



‘THE TALK’

As school year unfolds, Black and brown parents revisit lessons of systemic racism with their children

By Darcel Rockett | CHICAGO TRIBUNE

As students settle into the school year and “new normal,” parents take the journey with them — lending support and guidance as the back-to-school season unfolds amid the surprises and challenges everyday school interactions bring. Sometimes navigating the school year feels like a “Choose Your Own Adventure” book, where one decision could quickly spiral into devastating results and alter the course of a young person’s life.

One thing, however, remains constant: “the talk.”

It’s the conversation Black and brown parents have been having for generations with their children on how systemic racism and racial profiling can turn deadly in an instant. It’s a message they share with their children to equip them with the necessary knowledge to protect themselves from being hurt or killed during everyday activities that turn into racialized encounters with police and others.

Joy Sapp, a Chatham native, remembers having “the talk” when her eldest, Robert Wise III, 17, was 9 and her youngest, Elliott Donaldson Jr., 13, was 5. Parents like Sapp are revisiting the talk and now including friends — all to make sure their children stay safe, recognize pervasive biases, de-escalate scenarios they may encounter and remove themselves from situations that run counter to their well-being.

The conversations — online and in real life — have been particularly significant in recent months after the death of Nolan Wells, the Black teen who traveled to an uninhabited island off of Mississippi’s Gulf Coast on a July Fourth boat trip with a group of friends, all of whom were white. He did not return to the mainland with his friends; instead, his body was found two days later off the

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Langston Golden, 16, walks to Kenwood Academy High School in Hyde Park on Aug. 25. Golden recently had an interaction with law enforcement while at a South Side bus stop on his way home from work. **ARTHUR MAIORELLA/CHICAGO TRIBUNE**

ELECTION 2026 SENATE

GOP on defense in red states

Move to pull cash from NC, pour spending into Kansas reveals dire map for party

By Joey Cappelletti and Thomas Beaumont
ASSOCIATED PRESS

WASHINGTON — Senate Republicans’ top campaign spending organization is pulling back in North Carolina and pouring money into Kansas, a striking shift that shows how the party’s plan to keep its majority has turned into an increasingly defensive fight ahead of November’s midterms.

The decision by the Senate Leadership Fund, a super PAC aligned with top Senate Republicans, was disclosed Friday by four people with direct knowledge of the situation who insisted on anonymity to discuss internal strategy.

Ad cancellations are a common, and very telling, move down the stretch of campaigns, as they reveal where national operatives see their best path to a majority.

The shifting resources signal a lack of confidence that Michael Whatley, a former Republican National Committee chairman who was President Donald Trump’s choice to run for Senate in North Carolina, can beat Democratic former Gov. Roy Cooper.

Super PACs aligned with Trump also do not have any future reservations for airtime in the North Carolina Senate race.

“I am worried about (Whatley),” Trump told reporters Friday as he was departing for a campaign rally in Alabama. “I hope he wins.”

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■ Even though House districts were redrawn in Texas and Florida to make them easier to win, Republicans are weighed down by the public’s dissatisfaction with President Donald Trump. **Nation & World, Page B5**

Out of public eye for months, Kane County sheriff retires

By Molly Morrow and Rebecca Johnson
AURORA BEACON-NEWS

The Kane County sheriff, who has been missing from the public eye for about six months, announced Friday he’s stepping down to “focus on his health and to ensure continuity of leadership.”

Sheriff Ron Hain will retire Nov. 1, ending his 30-year career in law enforcement, according to a news release from the Kane County sheriff’s office and state’s attorney’s office. He declined interviews, asking the public to “respect his privacy as he focuses on his health,” but said in a statement that “serving the people of Kane County has been the honor of my life.”

“I’m proud of what we built together and prouder still of the men and women of this office who show up for this community every single day,” he said.

Hain hasn’t made a public appearance since at least the spring. The Tribune had submitted Freedom of Information requests about Hain’s absence Wednesday to the sheriff’s office.

Rumors of the reason behind Hain’s absence have swirled over the past year.



Hain

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AL DIVISION SERIES GAME 1 WHITE SOX AT GUARDIANS

When: Noon **Where:** Progressive Field, Cleveland **TV:** TBS, truTV and HBO Max **Radio:** WMVP-AM1000
In Sports: Can the White Sox can keep succeeding in the postseason without a conventional pitching rotation?

From cellar to hot seller

Stores scramble to keep up with demand for Sox gear

By Jane Miller
CHICAGO TRIBUNE

At downtown sports apparel shop Chicago Sports & Novelty, manager Loretta Rizzo laid out a freshly stocked stack of Munetaka Murakami jerseys.

“We’ve sold out of these three times,” she said, pointing to the pile of black and white fabric with the White Sox first baseman’s name spelled out in Japanese characters.

Since the wild-card round started, Munetaka Murakami has had the fourth-best-selling jersey in all of baseball, and the top three selling jerseys for the White Sox, according to sports merchandise company Fanatics. But it’s not just Murakami gear that fans are snatching up. Sales of White Sox merchandise across the board are up two times this week compared with last week.

With the team headed to the American League Division Series this weekend, stores across Chicago are experiencing an unprecedented demand for White Sox merchandise.

“They just won less than 24 hours ago,”



Colleen Doyle, a lifelong White Sox fan armed with tickets to Monday’s game in Cleveland, shops on Friday for a new shirt at Grandstand, a sports merchandise store in the South Side’s Bridgeport neighborhood. **ARTHUR MAIORELLA/CHICAGO TRIBUNE**

Jason Caref, owner of Clark Street Sports, said on Thursday, referring to the team’s win over the Houston Astros. “There were a bunch of online sales overnight.”

“I’m expecting a big weekend as they get into the next round,” he added.

At sports apparel store Grandstand, located just down the street from Rate Field, “anything with the Sox logo currently is flying off the shelf,” owner Stephanie Ganal said.

Grandstand is primarily known for its White Sox gear, but usually in October, the clothing on display is for the Bears.

“When we are into Bear season, and our sales floor is still primarily White Sox, you know the team is doing it well,” Ganal said with a laugh.

Inside Grandstand, amid rows of black and white hats, jerseys, lunchboxes and

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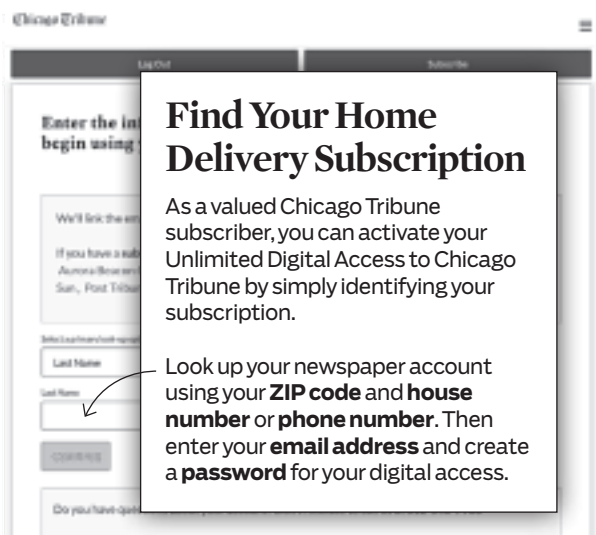


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Tribune books

“He Had It Coming: Four Murderous Women and the Reporter Who Immortalized Their Stories” “Chicago The Musical” played on Broadway for more than 9,600 performances since it premiered on Nov. 14, 1996, yet not many people know the characters of Roxie Hart, Velma Kelly and others are inspired by real women. Their stories were captured by Tribune reporters. This book includes original newspaper clippings, Watkins’ stories and a new analysis.

“Dinner at Home” Cooking at home doesn’t have to be difficult, but it should always be delicious. JeanMarie Brownson, culinary director for Rick Bayless’ Frontera Foods, helped readers put inventive, yet simple, dishes on the table through her Dinner at Home column for the Tribune. Her book includes everything you need to create spectacular food any day of the week.

“Capone: A Photographic Portrait of America’s Most Notorious Gangster.” Using many never-before-published photographs and newspaper clippings from the Tribune’s archives, this coffee-table book chronicles the rise and fall of Al Capone.

“Gangsters & Grifters: Classic Crime Photos From the Chicago Tribune.” This collection of photographs taken in the early 1900s through the 1950s features infamous criminals, small-time bandits, smirking crooks, pickpockets, hoodlums and wiseguys at crime scenes.

“Ask Amy: Advice for Better Living” For more than a decade, Amy Dickinson was the Tribune’s signature general advice columnist, helping readers with questions both personal and pressing. This book, which collects columns from 2011 to 2013, is a testament to her empathetic counsel and practical common-sense tips.

“Culture Worrier: Reflections on Race, Politics and Social Change.” Clarence Page’s newest book commemorates the 30th anniversary of his column’s first appearance in the Tribune. It is the first such collection of the Pulitzer Prize winner’s columns, covering topics such as politics, social issues, pop culture, race, family, new media and prominent figures, as well as his personal life.

“10 Things You Might Not Know About Nearly Everything.” You may never need to know the human body contains a half-pound of salt, but that’s just one of the obscure facts you’ll find about sports, history, religion, politics, arts and culture, food and leisure, and science and technology in this collection of columns from Mark Jacob and Stephan Benzkofer.

“Life Skills: How To Do Almost Anything” How do you give a good wedding toast? How do you fix a clogged drain? How do you bowl without hurting anyone? Questions like these make up this engaging do-it-yourself guide.

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Chicago Tribune (USPS104-000) is published daily (7 days) at 1000 Albion Ave., Schaumburg, IL, 60193; Chicago Tribune Company, LLC, Publisher; periodicals postage paid at Schaumburg, IL, and additional mailing offices. Postmaster: Send changes to the Chicago Tribune, Mail Subscription Division, 1000 Albion Ave., Schaumburg, IL, 60193.

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Illinois AG moves to halt operations at South Deering plant accused of odors

By Finnegan Belleau
CHICAGO TRIBUNE

Illinois Attorney General Kwame Raoul filed a motion Thursday to halt operations at a Southeast Side plant accused of emitting bad odors into the surrounding neighborhood, according to a news release. Raoul and the city of Chicago in August sued Pullman Innovations, a facility in South Deering that manufactures ingredients used in animal feed, for excessive odors, illegal air pollu-

tion, construction of a boiler without a permit and violations of certain conditions of the operating permit at its Chicago facility, according to a previous news release. Nearby resident Oscar Ortega told the Tribune in August that ever since changing ownership, odors from the plant made it difficult to go outside.

The Southeast Side has long dealt with industrial pollution and environmental justice issues. The motion for a temporary restraining order aims to stop operations

at the plant while a motion for a preliminary injunction would require the company to address the odors and violations of environmental law and its operating permit.

“The foul odors from the Pullman Innovations facility are hurting this community and interrupting the lives of nearby residents who deserve to enjoy their homes and neighborhood activities in peace,” Raoul said in a statement on Thursday announcing the filings.

Pullman Innovations did

not immediately respond to a request for comment.

A large portion of South Deering has an environmental justice index score of 98.6 on a scale that maxes out at 100, according to a map on the Chicago Health Atlas, a database created by the Chicago Department of Public Health and the University of Illinois Chicago. The composite score of cumulative impacts reflects communities in Chicago that are most burdened by pollution and most vulnerable to its effects.



Billy White shops at Grandstand in Chicago’s Bridgeport neighborhood on Friday for some “business casual” White Sox gear to wear to a weekend conference. **ARTHUR MAIORELLA/CHICAGO TRIBUNE PHOTOS**

SOX

from Page A1

other miscellaneous equipment, lifelong fan Billy Pindozzo picked out a White Sox sweatshirt that says “No Time Like October.”

Pindozzo is going to the blackout game at Rate Field on Wednesday.

“I just want some new gear for the game,” he said on Friday. “I got a bunch, but I want some new stuff.”

“Put away the Cubs stuff, it’s Sox time,” said Grandstand customer Rocco Arcieri, who was also shopping for the game on Wednesday. “The Cubs are the past, the Sox are the future. We’re young, we’re hungry, we’re ready to rock and roll.”

While sales have taken off in the last few days amid the team’s playoff victories, the good business has been a trend throughout the whole season, Ganal said.

“We’ve been busy like this since April,” she said.

As of Thursday night, White Sox gear sales at Clark



Grandstand’s large variety of White Sox hats.

Street Sports were up 70% this season when compared with last season, Caref said.

Staff at Clark Street Sports, which has multiple locations across the city and typically carries more Cubs gear than White Sox, have been folding up the blue and red jerseys and tucking them into the back to make space for large White Sox displays.

“They’re (White Sox jerseys) getting moved to the prominent location in the store,” Caref said, “and we’re ordering more Sox merchan-

dise so that people have more products to choose from.”

Mayra Cisneros, general manager at Chicago Sports & Novelty, said the store’s crew regrets not having ordered as much White Sox gear at the start of the year.

“That was a big mistake that everybody’s going through,” she said. “If they keep advancing, we’re gonna be out of merchandise.”

Their crew is preparing for a better season next year.

“For next year we actually placed a much bigger order,”

Cisneros said of the White Sox jerseys. “We doubled the amount just because of the way they’re playing.”

Chicago Sports & Novelty is located on Michigan Avenue, so a lot of its customers are tourists.

“Europeans love the White Sox,” Cisneros said with a laugh. “They’ll come and spend the money.”

With the excitement around the Bears coming at the same time as the White Sox victories, sports retailers agree that it’s a great time to be in business.

“It feels way better than, let’s say, two years ago, when the whole Chicago sports scene had gone through a drought, where no one made the playoffs,” Caref said. “I mean, there was a time where I definitely didn’t know where the next paycheck was coming from.”

“It’s Bears and Sox fighting for retail space on the floor,” Ganal said. “A good problem to have.”

“Let’s keep winning,” Caref said, “and let’s keep buying merchandise!”

SHERIFF

from Page A1

On April 10, Undersheriff Amy Johnson had told members of the sheriff’s office in an email that she was “aware of recent rumors regarding the Sheriff’s health.” She said Hain was currently in the hospital, but didn’t disclose the reason.

“Please be assured that we will continue to adhere to the established chain of command, and operations will proceed as normal,” she said. “We will provide updates as appropriate.”

Since then, there’s been no public explanation for Hain’s disappearance. When Hain was first elected in 2018, he had been among the most accessible in suburban law enforcement until he disappeared from the public eye.

Kane County State’s Attorney Jamie Mosser has, during this time, declined to comment at county meetings and in news inquiries on what she characterized as “details related to personnel matters, including whether or not a person is on a leave of absence.”

Mosser said in a Friday statement that she wants to thank Hain for his years of service. She said he helped her take on her role when she was newly elected, calling him a “mentor” and “trusted friend.”

“His vision for the jail in providing treatment and job skills transformed the way we look at criminal justice,” she said. “It has been an honor to work alongside him.”



Kane County Undersheriff Amy Johnson talks Aug. 26 in Geneva. **PAUL VALADE/DAILY HERALD**

Hain, of Elburn, isn’t seeking reelection to what would be a third term. He announced his intention not to run for another term in early 2025, casting his support behind Johnson, who is running as the Democratic nominee in the Nov. 3 election.

Johnson will also step into the position of sheriff after Hain retires “until another sheriff is elected or appointed,” the news release said. It’s unclear if she had already been serving in this position for the past six months while Hain was absent.

In a July 16 County Board committee meeting, board member Myrna Molina asked whether, in keeping with the chain of command, the undersheriff is “given operational oversight” if “the sheriff is not available.” Johnson confirmed that that is correct.

Johnson said Friday that Hain’s vision “transformed how we serve our community

and will continue to guide this office for years to come.”

Her Republican opponent in the sheriff’s race, Rob Russell, said Friday in a phone call that he’s glad Hain “got a chance to retire” and that “hopefully he’s doing well.”

Russell, the former Kane County coroner, said Johnson overseeing the sheriff’s office appeared to work “fine,” but criticized a lack of transparency about Hain’s absence.

“I don’t blame (Hain) for that,” Russell said. “But ... the people that he left in charge should have done something a little bit more responsible for the people.”

And he said he doesn’t think Johnson should be given “a leg up” when it comes to the election, now that she has the title of acting sheriff.

“I have faith in the people, and, and they see through stuff,” Russell said. “If this is some kind of October surprise, we’ll call it ... hopefully the

people will see through that.”

The news release commended Hain for his “innovative programs” that improved public safety and addressed the opioid crisis. It said he launched the “A Way Out” program in 2019 to help people struggling with drug addiction access treatment as well as the social worker program in 2021.

“What distinguished his service was his belief that public safety and second chances could go hand in hand,” said Kane County Board Chair Corinne Pierog. “He worked to create opportunities for individuals with criminal backgrounds to develop valuable job skills, rebuild their self-respect and make positive changes in their lives.”

Elgin police Chief Ana Lalley also said she contacted Hain many times for assistance and “he never failed to provide these much-needed resources.” She appreciated his “professionalism, cooperation and a commitment to the safety of all in Kane County.”

Former Kane County Sheriff Pat Perez, meanwhile, commended Hain’s “innovative approach to developing programs for inmates to help put their lives in a positive direction and reduce recidivism” which he said “raised the bar for sheriff’s offices across the country.”

Daily Herald reporters Charles Keeshan and Susan Sarkauskas as well as freelance reporter Alicia Fabbre contributed reporting.

Martinez to sue over shooting by Border Patrol

By Jason Meisner
CHICAGO TRIBUNE

Lawyers for Marimar Martínez, the Chicago woman shot five times by a Border Patrol agent during Operation Midway Blitz, said Friday they will file a federal lawsuit next week that includes new ballistics analysis and video animation showing the agent was not in harm’s way when he opened fire.

The lawsuit is expected to be filed in U.S. District Court on Monday, almost exactly a year to the day after agent Charles Exum opened fire on Martínez during a traffic altercation in the Brighton Park neighborhood, according to her attorneys, who plan to hold a news conference to show the video to the media.

“The presentation will illustrate the sequence of shots and the relative positions of Exum and Marimar’s vehicle, demonstrating how the physical evidence contradicts the government’s account of events,” Martínez’s attorneys said in a news release Friday.

The long-awaited lawsuit is landing some eight months after Martínez filed a federal tort claim against the Department of Justice alleging excessive force by Exum as well as a pattern of misstatements by his superiors intended to smear Martínez’s character and cover up the truth.

As part of that effort, Martínez’s attorneys released evidence in the case that they said demonstrated how Trump administration offi-



Marimar Martínez shows a scar on her arm during an April 28 hearing in the Loop as she describes the day she got shot by a Border Patrol agent. EILEEN T. MESLAR /TRIBUNE

cials “have created a culture of violence among their agents” where the shootings of U.S. citizens are “embraced, celebrated and promoted.”

Among the investigatory materials were text messages showing Exum joked about the shooting with colleagues, was called a “legend” by one of his fellow agents, and even received praise directly from his boss, then-Border Patrol Cmdr. Gregory Bovino, as Martínez lay badly wounded in a hospital.

Almost immediately after the shooting, Homeland Security officials released statements branding Martínez, a Montessori school teacher with no criminal record, as

an armed “domestic terrorist” who was part of a convoy attempting to box in agents that day.

DHS confirmed earlier this year that Exum had been placed on administrative leave while an internal investigation was conducted. His current status was not immediately known. A spokesperson for the agency did not respond to emailed questions about the status of the probe on Friday, referring the matter to the Department of Justice. A DOJ representative could not immediately be reached.

“CBP is committed to the highest standards of conduct, transparency, and accountability,” DHS said in a statement

in February. “All significant use-of-force incidents are thoroughly investigated, reviewed, and presented to the National Use of Force Review Board, an independent body comprised of senior CBP officials and representatives from DHS and DOJ, including the DOJ Civil Rights Division.”

Among the trove of evidence in Martínez’s case was body-camera footage from one of the agents in the car with Exum that day showing the tense moments just before their unmarked Chevrolet Tahoe, which was outfitted with an Uber sign, collided with her SUV.

“It’s time to get aggressive and get the (expletive) out,”

one agent said as horns blared. Seconds later, Exum, who was driving with his Glock pistol in his right hand, appeared to jerk the steering wheel to the left, in the direction of Martínez’s vehicle alongside them.

“Be advised we have been struck!” one of the agents in the vehicle yells to a dispatcher. Exum then gets out of the vehicle and moves off-camera and five rapid-succession gunshots are heard. Martínez was struck by gunfire in the legs, arm and chest, but managed to drive off before calling 911.

A few hours after the shooting, Bovino sent an email directly to Exum and others in Border Patrol commending him for his work, the evidence released Tuesday showed. “I would like to extend an offer to you to extend your retirement beyond age 57.... In light of your excellent service in Chicago, you have much left to do!” it read.

Exum, meanwhile, exchanged a series of texts with his wife as well as a group of fellow agents under the name “Posse Chat.” In one of them, someone Exum identified as “the guy from Vermont” wrote, “Good job brother, glad you are unharmed and get to live to tell the story.”

“You are a legend among agents you better (expletive) know that. Beers on me when I see you at training,” the agent texted Exum, the records show.

Martínez’s shooting drew

national scrutiny and became a defining moment of Midway Blitz, the Trump administration’s controversial immigration enforcement campaign last fall.

After surviving the ordeal, Martínez attended Trump’s State of the Union address in January as a guest of U.S. Rep. Jesús “Chuy” García, a Chicago Democrat. She also testified before Congressional committees and in other forums in Washington, calling herself the surviving “voice” for other victims of violence like Renee Good and Alex Pretti, two U.S. citizens who were fatally shot by immigration agents in Minnesota earlier this year.

Good’s family sued the U.S. government and several immigration officials on Thursday, alleging wrongful death, conspiracy and other violations in the 37-year-old woman’s killing.

In August, Martínez was among a handful of people who filed criminal complaints with the Chicago Police Department against federal agents over the tactics used during Midway Blitz.

“If the federal government refuses to act, state and local authorities must do so,” Marimar Martínez said outside CPD’s Area 3 station on the Northwest Side. “Today I am imploring our local and state officials to do their job and protect their citizens from the criminal conduct that ICE and Border Patrol have inflicted upon their victims, our brothers and sisters.”

Commander disciplined in ‘Blitz’ response moved out of patrol leadership

By Caroline Kubzansky
CHICAGO TRIBUNE

The leader of a South Side police district who was recently disciplined in connection with the Chicago police’s response to a high-profile confrontation on the city’s Southwest Side during Operation Midway Blitz has been removed from his post and transferred to a non-patrol division, police announced Thursday.

Cmdr. Joseph Mark, who has overseen day-to-day policing in the Deering (9th) District since July 2024, will now lead the department’s alternate response section, according to a Chicago Police Department news release. The alternate response section handles nonemergency calls. It’s also the typical landing spot for cops who have been stripped of their police powers.

His departure comes amid a spike in gun violence around the district, which covers Back of the Yards, Bridgeport, McKinley Park and Brighton Park, among other neighbor-

hoods. Data updated through Sept. 27 show that homicides have increased by 117% from the same period in 2025, while shootings have jumped by 37%.

Recently released public records also show Mark was given a Summary Punishment Action Request, indicating a relatively small violation of department policy, related to an internal investigation of how Chicago police handled protests that followed the shooting of U.S. citizen Marimar Martínez at the hands of U.S. Customs and Border Protection Agent Charles Exum.

The shooting kicked off a blockbuster federal court case that fell apart only weeks later and led to a day of chaos in Brighton Park as federal agents deployed multiple rounds of chemical munitions against furious residents.

It also led to an internal investigation of former Chief of Patrol Jon Hein, who was effectively the second-in-command of CPD at the time of the raids. Hein

allegedly sent a “no units shall respond” message out across CPD’s internal communication system after a group of federal agents called 911, saying they were surrounded by a crowd of angry citizens in Brighton Park. News of the message incited furor among right-wing commentators, prompting then-Superintendent Larry Snelling to mount a full-throated defense of Hein at a news conference a few days later.

The investigation, categorized under “Operation/Personnel Violations/Failure to provide service,” was marked not sustained or otherwise unfounded, records show, and Hein was cleared of any wrongdoing.

Records show that at least two police supervisors — Mark and Lt. Jason Brown, also with the Deering District — were formally disciplined for what appeared to be minor infractions in connection with that investigation. Neither Mark nor Brown immediately responded to a request for comment.

According to police,

Mark will be replaced by James Triantafillo, who was most recently a captain in the Harrison (11th) District. Thursday’s promotions also

included a new Chief of Patrol. Andre Parham, who most recently was the deputy chief of CPD’s Harrison Area (Area 4), will supervise the

patrol division, considered the backbone of the department. The role has been vacant since June, when Hein retired.

TINLEY PARK

Dairy Palace makes cinematic debut

By Evy Lewis
DAILY SOUTHTOWN

Tinley Park’s venerable Dairy Palace reached a new audience last month when “Trash Mountain,” a movie that used the 73-year-old ice cream shop as a filming location, had its world premiere at the Toronto International Film Festival.

“It was fun,” Dairy Palace owner Kevin Hoffmeister said of his business becoming a movie set. “It was a lot of fun.”

The movie is set for two Chicago-area screenings as part of the Chicago International Film Festival this month, according to the festival’s website, with one scheduled for 5:15 p.m., Oct. 23 at the AMC Newcity 14 in Lincoln Park and the other scheduled for 3 p.m., Oct. 24 at the Chicago History Museum.

“Trash Mountain” stars Caleb Hearon, Zooey Deschanel, Jaboukie Young-White, Kyle Marvin and Jacki Weaver, and was directed by Kris Rey. The movie follows a Chicago man, played by Hearon, who travels back to his Missouri hometown to sort through his recently deceased hoarder father’s

belongings.

“People were great,” Hoffmeister said. “Couldn’t have been nicer. I wasn’t expecting that, I kind of expected a bit of Hollywood attitude, but none of that happened at all. Everybody was cool.”

The film shoot took place last October, at the very end of the Dairy Palace’s summer season. At the end of the day of filming, Hoffmeister said, Hearon bought Dairy Palace ice cream for the full crew.

“He said, ‘Ice cream for everybody.’ There was like over a hundred people,” Hoffmeister recalled. “Everybody got what they wanted, and he picked up the tab for it.”

A wide theatrical release date for the movie has not yet been announced. Following its premiere at the Toronto International Film Festival, it had a 100% fresh rating from 15 critics on Rotten Tomatoes.

“Everybody had a good time, I think,” Hoffmeister said. “We certainly did.”

Hoffmeister said when the movie does have its full release, he’d like to take his employees to see it.

“We’ll take all the people that work at the store,” Hoffmeister said. “We’re gonna

take them, when the movie comes out, make a day of it and just pay for everybody to go.”

The Dairy Palace was one of several candidates to be the backdrop for the sequence.

“I guess it was like 10 of them, and they narrowed it down to us at the last minute,” he said. “The director liked our place the best.”

Hoffmeister said it was the first time a movie had been filmed in Tinley Park.

“Tinley kind of gave them a little pressure about getting permitting, and it was gonna take 60 days, and I called them and was like, ‘Listen, when’s the last time a movie was shot in Tinley Park?’” Hoffmeister said. “They said, ‘Never.’ And I said, ‘Well, there you go.’”

It’s not too late to grab a cold treat at a local shop that’s getting international exposure. The Dairy Palace, 16760 Oak Park Ave., is open from 2 to 10 p.m. daily. The business usually closes for the winter towards the end of October, depending on the weather, Hoffmeister said.

“If it stays nice, we stay open,” Hoffmeister said. “If you see the yellow lights on, we’re there.”

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ICE tracked in Lake County as fear lingers

By Steve Sadin
FOR THE LAKE COUNTY
NEWS-SUN

U.S. Immigration and Customs Enforcement agents returned to Lake County in recent days, apprehending two men in Waukegan, patrolling Gurnee Mills and being spotted in Round Lake. Their return rekindled some of the fear instilled during Operation Midway Blitz a year ago, when dozens were taken into custody by federal immigration officers during a 70-day period. “Last year was awful to experience,” Maria-Elana Jonas, the founder and president of Waukegan-based HACES, said. “They still follow people with racial profiling. I carry my passport.”

Mario Guadarrama, 31, and Pedro Serrano-Hernandez, 39, were apprehended by ICE agents on Sept. 25 near the intersection of Prescott and Eighth streets in Waukegan, near the Holy Family Food Pantry, according to an email from the U.S. Department of Homeland Security. Both Guadarrama and Serrano-Hernandez were taken into custody during targeted enforcement operations, it said. Guadarrama was arrested by Illinois authorities in 2019 for domestic battery, according to the email. He entered the U.S. illegally at an unknown time and location. Dulce Ortiz, the executive director of Mano a Mano Family Services and a Waukegan Township trustee, said

Mano a Mano is supporting Guadarrama’s family, which includes three elementary school-age children. He is being held in an ICE detention facility in Indiana, she said. Meanwhile, Ortiz said Mano a Mano’s rapid response team was busy on Sept. 25 and on Monday reacting to reports of ICE activity in the Round Lake area and Gurnee Mills. She is unaware of anyone else being taken away by agents. “They knew we were watching,” Ortiz said. “They kept moving around. They eventually left.” A year after Midway Blitz, when Fiestas Patrias events were canceled in Lake County, some people felt comfortable going to celebra-

tions this year while others did not. Though fear remains, Ortiz said some people are more comfortable going to community events. “They feel a need to go out and support these events so the small businesses feel supported,” she said. “They’re going for the ones who are afraid.” Fear has not gone away for everyone. Ortiz said some people are reluctant to leave their homes, and they are careful when they do. Others are learning to live with their dread. “They take precautions so they are not kidnapped,” she said. Jonas said naturalized citizens and those who have lived legally in the U.S. for a long time are feel-

ing more comfortable now. Asylum-seekers dwelling in the country for two to three years are far more careful. “They are all cautious and nervous of being out and about,” Jonas said. “They are a good section of the community.” Waukegan Mayor Sam Cunningham, who intervened when immigration enforcement agents were trying to arrest a native-born daughter of immigrants last year, said in an email that Midway Blitz impacted “so many individuals and families” in the city. “From how children travel to school to how neighbors interact, the disruption fundamentally altered daily lives throughout the city,” he said. “The city stands firmly

committed to ensuring that every resident, regardless of immigration status, feels safe engaging with local government and law enforcement.” Theresa Plascencia, the superintendent of Waukegan Community School District 60, said in an email that the fear “did not begin or end last fall. While there may not be the same level of attention today, we know that fear and uncertainty remain very real for some of our students and families. “Throughout all of this, our focus has remained on supporting our students and families, connecting them with information and resources when needed, and doing everything we can to provide stability during uncertain times,” she said.

TALK

from Page A1

island’s coast. Questions have swirled around Wells’ death from his family, his legal representation and the Black community, who were suspicious about law enforcement moving too quickly with the investigation and assuming foul play wasn’t involved, while being slow in relaying new information to the public. An independent autopsy commissioned by Wells’ family found in July that the 18-year-old’s cause of death was “undetermined” pending further investigation. A Mississippi grand jury decided not to bring indictments in the case last month. “You have to keep a watchful eye,” Sapp said. “I tell my kids all the time: You are the company you keep, so if you’re around friends and they’re doing something they’re not supposed to, you need to distance yourself or let somebody know. You have to make sure these are your friends, because he (Wells) thought that these were his friends and we’re seeing now that that wasn’t really evident.” This summer, Jamie Nesbitt Golden learned about an interaction her 16-year-old son, Langston, had with law enforcement at a South Side bus stop on his way home from work. It sparked the Block Club Chicago reporter’s ire and prompted her to write a Facebook post about it. Having missed his usual stop, he got off at the next one when a blue, unmarked Ford Explorer pulled up with two plainclothes officers — one Black, the other white. “I had assumptions of them thinking I was suspicious because they couldn’t see that I was on the phone and I was hunched over,” the Kenwood High School junior said. “They approached me and told me that they were checking on my well-being. They asked if I had a weapon on me. I’m like, ‘No.’ I told them I don’t live in the area.” Golden recalled the interaction taking no more than five minutes, but he thinks about the mistakes he made — steps his parents told him not to take when they gave him “the talk.” One was walking closer to those who say they are law enforcement. His mother told him to maintain distance because he didn’t know



Langston Golden, 16, walks to Kenwood Academy High School with his mother, Jamie Nesbitt Golden, in Hyde Park on Aug. 25. “I didn’t feel threatened for my life. ... I was irritated,” Golden said of his recent interaction with law enforcement. “I say that this is my first kind of intense interaction with CPD.” **ARTHUR MAIORELLA/CHICAGO TRIBUNE**

whether they were real cops. Having covered Immigration and Customs Enforcement as part of her job, she said she worries about folks impersonating law enforcement officers. Another mistake was conversing with law enforcement officials without a parent listening in. The interaction ended when a young woman interrupted. As Golden said, “She sort of shoed them away.” “I didn’t feel threatened for my life. ... I was irritated,” he said of this, his first intense interaction with the Chicago Police Department. His parents sent him to work in Ubers for a few days after that, as a precaution. He took the train for the remainder of his summer program. Golden said she is following her son’s lead on navigating the aftermath of the incident, which may entail lodging a complaint with the police. Riana Elyse Anderson, a licensed clinical psychologist and associate professor at Columbia University’s School of Social Work, looks

at proactive coping strategies to reduce race-related stress in Black families as the CEO and founder of RACE Space Inc., which hosts the mental health app Teens Navigating the Talk, designed by clinicians, researchers and youths of color to improve teens’ ability to talk about, cope with, and confront racism. She sees the Wells case as nuanced. “I can’t say that there’s nothing racial about it, and I don’t want to say that this isn’t a racial issue,” she said. “At the same time, adolescents make hell a mistakes all the time and try to cover it up. This is not something that we can put our finger entirely on, and we can’t lose sight of it at the same time.” Nesbitt Golden said Langston takes part in TMH Mancave, a weekly boxing and mental health program, with a peer group of other high school-age kids. The program aims to eliminate stigma and bring awareness to the mental health needs of Black men and boys. He said the group spent a day talking

about the Wells case. “Kids, for the most part, are resilient,” she said. “We’ve been having these conversations since he was in first or second grade. When he came home that day ... when he told me he had approached the car because he couldn’t hear, my blood ran cold. We tell him, ‘Don’t answer any questions, ask for a parent.’ But you have to give a little grace because as soon as you’re in that situation, everything you’ve been taught goes out the window because you’re trying to figure out what to do. I had that moment on Facebook because I was so upset about it.” In high-stress situations, Anderson said, the rules laid out in the talk don’t always translate into action. “We can’t say definitively what Nolan did or didn’t do,” Anderson said. “But what I can say is that when families have these conversations with young people, their psychological well-being tends to be better, because these young people are processing, and when they

do react, it’s not as much of a spike in adrenaline, stress or cortisol. It’s a recognition and awareness of that situation, and that keeps them more regulated in their ability to process.” Both Sapp and Nesbitt Golden said the talk remains a necessary mainstay as their boys get older. “All we can do is continue to have these conversations,” Nesbitt Golden said. “Keep stressing that there are ways to navigate this. ... It’s not just what happens when you are stopped by cops, but what happens when you’re at a party and something happens and you don’t feel safe? How do you leave that?” “There are too many Black and brown kids that aren’t making it home,” Sapp added. With a son soon to be in college, she said she’s doubling down on making sure he’s aware of his surroundings. “Going to parties. You have to watch your cup, ... the people you hang around. You have to be careful.” It’s never too soon to have

“the talk,” Anderson said. Points of entry are many, given that literature exists to help adults have developmentally appropriate conversations with youths on the topic. “If they could pick out which Starburst (candy) they like, they get the concept of discrimination,” Anderson said. “They know how to pick amongst things that they like and don’t like. It’s about how you can use your own sense of their understanding to link into that conversation.” Anderson has built a program for Black families to talk to each other about this — specifically for those 10 to 14 years old. In it, people talk about and unpack feelings, and ask questions of youths: “What did you notice? How can I help you to think about this more clearly?” “You don’t have to have all the answers,” she said. “If you can say ‘I love you and I want to make sure that you’re OK. Talk to me about how you feel about this thing.’ I think that’s a really helpful kick-start for family conversations.”

Trail camera sighting highlights bobcats’ stealthy presence in Will County

By Elena Tittel
DAILY SOUTHTOWN

When a trail camera set up by the Forest Preserve District of Will County in a preserve in the south end of the county captured images of two bobcats, naturalists saw that one of the animals had a pronounced limp. They were glad to see it. Becky Blankenship, a wildlife ecologist at the Forest Preserve District of Will County, said the bobcat with a limp also appeared on trail camera footage back in 2022. That implies that the bobcat is recovering well and has been able to support itself in the wild, she said. Though bobcats, scientifically called *lynx rufus*, are native to Illinois and have seen a major population resurgence in the past decade, they’re much more likely to be caught on film rather than seen in person. Blankenship said that bobcats pop up pretty regu-



Bobcats have been spotted this year on cameras set up by the Forest Preserve District of Will County. **FOREST PRESERVE DISTRICT OF WILL COUNTY**

larly in southern Will County. The district has seen several bobcats on their trail cams over the years and said that they are known to be in the area. “I get a lot of anecdotal evidence of people saying that they’ve seen them a few years ago, or once in their yard or something like that,” Blankenship said. However, seeing one in person can be quite rare depending on where you are.

“Not a lot of people get to see these critters,” Blankenship said. “It’s a pretty cool species, so if you do get to see it, it’s a really cool moment.” Bobcats can be found statewide and often live in areas with wooded bluffs and rolling hills and in bottom-land forests, she said. They are carnivores that hunt and consume prey such as cottontail rabbits and squirrels. Guillaume Bastille-Rousseau, associate professor at

Southern Illinois University, said the Illinois bobcat population has been rebounding after a long period of decline. According to Bastille-Rousseau, the number of bobcats in Illinois started to decline in the 1970s and they were listed as a threatened population. As the population continued to decline, the state halted legal hunting of bobcats in 1977. By that time, the state’s bobcat population was primarily concentrated in southern Illinois, where forests are abundant. In 2001, Bastille-Rousseau said the bobcats began to rebound in Illinois, and they have been able to recolonize areas across the state. Bobcats were officially taken off the state’s threatened species list in 1999, according to the Illinois Bobcat Foundation. Bastille-Rousseau said that bobcat hunting season in Illinois was reestablished in 2016, ending a 44-year ban. The upcoming bobcat hunting and trapping seasons

will take place between Nov. 10 and Feb. 15. Hunters can go out anytime during the day but must possess a bobcat hunting and trapping permit beforehand, according to Hunt Illinois. Bastille-Rousseau said approximately 2,000 bobcat hunting and trapping permits are issued per season. Permit holders are limited to harvest one bobcat per season. According to Blankenship, bobcats cannot be legally hunted or trapped in Will County as harvesting is restricted to the southern and western halves of Illinois. Neither bobcats nor any other species can be hunted or trapped in the forest preserves. To properly hunt or trap them, Blankenship said, hunters need to properly educate themselves about ethical practices. “Hunters and trappers must complete education courses that teach them how to harvest game animals ethi-

cally and responsibly. Ethics applies to sustainable levels of harvest, which must be based on the best available science,” Blankenship said. While bobcats are wild animals, Bastille-Rousseau said they are not dangerous and will not attack humans. In fact, they can be quite scared of people and tend to avoid them. He said although bobcats are bigger than a domestic house cat, they are no larger than a medium-size dog and weigh only 15 to 30 pounds. If you have your hopes set on seeing a bobcat for yourself, Blankenship said they are primarily crepuscular, meaning they are more active at dawn and dusk. However, it is not impossible to see one during the day. Blankenship advised if you see a bobcat out in the wild, do not approach it or call for it to come closer. She said people do not have to take any precautions and can appreciate them from a distance.

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YOUR VOICE

Here’s why Illinois’ eight shuttered visitor centers matter

By Frank Hosek
SPECIAL TO THE TRIBUNE

As my wife and I were traveling on Interstate 55 on our way to Memphis, Tennessee, the “home of the blues,” we spied a welcome center in Blytheville after crossing the border into Arkansas. We pulled over to stretch our legs and take advantage of the offerings.

We were greeted with a natural stone and post-and-beam constructed building. Inside, the slate floors beneath exposed beams led us past display cases filled with the state’s natural wonders and a bevy of racks filled with brochures and booklets.

On this day, Arkansas was nothing more than a pass-through state on our drive to southwestern Tennessee. As I awaited my wife, I picked up a small trifold brochure touting “Historic Dyess Colony: Where Johnny Cash’s Story Began.”

Well, this was intriguing! I am a Cash fan, but this Dyess Colony was new to me. With a little prompting from a smiling attendant who stood ready to answer any inquiries about her state, I announced to my wife we were headed to Dyess.

Soon, we were bouncing across northeast Arkansas, down black-topped roads and past sandy fields, tired little homes fenced in by rusted memories and tottering road signs riddled by .22 caliber holes searching for the boyhood home of Johnny Cash.

There, we learned from the former mayor, and now museum manager, of the home where Cash grew up, the experiences that formed some of his earliest memories and served as the basis of some of his first recordings with Sun Records of Memphis. We also discovered the remarkable story of the New Deal community



A woman poses for a portrait in front of fiberglass Muffler Man statues at the American Giants Museum in Atlanta, Illinois, in 2025. E. JASON WAMBSGANS/CHICAGO TRIBUNE

that helped shape his life and music.

It was a most enjoyable and enlightening detour.

I was reminded of this by the announcement that Illinois’ eight interstate visitor information centers closed at the end of September.

“The role of the state’s visitor information centers has evolved significantly over the past couple of decades as the ways visitors plan and access travel information have changed,” the Illinois Department of Commerce and Economic Opportunity told Capitol News Illinois in a statement.

The assumed inference is that travelers rely on Google for their travel needs and that informative brochures and knowledgeable attendants are a quaint idea that has outlived its usefulness.

There is no doubt that the internet contains a wealth of information for travelers. If you’re heading to Chicago, you can check Tripadvisor for the best hotels, things to see and top 10 restaurants. That is useful knowledge at your fingertips, specific to your destination.

But what do you know of the highway to your destination? Robert Frost wrote of

the road not taken, and how he doubted that he would ever come back.

It’s the treasures along the way that need a voice.

While driving on I-57 through southern Illinois to Chicago, who will tell you of Chester? It’s a 50-minute detour to the birthplace of Popeye the Sailor Man and Fort Kaskaskia of the American Revolution.

If you’re cruising on I-55 between Springfield and Bloomington, stop at the American Giants Museum in Atlanta, Illinois, which tells the story of the kitschy Muffler Man statues and other roadside giants in America.

Amid the cornfields on I-72, you can stop and ride the rails at the Monticello Railway Museum, home to a restored, running, 1907 vintage steam locomotive.

On I-80 to Joliet, you can take Exit 97 to see the more than 8,000 names engraved on the polished black granite of the Middle East Conflicts Wall Memorial in Marseilles, each name representing a military member lost in service to our nation.

According to Gov. JB Pritzker and the Illinois Department of Commerce and Economic Opportunity, visitor spending hit an all-time high of \$50.2 billion in 2025. The state has greeted that significant news by eliminating the small budget of \$1.6 million appropriated for the eight Illinois visitor centers.

Another name for visitor centers is welcome centers. They act as the front doors to Illinois, for the 115 million visitors who choose to grace our state.

Do we really want to close those doors?

Frank Hosek is a freelance travel writer based just outside the Chicago area and a retired director of human resources for an Illinois company.

Voice of the people

State action on plastics

Regarding the article “The overwhelming problem of plastic” (Sept. 27): As someone who has dedicated her personal and professional life to protecting the Great Lakes, I can attest to the mind-blowing prevalence of microplastics on the shore of the Great Lakes. Locals know me for my pink kei truck that I use to haul thousands of pounds of trash from the Great Lakes to my home, where I find creative ways to use it for art. The things I’ve seen are devastating: endless colorful plastic fragments. My childhood beach is inundated with plastic pollution.

No matter how much trash I collect, there’s always more. That’s why I use my career to advocate for policies that meaningfully reduce plastic pollution.

Illinois has taken baby steps in reducing plastic pollution over the years. Chicago supported the shift away from throwaway culture with a fee on disposable plastic and paper bags, and the city prohibits restaurants from providing single-use utensils and condiment packets unless they’re requested. Illinois recently became the first Great Lakes state to legally classify industrial plastic pellets as pollutants.

State lawmakers need to think bigger. Much of the microplastic pollution in the Great Lakes is microfibers, the tiny plastic strands that come from clothing and other textiles — and a major source is our washing machines. While fashion brands and textile manufacturers need to stop using so much synthetic material in the first place, policymakers can help trap a significant amount of these microfibers before they end up in our lakes. Research led by my 5 Gyres Institute colleague, Lisa Erdle, shows that installing filters on washing machines can reduce microfibers in wastewater by 41%. That’s huge!

We cannot filter our way out of a problem that starts with how much plastic companies put into our clothing.

However, Illinois lawmakers should consider requiring filters in all new washing machines sold in the state. Additionally, the state legislature must finally pass a ban on single-use plastic bags and plastic-foam containers — a policy that would actually stop pollution before it even starts. These are simple but effective ways to substantially curb the plastic pollution happening in our treasured Great Lakes.

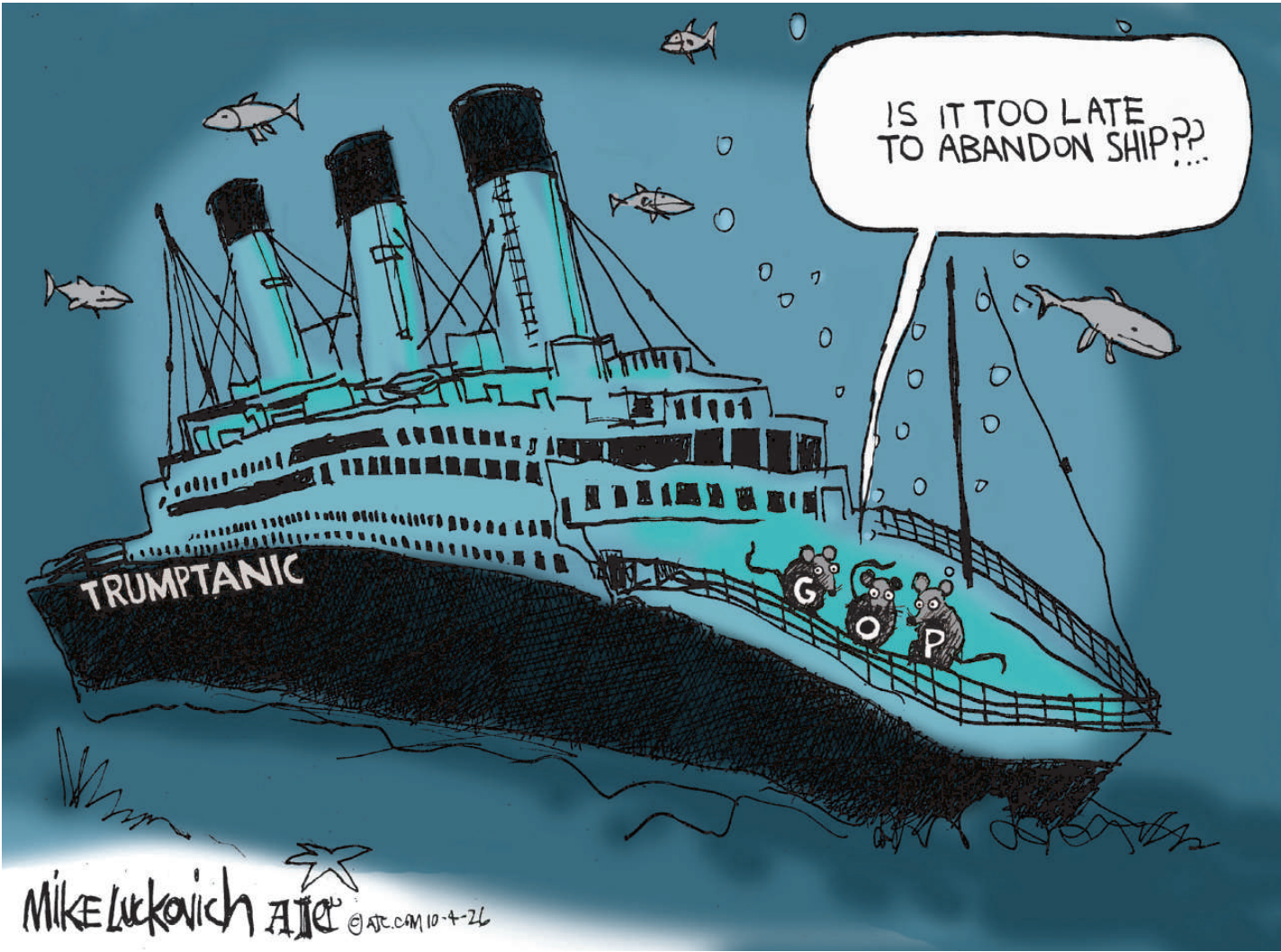
It’s past time for meaningful plastics policy. The Great Lakes deserve our protection, and the region is counting on state leaders to preserve it.

— Hannah Tizedes, senior digital marketing lead, 5 Gyres Institute

The scourge of plastic waste

The series “Great waste in Great Lakes” reviews the scourge of plastic waste in the Great Lakes.

The oceans of the world are also clogged with plastic. There has been much discussion about microplastics so small that they



MIKE LUCKOVICH/THE ATLANTA JOURNAL-CONSTITUTION

get into the human body. We have yet to see all the damage these small particle will do to a person’s health. That so little of the produced plastics are recycled, about 5%, is a story not widely reported, while blue containers around us give us a false impression about the process that we’re doing good.

When all children are found to have these plastics particles in their bodies, what will the plastic corporations; their CEOs, attorneys and lobbyists; and uninterested government officials tell their children about why they are infected and the cause of their health issues? That they took pride in producing the tons of plastics that clog the waste stream?

If we are to keep using these materials, then the producers and the public have to step up and find solutions to really reducing the world’s biggest solid contamination. The future generations deserve better. If we can put men on the moon, we can also clean up our environment.

— Bill Gurolnick, Northbrook

Individual actions for climate

Thank you for the series on the problem of plastic. Plastic is an important issue and

deserves attention.

However, climate change is also important. Many know about the problem. How about articles on what individuals can do about it?

Faith in Place recently had a program on “Unlock Solar Savings: How to Fund your Clean Energy Transition.” The Illinois Environmental Council could also provide information.

Providing such information would help Tribune readers prevent the increasingly serious problem of climate change.

— Eleanor Hall, Chicago

Story took me back in time

In 1974, I was a fresh meteorology graduate from Northern Illinois University. My first job was in Wheeling at the Central Weather Service working for Earl Finckle. My main job was to call our contact at Bell Federal Savings and Loan and provide a forecast so the bank could set the bell in the right mode.

Seeing the picture of the updated Bell-weather in Sunday’s paper (“Aglow once again”) and reading the article sure took me back in time. Thank you.

— Mike Garfield, Buffalo Grove

Letter on forgiveness

Wow! The letter from Scott T. Thompson hit home — hard (“What is actually forgiveness?” Sept. 28). I’m sure that like many people, family disagreements have kept family members apart for many years, sometimes decades. I cut out the letter and plan to send it to a family member I have been estranged from for decades. And ask for forgiveness.

Thank you to Thompson.
— Sonia McGuinn, Lake Villa

Bring back Kid Whisperer

Whatever happened to the Kid Whisperer? I imagine his astringent style annoyed a few parents, but I loved his columns because he was such a breath of fresh air.

I wish the Tribune would bring him back!

— Barbara Newman, Evanston

For online-exclusive letters, go to www.chicagotribune.com/letters. Email your letter submissions, 400 words or less, to letters@chicagotribune.com. Include your full name, address and phone number.



Sen. Roger Marshall, R-Kansas, gestures while Vice President JD Vance speaks Sept. 14 in Olathe, a suburb of Kansas City. **MARK SCHIEFELBEIN/AP**

SENATE

from Page A1

The moves offer a stark sign of how dramatically the Senate map has shifted just a month before midterm elections that will determine control of the U.S. House and Senate.

Republicans entered the cycle believing they had more opportunities to flip Democratic-held seats than they had incumbents at serious risk. Now they are dumping money into states where Trump won comfortably two years ago.

Kansas Sen. Roger Marshall, a Republican seeking a second term, is facing a challenge from Democratic nominee Adam Hamilton, the leader of the nation's largest United Methodist Church.

The Senate Leadership Fund has reserved nearly \$8.2 million in advertising to support Marshall over the next month, according to AdImpact, a significant investment in a state Trump won by nearly 16 percentage points in the last presidential election.

Marshall has reserved another \$2.3 million and is supported by another \$500,000 from other groups. By comparison, Hamilton has reserved just \$590,000 in advertising, and he's receiving only a little more than \$556,000 in outside help.

Marshall won his first Senate race by more than 11 percentage points in 2020, the year Democrat Joe Biden defeated Trump for president.

However, higher fuel costs and other economic concerns have made the state more competitive than Republicans had expected.

"Kansas farmers — including Republicans — are devastated by the war in Iran driving up diesel prices," said Jeanna Repass, chair of the Kansas Democratic Party.

Former Kansas Gov. Mike Hayden, a Republican, announced Friday that he was endorsing Hamilton. He is the second Republican former governor of Kansas to back the Democrat, after Bill Graves endorsed Hamilton on Sept. 23.

Lauren French, a spokesperson for the Senate Majority PAC, the Democrats' spending arm, said in a statement that "Republicans are scrambling because they know" Hamilton can win.

Marshall's campaign did not provide comment directly responding to the new spending on his behalf.

The Senate Leadership Fund had planned to spend \$18 million in North Carolina over the next month, according to reservations tracked by AdImpact. The group has already spent about \$32 million there.

Trump campaigned with Whatley last month, saying higher fuel prices were "a very inexpensive price to pay" for preventing Iran from acquiring a nuclear weapon. Though gas prices are near historic highs, they remain below the nationwide record set in 2022.

Trump won North Carolina by just over 3 percentage points in 2024. Republicans

have held both of the state's Senate seats since 2015, even as Cooper won two terms as governor and served from 2017 to 2025.

Jeff Allen, campaign manager for Cooper, said in a statement that they remain focused on "building a campaign to earn every vote."

Whatley's team defended his chances.

"We feel confident we have the resources to highlight Career Politician Roy Cooper's 40 Years of Failures and win in November," campaign spokesman DJ Griffin said in a statement.

There's more trouble for the party farther south in Georgia.

Although Republicans were eager to dislodge Democratic Sen. Jon Ossoff this year, they're despairing about the chances of their nominee in the race, Rep. Mike Collins.

"I don't think he's got much of a shot," Tim Waters, Peach County Republican Party chair, previously said.

Winning the Senate majority could still prove difficult for Democrats.

They would need to defeat multiple Republican incumbents in states like Ohio, Maine and Alaska, and there are some concerns that Democrats could fall short in New Hampshire.

The party is also facing a tidal wave of Republican cash, much of it connected to Trump's deep-pocketed political organization.

The New York Times contributed.



Chicago Tribune Death Notices

Chicago Tribune extends our condolences to the families and loved ones of those who have passed.

chicagotribune.com/deathnotice

Death Notices

Crifassi, Michael Joseph "Mike"

Michael J. Crifassi
May 9, 1951 – May 13, 2026

Michael J. Crifassi, 75, passed away May 13, 2026. The oldest of four children, Michael was preceded in death by his parents, Carl and Veronica Crifassi; brother, James Charles; sister, Margaret Mary; and nephew, Carl Sager.

He is survived by his sister, Denise Bruschi; brother-in-law, Ron Sager; nieces and nephews Lisa Prejean, James Hampl, Anne Bruschi, John Bruschi, Tina Sager, Michael Sager and Michelle Sager; many great-nieces and great-nephews; and cherished longtime friends, Jack and Val.

Brilliant, fiercely independent and truly one of a kind, Michael will be remembered for his intelligence, generosity, loyalty and unforgettable personality.

A Celebration of Life will be held Sunday, October 4, 2026, from 2:00–5:00 p.m. at Gino's East, 162 E. Superior Street, Chicago, Illinois 60611.

Moran Jr, John Thomas Jack

John Thomas Moran, Jr., known to many as Jack, passed away on September 23, 2026, at the age of 83.

Born on March 15, 1943, in Oak Park, Jack carried with him throughout his life a deep sense of fairness, determination, and conviction. His journey took him from Chicago, to Scarsdale, New York, to South Bend, Indiana, and later to Georgetown, where he pursued the education and experiences that would shape a remarkable legal career dedicated to helping others.

Graduating Magna Cum Laude of the University of Notre Dame, Jack went on to earn his law degree from Georgetown University in 1968, and was grantee of National Endowment for the Humanities from Harvard Law School. From there began what would become more than five decades of distinguished legal practice. He was an intern for Donald Rumsfeld in Congress before he moved back to Chicago to take a position in the Cook County Public Defender's Office. There he ultimately headed the Appeals Division, before opening his own practice, The Moran Law Group.

Throughout his career, he championed the rights of workers, employees, unions, and individuals who often lacked the resources to defend themselves. He believed deeply in justice and was guided by a strong sense of right and wrong. Whether representing clients in complex litigation or taking cases pro bono, Jack fought tirelessly for those who needed someone in their corner and with that determination he developed lifelong friendships, whom he cared for deeply.

His professional accomplishments were many, but those who knew him best remember his intelligence, his passionate advocacy, his sharp wit, his many stories, and his unwavering commitment to causes he believed in. Though he built a remarkable legal career, those who knew Jack also knew of his enduring love for Notre Dame football. As a proud alumnus, he followed the Fighting Irish throughout his life, celebrating victories, enduring disappointments, and sharing countless Saturday's with friends and family in South Bend. Notre Dame was not simply where he attended college; it remained an important part of who he was and a source of lasting pride.

Preceded by his mother Corinne Dire and father John Thomas Moran, Jack is survived by his wife, Cathy; her daughters Lola and Stella; his son, Sean Pyne-Moran and his mother Kay; his sister, Donna Robbins and her children Michelle and David; his brother Joseph Moran and a wide circle of extended family, friends, and colleagues.

His legacy lives on in the people whose lives he touched, the individuals he defended, the workers for whom he fought, and the family and friends who will remember his strength of character, generosity, and devotion to justice.

For eventual information on his memorial please visit : <https://www.legacy.com/legacy/john-moran>

Chicago Daily Tribune

ON OCT. 3 ...

In 1226, Francis of Assisi, founder of the Franciscan religious order, died; he was canonized in 1228.

In 1863 President Abraham Lincoln declared the last Thursday in November Thanksgiving Day.

In 1929 the Kingdom of Serbs, Croats and Slovenes formally changed its name to the Kingdom of Yugoslavia.

In 1941 Adolf Hitler declared in a speech in Berlin that Russia had been "broken" and would "never rise again." Also in 1941 rock star Chubby Checker was born in Philadelphia.

In 1942 President Franklin Roosevelt established the Office of Economic Stabilization.

In 1944, during World War II, U.S. troops cracked the Siegfried Line north of Aachen, Germany.

In 1951 the New York Giants captured the National League pennant in Game 3 by a score of 5-4 as third baseman Bobby Thomson hit a three-run homer off the Brooklyn Dodgers' Ralph Branca in the "shot heard 'round the world."

In 1955 "Captain Kangaroo" and "The Mickey Mouse Club" premiered on CBS and ABC, respectively.

In 1960 "The Andy Griffith Show" premiered on CBS.

In 1961 "The Dick Van Dyke Show," also starring Mary Tyler Moore, made its debut on CBS.

In 1962 astronaut Wally Schirra blasted off from Cape Canaveral aboard the Sigma 7 on a nine-hour flight.

In 1967 Riverview, the North Side amusement park that entertained generations of Chicagoans, was shut down. Also in 1967 folk singer Woody Guthrie died; he was 55.

In 1974 Frank Robinson became major-league baseball's first Black manager as he was named to lead Cleveland.

In 1981 Irish nationalists at the Maze Prison near Belfast, Northern Ireland, ended seven months of hunger strikes that had claimed 10 lives.

In 1987 U.S. and Canadian negotiators agreed on a framework for an accord to eliminate all tariffs between the world's two largest trading partners.

In 1990 West Germany and East Germany ended 45 years of postwar division, declaring the creation of a new unified country.

In 1991 Arkansas Gov. Bill Clinton entered the race for the Democratic presidential nomination. Also in 1991 South African author Nadine Gordimer was named winner of the Nobel Prize in literature.

In 1995 the jury in the O.J. Simpson murder trial announced its verdicts, finding the former football star not guilty of the 1994 slayings of his former wife, Nicole Brown Simpson, and Ronald Goldman. (Simpson was later found liable in a civil trial.)

In 1996 Polish poet Wislawa Szymborska won the Nobel Prize in literature.

In 1997 Attorney General Janet Reno said Justice Department investigators had no evidence President Bill Clinton violated the law

with White House coffees and overnight stays for big contributors.

In 1998 Pope John Paul II beatified Cardinal Alojzije Stepinac, the World War II archbishop of Zagreb, a controversial figure because many Serbs and Jews had accused him of sympathizing with the Nazis.

In 2001 the Senate approved an agreement normalizing trade between the United States and Vietnam.

In 2002 five people were shot to death in the Washington area within a 14-hour period, beginning the hunt for the "Beltway Sniper."

In 2003 a tiger attacked magician Roy Horn of the duo Siegfried & Roy during a performance in Las Vegas, leaving the illusionist in critical condition.

In 2005 President George W. Bush nominated White House counsel Harriet Miers to the Supreme Court. (She withdrew three weeks later after criticism over her lack of judicial experience and Republican concerns about her conservatism.) Also in 2005 Australians Barry Marshall and Robin Warren won the 2005 Nobel Prize in physiology or medicine.

In 2008 O.J. Simpson was found guilty of robbing two sports-memorabilia dealers at gunpoint in a Las Vegas hotel room. (Simpson was later sentenced to nine to 33 years in prison; he was granted parole in July 2017 and released from prison on Oct. 1.)

In 2012 the Weather Channel announced it would start naming winter storms, a move that received a cool reception from meteorologists around the country.

Honor a Loved One with a Death Notice in Chicago Tribune

It's a final farewell; a sign of love and respect; an homage to a loved one's life. Placing a Death Notice shows you care, and is now more efficient than ever before with our **NEW Self-Service** tool.

Features of Self-Service

- Instant notice creation and review
- Real-time pricing
- Pre-designed templates
- Enhance your notice by uploading photos and graphics
- Immediate, printable proof of notice

Includes print listing in the **Death Notice section of the Chicago Tribune**, an online notice with guestbook on chicagotribune.com.

Chicago Tribune

Visit:
chicagotribune.com/deathnotice



A NEW WAY TO HONOR your loved ones.

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Chicago Tribune

Antiques & Collectibles

Buying ALL Baseball, Basketball, Football, and Hockey cards Pre 1980. Please call Shane @ 937-432-8941

Announcements

Former R&G Services Employees Please contact Derek Warnke if you worked at R&G Services located near Chicago, IL between 1971-1975. **314-437-0767**

Former WMS Industrie Employees Please contact Derek Warnke if you worked at WMS Industries Inc. located in Chicago, IL between 1975-1981. **314-437-0767**

Industrial Coating Employees Please contact Derek Warnke if you worked at Industrial Coatings Group Inc. located in Chicago, IL between 1982-1997 **314-437-0767**

Passed CISSP Exam Thank you St. Joseph of Cupertino for your intercession in helping pass the CISSP exam.

Shure Brothers Inc. Employees Please contact Derek Warnke if you worked at Shure Brothers located in Chicago/Evanston, IL between 1966-1971. **314-437-0767**

Assumed Name

Notice is hereby given, Pursuant to "An Act in relation to the use of an Assumed Business Name in the conduct or transaction of Business in the State" as amended, that a Certification was filed by the Undersigned with the County Clerk of Cook County.

File No. M26002014 on the Date: 07/15/2026

Under the Assumed Name of: **Andrick Counseling**

with the business located at: **55144 W Lawrence Ave, Chicago, IL**

The true name and residence Address of the owner is: **Jessica Andrick 4845 N Moody Ave, Chicago, IL 60630, USA**

Notice is hereby given, Pursuant to "An Act in relation to the use of an Assumed Business Name in the conduct or transaction of Business in the State" as amended, that a Certification was filed by the Undersigned with the County Clerk of Cook County.

File No. M26002057 on the Date: 10/01/2026

Under the Assumed Name of: **EM TREASURES CAPITAL**

with the business located at: **1700 N Keeler Chicago, IL 60639**

The true name and residence Address of the owner is: **Esau Martinez 1707 N Keeler Chicago, IL 60639**

Legal Notice

PUBLIC NOTICE

Notice of Filing of Evidence Pursuant to Order of the Illinois Commerce Commission

To Patrons of The Peoples Gas Light and Coke Company:

The Peoples Gas Light and Coke Company hereby gives notice to the public that it has filed with the Illinois Commerce Commission, pursuant to the Commission's order in Docket 25-0966, dated October 29, 2025, evidence relating to the reconciliation of revenues arising and costs recoverable under Rider EOA of its Schedule of Rates (Ill.C.C.No. 28) for Gas Service in Chicago, Illinois.

A copy of the filing may be inspected by any interested party at any business office of this Company.

All parties interested in this matter may obtain information with respect thereto either directly from this Company or by addressing the Chief Clerk of the Illinois Commerce Commission, 527 East Capitol Avenue, Springfield, Illinois 62701.

THE PEOPLES GAS LIGHT AND COKE COMPANY

By Theodore Eidukas
Vice President – Regulatory Affairs

9/26 & 10/3/26 148345

The Metropolitan Water Reclamation District of Greater Chicago is accepting applications for the following classification(s):

Treatment Plant Operator III (Promotional)

Application Filing Period: September 25, 2026 through October 9, 2026. **Examination Date:** October 22 & 23, 2026. **Location:** MWRD Main Office Building Annex, 111 East Erie Street, Chicago, IL. **Scope of Examination:** Knowledge of Treatment Plant Operator III practices. **Nature of Position and Duties:** Under general supervision, has responsibility for the control of the routine wastewater treatment process and the coordination of sewage pumping and disposal operations associated with this process at a wastewater treatment plant.

Salary: \$106,637.96 per year

Associate Structural Engineer (Original & Promotional)

Application Filing Period: September 25, 2026 through October 9, 2026. **Examination Date:** October 24, 2026. **Location:** To Be Announced. **Scope of Examination:** Knowledge of Associate Structural Engineer practices. **Nature of Position and Duties:** Under general supervision, performs ordinary structural engineering work in connection with the design of steel, wood and reinforced concrete structures. May supervise subordinate engineers and sub-professional personnel.

Salary: \$96,088.20 per year

Accounting Manager (Original & Promotional)

Application Filing Period: September 25, 2026 through October 9, 2026. **Examination Date:** November 6 & 7, 2026. **Location:** MWRD Main Office Building Annex, 111 East Erie Street, Chicago, IL. **Scope of Examination:** Knowledge of Accounting Manager practices. **Nature of Position and Duties:** Under general supervision, directs and coordinates professional and administrative staff in the performance of a variety of accounting and/or treasury activities which may include fund accounting, managerial accounting, auditing, report preparation, contract management, budget preparation, general ledger maintenance, payroll functions, accounts receivable functions, accounts payable functions, cash management and forecasting, bond sale execution and reporting requirements, interpretation and implementation of policies and legal requirements, and information systems management. **Salary:** \$133,602.82 per year

Applications can be submitted online only at www.districtjobs.org.

Additional information may be found at www.districtjobs.org or call 312-751-5100.

Mailed, Emailed, Hand delivered or Faxed Applications Will Not Be Accepted. Resumes Will Not Be Accepted In Place of Application Forms.

An Equal Opportunity Employer - M/F/D
9/25-10/9/2026 146037

Take Notice

TO: MONICA GORDON, COOK COUNTY CLERK; CHICAGO TITLE LAND TRUST COMPANY, SUCCESSOR TRUSTEE OF THE AMERICAN NATIONAL BANK AND TRUST COMPANY OF CHICAGO ATUTAD 6/3/1992 AKATIN 115625-01; JEROME DAVENPORT; CITY OF CHICAGO; MARION WALLACE; LATASHA MARIE SMITH; SHANINA BENTON; JACQUELINE PERKINS; JANA PERKINS; JAYNETTA M. L. MELTON; IJAHAD YASHUA PERKINS; ZAHID I. PERKINS; CAROLYN T. ROSCOE; KAYLA VALENZUELA; TAVION BICKART; VELMA ROBINSON; KIMBERLY NORWOOD; HENRY THIGPEN; KEESHA N. JONES; JAMES J. JONES. IN SAID ACTUAL OCCUPANCY OR POSSESSION OF SAID PROPERTY; UNKNOWN OCCUPANTS OR PARTIES INTERESTED IN SAID PROPERTY. TAX DEED NO. 2026COTD001957 FILED: 7/15/2026 TAKE NOTICE County of Cook Date Premises Sold or Forfeited: 1/1/2024 Certificate No.: 21-0004098 Sold or Forfeited for General Taxes of (year): 2021 Sold for Special Assessments of (Municipality) and Special assessment number: N/A Warrant No.: N/A Installment No.: N/A THIS PROPERTY HAS BEEN SOLD FOR DELINQUENT TAXES Property Address (as identified on the most recent tax bill, if available): 9041 S BUFFALO AVE, CHICAGO, IL 60617 C/K/A 9039-9041 S BUFFALO AVE, CHICAGO, IL 60617 Legal Description or Property Index No.: 16-05-109-15-0000 This notice is to advise you that the above property has been sold for delinquent taxes and that the period of redemption from the sale will expire on 1/8/2027. Check with the county clerk as to the exact amount you owe before redeeming. This notice is also to advise you that a petition has been filed for a tax deed which will transfer title and the right to possession of this property if redemption is not made on or before 1/8/2027. This matter is set for hearing in the Circuit Court of this County in Chicago, Illinois, on 1/27/2027 in Room 1704 of the Richard J. Daley Center at 50 W. Washington Street, Chicago, Illinois at 9:30 a.m. You may be present at this hearing but your right to redeem will already have expired at that time. YOU ARE URGED TO REDEEM IMMEDIATELY TO PREVENT LOSS OF PROPERTY. Redemption can be made at any time on or before 1/8/2027 by applying to the County Clerk of Cook County, Illinois, at the Office of the County Clerk in Chicago, Illinois. FOR FURTHER INFORMATION CONTACT THE COUNTY CLERK ADDRESS: 118 N. Clark Street, Room 434, Chicago, Illinois 60602 TELEPHONE AND/OR EMAIL ADDRESS: (312) 603-5645 – tax.redemption@cookcountyl.gov. MIDWESTERN INVESTORS LLC Purchaser or Assignee Dated: July 20, 2026 10/1, 10/2, 10/3/2026 140977

TO: MONICA GORDON, COOK COUNTY CLERK; QUENTEN J. WRIGHT; QUENTEN WRIGHT, JR.; JOSEPHINE CLAY; DELIAH BRIANNA SMITH; EVELYN NICOLE CLAY; PERSONS OR TENANTS IN ACTUAL OCCUPANCY OR POSSESSION OF SAID PROPERTY; UNKNOWN OCCUPANTS OR PARTIES INTERESTED IN SAID PROPERTY. TAX DEED NO. 2026COTD001955 FILED: 7/15/2026 TAKE NOTICE County of Cook Date Premises Sold or Forfeited: 1/1/2024 Certificate No.: 21-0004066 Sold or Forfeited for General Taxes of (year): 2021 Sold for Special Assessments of (Municipality) and special assessment number: N/A Warrant No.: N/A Installment No.: N/A THIS PROPERTY HAS BEEN SOLD FOR DELINQUENT TAXES Property Address (as identified on the most recent tax bill, if available): 11413 S SOUTH PARK AVE, CHICAGO, IL 60628 C/K/A 11413 S MARTIN LUTHER KING JR DR, CHICAGO, IL 60628 Legal Description or Property Index No.: 16-223-005-005-11413 S MARTIN LUTHER KING JR DR, CHICAGO, IL 60628 This notice is to advise you that the above property has been sold for delinquent taxes and that the period of redemption from the sale will expire on 1/8/2027. Check with the county clerk as to the exact amount you owe before redeeming. This notice is also to advise you that a petition has been filed for a tax deed which will transfer title and the right to possession of this property if redemption is not made on or before 1/8/2027. This matter is set for hearing in the Circuit Court of this County in Chicago, Illinois, on 1/27/2027 in Room 1704 of the Richard J. Daley Center at 50 W. Washington Street, Chicago, Illinois at 9:30 a.m. You may be present at this hearing but your right to redeem will already have expired at that time. YOU ARE URGED TO REDEEM IMMEDIATELY TO PREVENT LOSS OF PROPERTY. Redemption can be made at any time on or before 1/8/2027 by applying to the County Clerk of Cook County, Illinois, at the Office of the County Clerk in Chicago, Illinois. FOR FURTHER INFORMATION CONTACT THE COUNTY CLERK ADDRESS: 118 N. Clark Street, Room 434, Chicago, Illinois 60602 TELEPHONE AND/OR EMAIL ADDRESS: (312) 603-5645 – tax.redemption@cookcountyl.gov. MIDWESTERN INVESTORS LLC Purchaser or Assignee Dated: July 20, 2026 10/1, 10/2, 10/3/2026 140976

TO: MONICA GORDON, COOK COUNTY CLERK; QUENTEN J. WRIGHT; QUENTEN WRIGHT, JR.; JOSEPHINE CLAY; DELIAH BRIANNA SMITH; EVELYN NICOLE CLAY; PERSONS OR TENANTS IN ACTUAL OCCUPANCY OR POSSESSION OF SAID PROPERTY; UNKNOWN OCCUPANTS OR PARTIES INTERESTED IN SAID PROPERTY. TAX DEED NO. 2026COTD001955 FILED: 7/15/2026 TAKE NOTICE County of Cook Date Premises Sold or Forfeited: 1/1/2024 Certificate No.: 21-0004066 Sold or Forfeited for General Taxes of (year): 2021 Sold for Special Assessments of (Municipality) and special assessment number: N/A Warrant No.: N/A Installment No.: N/A THIS PROPERTY HAS BEEN SOLD FOR DELINQUENT TAXES Property Address (as identified on the most recent tax bill, if available): 11413 S SOUTH PARK AVE, CHICAGO, IL 60628 C/K/A 11413 S MARTIN LUTHER KING JR DR, CHICAGO, IL 60628 Legal Description or Property Index No.: 16-223-005-005-11413 S MARTIN LUTHER KING JR DR, CHICAGO, IL 60628 This notice is to advise you that the above property has been sold for delinquent taxes and that the period of redemption from the sale will expire on 1/8/2027. Check with the county clerk as to the exact amount you owe before redeeming. This notice is also to advise you that a petition has been filed for a tax deed which will transfer title and the right to possession of this property if redemption is not made on or before 1/8/2027. This matter is set for hearing in the Circuit Court of this County in Chicago, Illinois, on 1/27/2027 in Room 1704 of the Richard J. Daley Center at 50 W. Washington Street, Chicago, Illinois at 9:30 a.m. You may be present at this hearing but your right to redeem will already have expired at that time. YOU ARE URGED TO REDEEM IMMEDIATELY TO PREVENT LOSS OF PROPERTY. Redemption can be made at any time on or before 1/8/2027 by applying to the County Clerk of Cook County, Illinois, at the Office of the County Clerk in Chicago, Illinois. FOR FURTHER INFORMATION CONTACT THE COUNTY CLERK ADDRESS: 118 N. Clark Street, Room 434, Chicago, Illinois 60602 TELEPHONE AND/OR EMAIL ADDRESS: (312) 603-5645 – tax.redemption@cookcountyl.gov. MIDWESTERN INVESTORS LLC Purchaser or Assignee Dated: July 20, 2026 10/1, 10/2, 10/3/2026 140976

TO: MONICA GORDON, COOK COUNTY CLERK; VILLACO GROUP LLC; MIDLAND TRUST COMPANY AS CUSTODIAN FBO DOMINGO PLIEGO #17091597; CITY OF CHICAGO; CITY OF CHICAGO DEPARTMENT OF LAW; PERSONS OR TENANTS IN ACTUAL OCCUPANCY OR POSSESSION OF SAID PROPERTY; UNKNOWN OCCUPANTS OR PARTIES INTERESTED IN SAID PROPERTY. TAX DEED NO. 2026COTD001960 FILED: 7/15/2026 TAKE NOTICE County of Cook Date Premises Sold or Forfeited: 1/1/2024 Certificate No.: 21-0004796 Sold or Forfeited for General Taxes of (year): 2021 Sold for Special Assessments of (Municipality) and special assessment number: N/A Warrant No.: N/A Installment No.: N/A THIS PROPERTY HAS BEEN SOLD FOR DELINQUENT TAXES Property Address (as identified on the most recent tax bill, if available): 7036 S WASHTENAW AVE, CHICAGO, IL 60629 Legal Description or Property Index No.: 19-24-422-020-0000 This notice is to advise you that the above property has been sold for delinquent taxes and that the period of redemption from the sale will expire on 1/8/2027. Check with the county clerk as to the exact amount you owe before redeeming. This notice is also to advise you that a petition has been filed for a tax deed which will transfer title and the right to possession of this property if redemption is not made on or before 1/8/2027. This matter is set for hearing in the Circuit Court of this County in Chicago, Illinois, on 1/27/2027 in Room 1704 of the Richard J. Daley Center at 50 W. Washington Street, Chicago, Illinois at 9:30 a.m. You may be present at this hearing but your right to redeem will already have expired at that time. YOU ARE URGED TO REDEEM IMMEDIATELY TO PREVENT LOSS OF PROPERTY. Redemption can be made at any time on or before 1/8/2027 by applying to the County Clerk of Cook County, Illinois, at the Office of the County Clerk in Chicago, Illinois. FOR FURTHER INFORMATION CONTACT THE COUNTY CLERK ADDRESS: 118 N. Clark Street, Room 434, Chicago, Illinois 60602 TELEPHONE AND/OR EMAIL ADDRESS: (312) 603-5645 – tax.redemption@cookcountyl.gov. MIDWESTERN INVESTORS LLC Purchaser or Assignee Dated: July 20, 2026 10/1, 10/2, 10/3/2026 140976

TO: MONICA GORDON, COOK COUNTY CLERK; VILLACO GROUP LLC; MIDLAND TRUST COMPANY AS CUSTODIAN FBO DOMINGO PLIEGO #17091597; CITY OF CHICAGO; CITY OF CHICAGO DEPARTMENT OF LAW; PERSONS OR TENANTS IN ACTUAL OCCUPANCY OR POSSESSION OF SAID PROPERTY; UNKNOWN OCCUPANTS OR PARTIES INTERESTED IN SAID PROPERTY. TAX DEED NO. 2026COTD001960 FILED: 7/15/2026 TAKE NOTICE County of Cook Date Premises Sold or Forfeited: 1/1/2024 Certificate No.: 21-0004796 Sold or Forfeited for General Taxes of (year): 2021 Sold for Special Assessments of (Municipality) and special assessment number: N/A Warrant No.: N/A Installment No.: N/A THIS PROPERTY HAS BEEN SOLD FOR DELINQUENT TAXES Property Address (as identified on the most recent tax bill, if available): 7036 S WASHTENAW AVE, CHICAGO, IL 60629 Legal Description or Property Index No.: 19-24-422-020-0000 This notice is to advise you that the above property has been sold for delinquent taxes and that the period of redemption from the sale will expire on 1/8/2027. Check with the county clerk as to the exact amount you owe before redeeming. This notice is also to advise you that a petition has been filed for a tax deed which will transfer title and the right to possession of this property if redemption is not made on or before 1/8/2027. This matter is set for hearing in the Circuit Court of this County in Chicago, Illinois, on 1/27/2027 in Room 1704 of the Richard J. Daley Center at 50 W. Washington Street, Chicago, Illinois at 9:30 a.m. You may be present at this hearing but your right to redeem will already have expired at that time. YOU ARE URGED TO REDEEM IMMEDIATELY TO PREVENT LOSS OF PROPERTY. Redemption can be made at any time on or before 1/8/2027 by applying to the County Clerk of Cook County, Illinois, at the Office of the County Clerk in Chicago, Illinois. FOR FURTHER INFORMATION CONTACT THE COUNTY CLERK ADDRESS: 118 N. Clark Street, Room 434, Chicago, Illinois 60602 TELEPHONE AND/OR EMAIL ADDRESS: (312) 603-5645 – tax.redemption@cookcountyl.gov. MIDWESTERN INVESTORS LLC Purchaser or Assignee Dated: July 20, 2026 10/1, 10/2, 10/3/2026 140976

TO: MONICA GORDON, COOK COUNTY CLERK; MOSHE TAMSSOT; BLOCK X CONDOMINIUM ASSOCIATION; ISAAC TAMSSOT; TERRY DIHERTY; PERSONS OR TENANTS IN ACTUAL OCCUPANCY OR POSSESSION OF SAID PROPERTY; UNKNOWN OCCUPANTS OR PARTIES INTERESTED IN SAID PROPERTY. TAX DEED NO. 2026COTD002029 FILED: 7/15/2026 TAKE NOTICE County of Cook Date Premises Sold or Forfeited: 1/1/2024 Certificate No.: 21-0007319 Sold or Forfeited for General Taxes of (year): 2021 Sold for Special Assessments of (Municipality) and special assessment number: N/A Warrant No.: N/A Installment No.: N/A THIS PROPERTY HAS BEEN SOLD FOR DELINQUENT TAXES Property Address (as identified on the most recent tax bill, if available): 16 N MAY ST, CHICAGO, IL 60607 C/K/A 16 N MAY ST, UNIT 508, CHICAGO, IL 60607 Legal Description or Property Index No.: 17-08-443-042-109 This notice is to advise you that the above property has been sold for delinquent taxes and that the period of redemption from the sale will expire on 1/8/2027. Check with the county clerk as to the exact amount you owe before redeeming. This notice is also to advise you that a petition has been filed for a tax deed which will transfer title and the right to possession of this property if redemption is not made on or before 1/8/2027. This matter is set for hearing in the Circuit Court of this County in Chicago, Illinois, on 1/27/2027 in Room 1704 of the Richard J. Daley Center at 50 W. Washington Street, Chicago, Illinois at 9:30 a.m. You may be present at this hearing but your right to redeem will already have expired at that time. YOU ARE URGED TO REDEEM IMMEDIATELY TO PREVENT LOSS OF PROPERTY. Redemption can be made at any time on or before 1/8/2027 by applying to the County Clerk of Cook County, Illinois, at the Office of the County Clerk in Chicago, Illinois. FOR FURTHER INFORMATION CONTACT THE COUNTY CLERK ADDRESS: 118 N. Clark Street, Room 434, Chicago, Illinois 60602 TELEPHONE AND/OR EMAIL ADDRESS: (312) 603-5645 – tax.redemption@cookcountyl.gov. MIDWESTERN INVESTORS LLC Purchaser or Assignee Dated: July 20, 2026 10/1, 10/2, 10/3/2026 140969

TO: MONICA GORDON, COOK COUNTY CLERK; MOSHE TAMSSOT; BLOCK X CONDOMINIUM ASSOCIATION; ISAAC TAMSSOT; TERRY DIHERTY; PERSONS OR TENANTS IN ACTUAL OCCUPANCY OR POSSESSION OF SAID PROPERTY; UNKNOWN OCCUPANTS OR PARTIES INTERESTED IN SAID PROPERTY. TAX DEED NO. 2026COTD002029 FILED: 7/15/2026 TAKE NOTICE County of Cook Date Premises Sold or Forfeited: 1/1/2024 Certificate No.: 21-0007319 Sold or Forfeited for General Taxes of (year): 2021 Sold for Special Assessments of (Municipality) and special assessment number: N/A Warrant No.: N/A Installment No.: N/A THIS PROPERTY HAS BEEN SOLD FOR DELINQUENT TAXES Property Address (as identified on the most recent tax bill, if available): 16 N MAY ST, CHICAGO, IL 60607 C/K/A 16 N MAY ST, UNIT 508, CHICAGO, IL 60607 Legal Description or Property Index No.: 17-08-443-042-109 This notice is to advise you that the above property has been sold for delinquent taxes and that the period of redemption from the sale will expire on 1/8/2027. Check with the county clerk as to the exact amount you owe before redeeming. This notice is also to advise you that a petition has been filed for a tax deed which will transfer title and the right to possession of this property if redemption is not made on or before 1/8/2027. This matter is set for hearing in the Circuit Court of this County in Chicago, Illinois, on 1/27/2027 in Room 1704 of the Richard J. Daley Center at 50 W. Washington Street, Chicago, Illinois at 9:30 a.m. You may be present at this hearing but your right to redeem will already have expired at that time. YOU ARE URGED TO REDEEM IMMEDIATELY TO PREVENT LOSS OF PROPERTY. Redemption can be made at any time on or before 1/8/2027 by applying to the County Clerk of Cook County, Illinois, at the Office of the County Clerk in Chicago, Illinois. FOR FURTHER INFORMATION CONTACT THE COUNTY CLERK ADDRESS: 118 N. Clark Street, Room 434, Chicago, Illinois 60602 TELEPHONE AND/OR EMAIL ADDRESS: (312) 603-5645 – tax.redemption@cookcountyl.gov. MIDWESTERN INVESTORS LLC Purchaser or Assignee Dated: July 20, 2026 10/1, 10/2, 10/3/2026 140969

Take Notice

TO: MONICA GORDON, COOK COUNTY CLERK; JOSEPHINE B. ADILLA; CITY OF SEAGRAM; C/O ASHMAN & STEIN, P.C. (IN RE: MARIA L. RUVALCABA TRUST DATED 7/21/1999; JUAN F. RUVALCABA JR. AS SUCCESSOR TRUSTEE OF THE MARIA L. RUVALCABA TRUST DATED 7/21/1999; ERNESTINA RUVALCABA, AS SUCCESSOR TRUSTEE OF THE MARIA L. RUVALCABA TRUST DATED 7/21/1999; JOSE L. RUVALCABA, AS SUCCESSOR TRUSTEE OF THE MARIA L. RUVALCABA TRUST DATED 7/21/1999; ROSE GARZA, AS SUCCESSOR TRUSTEE OF THE MARIA L. RUVALCABA TRUST DATED 7/21/1999; CITY OF CHICAGO; CITY OF CHICAGO DEPARTMENT OF LAW; PERSONS OR TENANTS IN ACTUAL OCCUPANCY OR POSSESSION OF SAID PROPERTY; UNKNOWN OCCUPANTS OR PARTIES INTERESTED IN SAID PROPERTY. TAX DEED NO. 2026COTD002032 FILED: 7/15/2026 TAKE NOTICE County of Cook Date Premises Sold or Forfeited: 1/21/2024 Certificate No.: 21-0007717 and 21-0007718 Sold or Forfeited for General Taxes of (year): 2021 Sold for Special Assessments of (Municipality) and special assessment number: N/A Warrant No.: N/A Installment No.: N/A THIS PROPERTY HAS BEEN SOLD FOR DELINQUENT TAXES Property Address (as identified on the most recent tax bill, if available): 2655 S HARDING AVE, CHICAGO, IL 60623 Legal Description or Property Index No.: 16-26-301-021-0000 This notice is to advise you that the above property has been sold for delinquent taxes and that the period of redemption from the sale will expire on 1/8/2027. Check with the county clerk as to the exact amount you owe before redeeming. This notice is also to advise you that a petition has been filed for a tax deed which will transfer title and the right to possession of this property if redemption is not made on or before 1/8/2027. This matter is set for hearing in the Circuit Court of this County in Chicago, Illinois, on 1/27/2027 in Room 1704 of the Richard J. Daley Center at 50 W. Washington Street, Chicago, Illinois at 9:30 a.m. You may be present at this hearing but your right to redeem will already have expired at that time. YOU ARE URGED TO REDEEM IMMEDIATELY TO PREVENT LOSS OF PROPERTY. Redemption can be made at any time on or before 1/8/2027 by applying to the County Clerk of Cook County, Illinois, at the Office of the County Clerk in Chicago, Illinois. FOR FURTHER INFORMATION CONTACT THE COUNTY CLERK ADDRESS: 118 N. Clark Street, Room 434, Chicago, Illinois 60602 TELEPHONE AND/OR EMAIL ADDRESS: (312) 603-5645 – tax.redemption@cookcountyl.gov. MIDWESTERN INVESTORS LLC Purchaser or Assignee Dated: July 20, 2026 10/1, 10/2, 10/3/2026 140964

TO: MONICA GORDON, COOK COUNTY CLERK; GONZALO RODRIGUEZ; ILLINOIS DEPARTMENT OF REVENUE; ILLINOIS ATTORNEY GENERAL; JOSEPHINE VIANYEY RODRIGUEZ; ZEFERINO FLORES; FRANCISCA RODRIGUEZ; LUANNA; UNKNOWN HEIRS AND LEGATEES OF GONZALO RODRIGUEZ; UNKNOWN HEIRS AND LEGATEES OF FRANCISCA RODRIGUEZ; PERSONS OR TENANTS IN ACTUAL OCCUPANCY OR POSSESSION OF SAID PROPERTY; UNKNOWN OCCUPANTS OR PARTIES INTERESTED IN SAID PROPERTY. TAX DEED NO. 2026COTD002022 FILED: 7/15/2026 TAKE NOTICE County of Cook Date Premises Sold or Forfeited: 1/1/2024 Certificate No.: 21-0007176 Sold or Forfeited for General Taxes of (year): 2021 Sold for Special Assessments of (Municipality) and special assessment number: N/A Warrant No.: N/A Installment No.: N/A THIS PROPERTY HAS BEEN SOLD FOR DELINQUENT TAXES Property Address (as identified on the most recent tax bill, if available): 2432 S RIDGEWAY AVE, CHICAGO, IL 60623 Legal Description or Property Index No.: 16-26-114-032-0000 This notice is to advise you that the above property has been sold for delinquent taxes and that the period of redemption from the sale will expire on 1/8/2027. Check with the county clerk as to the exact amount you owe before redeeming. This notice is also to advise you that a petition has been filed for a tax deed which will transfer title and the right to possession of this property if redemption is not made on or before 1/8/2027. This matter is set for hearing in the Circuit Court of this County in Chicago, Illinois, on 1/27/2027 in Room 1704 of the Richard J. Daley Center at 50 W. Washington Street, Chicago, Illinois at 9:30 a.m. You may be present at this hearing but your right to redeem will already have expired at that time. YOU ARE URGED TO REDEEM IMMEDIATELY TO PREVENT LOSS OF PROPERTY. Redemption can be made at any time on or before 1/8/2027 by applying to the County Clerk of Cook County, Illinois, at the Office of the County Clerk in Chicago, Illinois. FOR FURTHER INFORMATION CONTACT THE COUNTY CLERK ADDRESS: 118 N. Clark Street, Room 434, Chicago, Illinois 60602 TELEPHONE AND/OR EMAIL ADDRESS: (312) 603-5645 – tax.redemption@cookcountyl.gov. MIDWESTERN INVESTORS LLC Purchaser or Assignee Dated: July 20, 2026 10/1, 10/2, 10/3/2026 140963

TO: MONICA GORDON, COOK COUNTY CLERK; JUAN JOSE HERNANDEZ; CITY OF CHICAGO; CITY OF CHICAGO DEPARTMENT OF LAW; FARM CREDIT SERVICES OF AMERICA; PERSONS OR TENANTS IN ACTUAL OCCUPANCY OR POSSESSION OF SAID PROPERTY; UNKNOWN OCCUPANTS OR PARTIES INTERESTED IN SAID PROPERTY. TAX DEED NO. 2026COTD002019 FILED: 7/15/2026 TAKE NOTICE County of Cook Date Premises Sold or Forfeited: 1/1/2024 Certificate No.: 21-0007152 Sold or Forfeited for General Taxes of (year): 2021 Sold for Special Assessments of (Municipality) and special assessment number: N/A Warrant No.: N/A Installment No.: N/A THIS PROPERTY HAS BEEN SOLD FOR DELINQUENT TAXES Property Address (as identified on the most recent tax bill, if available): 2116 S FAIRVIEW AVE, CHICAGO, IL 60608 Legal Description or Property Index No.: 16-24-421-021-0000 This notice is to advise you that the above property has been sold for delinquent taxes and that the period of redemption from the sale will expire on 1/8/2027. Check with the county clerk as to the exact amount you owe before redeeming. This notice is also to advise you that a petition has been filed for a tax deed which will transfer title and the right to possession of this property if redemption is not made on or before 1/8/2027. This matter is set for hearing in the Circuit Court of this County in Chicago, Illinois, on 1/27/2027 in Room 1704 of the Richard J. Daley Center at 50 W. Washington Street, Chicago, Illinois at 9:30 a.m. You may be present at this hearing but your right to redeem will already have expired at that time. YOU ARE URGED TO REDEEM IMMEDIATELY TO PREVENT LOSS OF PROPERTY. Redemption can be made at any time on or before 1/8/2027 by applying to the County Clerk of Cook County, Illinois, at the Office of the County Clerk in Chicago, Illinois. FOR FURTHER INFORMATION CONTACT THE COUNTY CLERK ADDRESS: 118 N. Clark Street, Room 434, Chicago, Illinois 60602 TELEPHONE AND/OR EMAIL ADDRESS: (312) 603-5645 – tax.redemption@cookcountyl.gov. MIDWESTERN INVESTORS LLC Purchaser or Assignee Dated: July 20, 2026 10/1, 10/2, 10/3/2026 140958

TO: MONICA GORDON, COOK COUNTY CLERK; JANE J. BUREN; CITY OF CHICAGO; CITY OF CHICAGO DEPARTMENT OF LAW; FARM CREDIT SERVICES OF AMERICA; PERSONS OR TENANTS IN ACTUAL OCCUPANCY OR POSSESSION OF SAID PROPERTY; UNKNOWN OCCUPANTS OR PARTIES INTERESTED IN SAID PROPERTY. TAX DEED NO. 2026COTD002019 FILED: 7/15/2026 TAKE NOTICE County of Cook Date Premises Sold or Forfeited: 1/1/2024 Certificate No.: 21-0007152 Sold or Forfeited for General Taxes of (year): 2021 Sold for Special Assessments of (Municipality) and special assessment number: N/A Warrant No.: N/A Installment No.: N/A THIS PROPERTY HAS BEEN SOLD FOR DELINQUENT TAXES Property Address (as identified on the most recent tax bill, if available): 2116 S FAIRVIEW AVE, CHICAGO, IL 60608 Legal Description or Property Index No.: 16-24-421-021-0000 This notice is to advise you that the above property has been sold for delinquent taxes and that the period of redemption from the sale will expire on 1/8/2027. Check with the county clerk as to the exact amount you owe before redeeming. This notice is also to advise you that a petition has been filed for a tax deed which will transfer title and the right to possession of this property if redemption is not made on or before 1/8/2027. This matter is set for hearing in the Circuit Court of this County in Chicago, Illinois, on 1/27/2027 in Room 1704 of the Richard J. Daley Center at 50 W. Washington Street, Chicago, Illinois at 9:30 a.m. You may be present at this hearing but your right to redeem will already have expired at that time. YOU ARE URGED TO REDEEM IMMEDIATELY TO PREVENT LOSS OF PROPERTY. Redemption can be made at any time on or before 1/8/2027 by applying to the County Clerk of Cook County, Illinois, at the Office of the County Clerk in Chicago, Illinois. FOR FURTHER INFORMATION CONTACT THE COUNTY CLERK ADDRESS: 118 N. Clark Street, Room 434, Chicago, Illinois 60602 TELEPHONE AND/OR EMAIL ADDRESS: (312) 603-5645 – tax.redemption@cookcountyl.gov. MIDWESTERN INVESTORS LLC Purchaser or Assignee Dated: July 20, 2026 10/1, 10/2, 10/3/2026 140958

TO: MONICA GORDON, COOK COUNTY CLERK; DIANE DG REALTY, LLC; CITY OF CHICAGO; DIANE GOTTILIEB; AARON CRAIG; PERSONS OR TENANTS IN ACTUAL OCCUPANCY OR POSSESSION OF SAID PROPERTY; UNKNOWN OCCUPANTS OR PARTIES INTERESTED IN SAID PROPERTY. TAX DEED NO. 2026COTD002017 FILED: 7/15/2026 TAKE NOTICE County of Cook Date Premises Sold or Forfeited: 1/1/2024 Certificate No.: 21-0006626 Sold or Forfeited for General Taxes of (year): 2021 Sold for Special Assessments of (Municipality) and special assessment number: N/A Warrant No.: N/A Installment No.: N/A THIS PROPERTY HAS BEEN SOLD FOR DELINQUENT TAXES Property Address (as identified on the most recent tax bill, if available): 10612 S SPRINGFIELD AVE, CHICAGO, IL 60651 Legal Description or Property Index No.: 16-02-310-024-0000 This notice is to advise you that the above property has been sold for delinquent taxes and that the period of redemption from the sale will expire on 1/8/2027. Check with the county clerk as to the exact amount you owe before redeeming. This notice is also to advise you that a petition has been filed for a tax deed which will transfer title and the right to possession of this property if redemption is not made on or before 1/8/2027. This matter is set for hearing in the Circuit Court of this County in Chicago, Illinois, on 1/27/2027 in Room 1704 of the Richard J. Daley Center at 50 W. Washington Street, Chicago, Illinois at 9:30 a.m. You may be present at this hearing but your right to redeem will already have expired at that time. YOU ARE URGED TO REDEEM IMMEDIATELY TO PREVENT LOSS OF PROPERTY. Redemption can be made at any time on or before 1/8/2027 by applying to the County Clerk of Cook County, Illinois, at the Office of the County Clerk in Chicago, Illinois. FOR FURTHER INFORMATION CONTACT THE COUNTY CLERK ADDRESS: 118 N. Clark Street, Room 434, Chicago, Illinois 60602 TELEPHONE AND/OR EMAIL ADDRESS: (312) 603-5645 – tax.redemption@cookcountyl.gov. MIDWESTERN INVESTORS LLC Purchaser or Assignee Dated: July 20, 2026 10/1, 10/2, 10/3/2026 140956

TO: MONICA GORDON, COOK COUNTY CLERK; DIANE DG REALTY, LLC; CITY OF CHICAGO; DIANE GOTTILIEB; AARON CRAIG; PERSONS OR TENANTS IN ACTUAL OCCUPANCY OR POSSESSION OF SAID PROPERTY; UNKNOWN OCCUPANTS OR PARTIES INTERESTED IN SAID PROPERTY. TAX DEED NO. 2026COTD002017 FILED: 7/15/2026 TAKE NOTICE County of Cook Date Premises Sold or Forfeited: 1/1/2024 Certificate No.: 21-0006626 Sold or Forfeited for General Taxes of (year): 2021 Sold for Special Assessments of (Municipality) and special assessment number: N/A Warrant No.: N/A Installment No.: N/A THIS PROPERTY HAS BEEN SOLD FOR DELINQUENT TAXES Property Address (as identified on the most recent tax bill, if available): 10612 S SPRINGFIELD AVE, CHICAGO, IL 60651 Legal Description or Property Index No.: 16-02-310-024-0000 This notice is to advise you that the above property has been sold for delinquent taxes and that the period of redemption from the sale will expire on 1/8/2027. Check with the county clerk as to the exact amount you owe before redeeming. This notice is also to advise you that a petition has been filed for a tax deed which will transfer title and the right to possession of this property if redemption is not made on or before 1/8/2027. This matter is set for hearing in the Circuit Court of this County in Chicago, Illinois, on 1/27/2027 in Room 1704 of the Richard J. Daley Center at 50 W. Washington Street, Chicago, Illinois at 9:30 a.m. You may be present at this hearing but your right to redeem will already have expired at that time. YOU ARE URGED TO REDEEM IMMEDIATELY TO PREVENT LOSS OF PROPERTY. Redemption can be made at any time on or before 1/8/2027 by applying to the County Clerk of Cook County, Illinois, at the Office of the County Clerk in Chicago, Illinois. FOR FURTHER INFORMATION CONTACT THE COUNTY CLERK ADDRESS: 118 N. Clark Street, Room 434, Chicago, Illinois 60602 TELEPHONE AND/OR EMAIL ADDRESS: (312) 603-5645 – tax.redemption@cookcountyl.gov. MIDWESTERN INVESTORS LLC Purchaser or Assignee Dated: July 20, 2026 10/1, 10/2, 10/3/2026 140956

GARAGE SALES

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Take Notice

TO: MONICA GORDON, COOK COUNTY CLERK; ESTATE OF MARIA L. RUVALCABA; UNKNOWN SUCCESSOR TRUSTEE OF THE MARIA L. RUVALCABA TRUST DATED 7/21/1999; JUAN F. RUVALCABA JR. AS SUCCESSOR TRUSTEE OF THE MARIA L. RUVALCABA TRUST DATED 7/21/1999; ERNESTINA RUVALCABA, AS SUCCESSOR TRUSTEE OF THE MARIA L. RUVALCABA TRUST DATED 7/21/1999; JOSE L. RUVALCABA, AS SUCCESSOR TRUSTEE OF THE MARIA L. RUVALCABA TRUST DATED 7/21/1999; ROSE GARZA, AS SUCCESSOR TRUSTEE OF THE MARIA L. RUVALCABA TRUST DATED 7/21/1999; CITY OF CHICAGO; CITY OF CHICAGO DEPARTMENT OF LAW; PERSONS OR TENANTS IN ACTUAL OCCUPANCY OR POSSESSION OF SAID PROPERTY; UNKNOWN OCCUPANTS OR PARTIES INTERESTED IN SAID PROPERTY. TAX DEED NO. 2026COTD002032 FILED: 7/15/2026 TAKE NOTICE County of Cook Date Premises Sold or Forfeited: 1/21/2024 Certificate No.: 21-0007717 and 21-0007718 Sold or Forfeited for General Taxes of (year): 2021 Sold for Special Assessments of (Municipality) and special assessment number: N/A Warrant No.: N/A Installment No.: N/A THIS PROPERTY HAS BEEN SOLD FOR DELINQUENT TAXES Property Address (as identified on the most recent tax bill, if available): 2917 S ARCHER AVE, CHICAGO, IL 60608 AND 2919 S ARCHER AVE, CHICAGO, IL 60608 Legal Description or Property Index No.: 17-29-326-003-0000 AND 17-29-326-003-003-0000 This notice is to advise you that the above property has been sold for delinquent taxes and that the period of redemption from the sale will expire on 1/8/2027. Check with the county clerk as to the exact amount you owe before redeeming. This notice is also to advise you that a petition has been filed for a tax deed which will transfer title and the right to possession of this property if redemption is not made on or before 1/8/2027. This matter is set for hearing in the Circuit Court of this County in Chicago, Illinois, on 1/27/2027 in Room 1704 of the Richard J. Daley Center at 50 W. Washington Street, Chicago, Illinois at 9:30 a.m. You may be present at this hearing but your right to redeem will already have expired at that time. YOU ARE URGED TO REDEEM IMMEDIATELY TO PREVENT LOSS OF PROPERTY. Redemption can be made at any time on or before 1/8/2027 by applying to the County Clerk of Cook County, Illinois, at the Office of the County Clerk in Chicago, Illinois. FOR FURTHER INFORMATION CONTACT THE COUNTY CLERK ADDRESS: 118 N. Clark Street, Room 434, Chicago, Illinois 60602 TELEPHONE AND/OR EMAIL ADDRESS: (312) 603-5645 – tax.redemption@cookcountyl.gov. MIDWESTERN INVESTORS LLC Purchaser or Assignee Dated: July 20, 2026 10/1, 10/2, 10/3/2026 140951

TO: MONICA GORDON, COOK COUNTY CLERK; MONICA BLAIGIS A/K/A MONICA A. BLAIGIS; THE OPERA LOFTS CONDOMINIUM ASSOCIATION, INC.; PERSONS OR TENANTS IN ACTUAL OCCUPANCY OR POSSESSION OF SAID PROPERTY; UNKNOWN OCCUPANTS OR PARTIES INTERESTED IN SAID PROPERTY. TAX DEED NO. 2026COTD002028 FILED: 7/15/2026 TAKE NOTICE County of Cook Date Premises Sold or Forfeited

Take Notice

TO: MONICA GORDON COOK COUNTY CLERK; BRIDGETTE A. GLUCKMAN; WASHINGTON PARK CONDOMINIUM ASSOCIATION; ASMC SERVICING, LTD.; CITY OF CHICAGO; PERSONS OR TENANTS IN ACTUAL OCCUPANCY OR POSSESSION OF SAID PROPERTY; UNKNOWN OCCUPANTS OR PARTIES INTERESTED IN SAID PROPERTY; TAX DEED NO. 2026COTD001943 FILED: 7/15/2026TAKE NOTICECounty of CookDate Premises Sold or Forfeited: 1/10/2024Certificate No.: 21-0003141Sold or Forfeited for General Taxes of (year): 2021Sold for Special Assessments of (Municipality)and special assessment number: N/AWarrant No.: N/A Installment No.: N/A THIS PROPERTY HAS BEEN SOLD FOR DELINQUENT TAXESProperty Address (as identified on the most recent tax bill, if available): 5140 S KING DR, CHICAGO, IL 60615 C/K/A 5140 S MARTIN LUTHER KING JR DR, UNIT A1, CHICAGO, IL 60615Legal Description or Property Index No.: 20-10-306-069-1001This notice is to advise you that the above property has been sold for delinquent taxes and that the period of redemption from the sale will expire on 1/8/2027. Check with the county clerk as to the exact amount you owe before redeeming. This notice is also to advise you that a petition has been filed for a tax deed which will transfer title and the right to possession of this property if redemption is not made on or before 1/8/2027. This matter is set for hearing in the Circuit Court of this County in Chicago, Illinois, on 1/27/2027 in Room 1704 of the Richard J. Daley Center at 50 W. Washington Street, Chicago, Illinois at 9:30 a.m. You may be present at this hearing but your right to redeem will already have expired at that time. YOU ARE URGED TO REDEEM IMMEDIATELY TO PREVENT LOSS OF PROPERTY. Redemption can be made at any time on or before 1/8/2027 by applying to the County Clerk of Cook County, Illinois, at the Office of the County Clerk in Chicago, Illinois. FOR FURTHER INFORMATION CONTACT THE COUNTY CLERK ADDRESS: 118 N. Clark Street, Room 434, Chicago, Illinois 60602 TELEPHONE AND/OR EMAIL ADDRESS: (312) 603-5645 - tax.redemption@cookcountyil.gov MIDWESTERN INVESTORS LLC Purchaser or Assignee Dated: July 20, 2026 10/1, 10/2, 10/3/2026 140828

TO: MONICA GORDON COOK COUNTY CLERK; MARIA ISABEL DIAZ NIETO; 4141-45 WEST 93RD PLACE CONDOMINIUM ASSOCIATION; PERSONS OR TENANTS IN ACTUAL OCCUPANCY OR POSSESSION OF SAID PROPERTY; UNKNOWN OCCUPANTS OR PARTIES INTERESTED IN SAID PROPERTY; TAX DEED NO. 2026COTD001943 FILED: 7/15/2026TAKE NOTICECounty of CookDate Premises Sold or Forfeited: 1/10/2024Certificate No.: 21-0002872Sold or Forfeited for General Taxes of (year): 2021Sold for Special Assessments of (Municipality)and special assessment number: N/AWarrant No.: N/A Installment No.: N/A THIS PROPERTY HAS BEEN SOLD FOR DELINQUENT TAXESProperty Address (as identified on the most recent tax bill, if available): 4141 93RD PL, OAK LAWN, IL 60453 C/K/A 4141 W 93RD PL, UNIT G-1-E, OAK LAWN, IL 60453Legal Description or Property Index No.: 24-03-410-015-1010This notice is to advise you that the above property has been sold for delinquent taxes and that the period of redemption from the sale will expire on 1/8/2027. Check with the county clerk as to the exact amount you owe before redeeming. This notice is also to advise you that a petition has been filed for a tax deed which will transfer title and the right to possession of this property if redemption is not made on or before 1/8/2027. This matter is set for hearing in the Circuit Court of this County in Chicago, Illinois, on 1/27/2027 in Room 1704 of the Richard J. Daley Center at 50 W. Washington Street, Chicago, Illinois at 9:30 a.m. You may be present at this hearing but your right to redeem will already have expired at that time. YOU ARE URGED TO REDEEM IMMEDIATELY TO PREVENT LOSS OF PROPERTY. Redemption can be made at any time on or before 1/8/2027 by applying to the County Clerk of Cook County, Illinois, at the Office of the County Clerk in Chicago, Illinois. FOR FURTHER INFORMATION CONTACT THE COUNTY CLERK ADDRESS: 118 N. Clark Street, Room 434, Chicago, Illinois 60602 TELEPHONE AND/OR EMAIL ADDRESS: (312) 603-5645 - tax.redemption@cookcountyil.gov MIDWESTERN INVESTORS LLC Purchaser or Assignee Dated: July 20, 2026 10/1, 10/2, 10/3/2026 140826

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Take Notice

TO: MONICA GORDON COOK COUNTY CLERK; SASO ANGELOVICK; THE HUNTINGTON NATIONAL BANK; VILLAGE CENTRE CONDOMINIUM ASSOCIATION; REGIONS BANK DBA ASCENTUM CAPITAL; ELENA KOSTIK; PERSONS OR TENANTS IN ACTUAL OCCUPANCY OR POSSESSION OF SAID PROPERTY; UNKNOWN OCCUPANTS OR PARTIES INTERESTED IN SAID PROPERTY; TAX DEED NO. 2026COTD001933 FILED: 7/15/2026 TAKE NOTICE County of Cook Date Premises Sold or Forfeited: 1/9/2024 Certificate No.: 21-0001144. Sold or Forfeited for General Taxes of (year): 2021 Sold for Special Assessments of (Municipality)and special assessment number: N/AWarrant No.: N/A Installment No.: N/A THIS PROPERTY HAS BEEN SOLD FOR DELINQUENT TAXES Property Address (as identified on the most recent tax bill, if available): 6950 WOLF RD, INDIAN HEAD PARK, IL 60525 C/K/A 6950 WOLF RD, UNIT 202, INDIAN HEAD PARK, IL 60525 Legal Description or Property Index No.: 18-19-403-019-1005 This notice is to advise you that the above property has been sold for delinquent taxes and that the period of redemption from the sale will expire on 1/8/2027. Check with the county clerk as to the exact amount you owe before redeeming. This notice is also to advise you that a petition has been filed for a tax deed which will transfer title and the right to possession of this property if redemption is not made on or before 1/8/2027. This matter is set for hearing in the Circuit Court of this County in Chicago, Illinois, on 1/27/2027 in Room 1704 of the Richard J. Daley Center at 50 W. Washington Street, Chicago, Illinois at 9:30 a.m. You may be present at this hearing but your right to redeem will already have expired at that time. YOU ARE URGED TO REDEEM IMMEDIATELY TO PREVENT LOSS OF PROPERTY. Redemption can be made at any time on or before 1/8/2027 by applying to the County Clerk of Cook County, Illinois, at the Office of the County Clerk in Chicago, Illinois. FOR FURTHER INFORMATION CONTACT THE COUNTY CLERK ADDRESS: 118 N. Clark Street, Room 434, Chicago, Illinois 60602 TELEPHONE AND/OR EMAIL ADDRESS: (312) 603-5645 - tax.redemption@cookcountyil.gov MIDWESTERN INVESTORS LLC Purchaser or Assignee Dated: July 20, 2026 10/1, 10/2, 10/3/2026 140818

TO: MONICA GORDON COOK COUNTY CLERK; CATHERINE CAMPAGNA A/K/A CATHERINE F. CAMPAGNA; PERSONS OR TENANTS IN ACTUAL OCCUPANCY OR POSSESSION OF SAID PROPERTY; UNKNOWN OCCUPANTS OR PARTIES INTERESTED IN SAID PROPERTY; TAX DEED NO. 2026COTD001930 FILED: 7/15/2026 TAKE NOTICE County of Cook Date Premises Sold or Forfeited: 1/9/2024 Certificate No.: 21-0000976 Sold or Forfeited for General Taxes of (year): 2021Sold for Special Assessments of (Municipality)and special assessment number: N/A Warrant No.: N/A Installment No.: N/A THIS PROPERTY HAS BEEN SOLD FOR DELINQUENT TAXES Property Address (as identified on the most recent tax bill, if available): 3780 IVANHOE CIR, SCHILLER PARK, IL 60176 Legal Description or Property Index No.: 12-21-211-044-0000 This notice is to advise you that the above property has been sold for delinquent taxes and that the period of redemption from the sale will expire on 1/8/2027. Check with the county clerk as to the exact amount you owe before redeeming. This notice is also to advise you that a petition has been filed for a tax deed which will transfer title and the right to possession of this property if redemption is not made on or before 1/8/2027. This matter is set for hearing in the Circuit Court of this County in Chicago, Illinois, on 1/27/2027 in Room 1704 of the Richard J. Daley Center at 50 W. Washington Street, Chicago, Illinois at 9:30 a.m. You may be present at this hearing but your right to redeem will already have expired at that time. YOU ARE URGED TO REDEEM IMMEDIATELY TO PREVENT LOSS OF PROPERTY. Redemption can be made at any time on or before 1/8/2027 by applying to the County Clerk of Cook County, Illinois, at the Office of the County Clerk in Chicago, Illinois. FOR FURTHER INFORMATION CONTACT THE COUNTY CLERK ADDRESS: 118 N. Clark Street, Room 434, Chicago, Illinois 60602 TELEPHONE AND/OR EMAIL ADDRESS: (312) 603-5645 - tax.redemption@cookcountyil.gov MIDWESTERN INVESTORS LLC Purchaser or Assignee Dated: July 20, 2026 10/1, 10/2, 10/3/2026 140817

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Take Notice

TO: MONICA GORDON COOK COUNTY CLERK; IAN FOSTER; CECILIA A. FOSTER; U.S. BANK, N.A. S/I/I TO U.S. BANK NATIONAL ASSOCIATION N.D.; JPMORGAN CHASE BANK, N.A. S/I/I TO HOME SAVINGS OF AMERICA FSB; PERSONS OR TENANTS IN ACTUAL OCCUPANCY OR POSSESSION OF SAID PROPERTY; UNKNOWN OCCUPANTS OR PARTIES INTERESTED IN SAID PROPERTY; TAX DEED NO. 2026COTD001942 FILED: 7/15/2026TAKE NOTICECounty of CookDate Premises Sold or Forfeited: 1/10/2024Certificate No.: 21-0002779Sold or Forfeited for General Taxes of (year): 2021Sold for Special Assessments of (Municipality)and special assessment number: N/AWarrant No.: N/A Installment No.: N/A THIS PROPERTY HAS BEEN SOLD FOR DELINQUENT TAXESProperty Address (as identified on the most recent tax bill, if available): 552 THORNWOOD DR, BUFFALO GROVE, IL 60089 Legal Description or Property Index No.: 03-05-404-026-0000This notice is to advise you that the above property has been sold for delinquent taxes and that the period of redemption from the sale will expire on 1/8/2027. Check with the county clerk as to the exact amount you owe before redeeming. This notice is also to advise you that a petition has been filed for a tax deed which will transfer title and the right to possession of this property if redemption is not made on or before 1/8/2027. This matter is set for hearing in the Circuit Court of this County in Chicago, Illinois, on 1/27/2027 in Room 1704 of the Richard J. Daley Center at 50 W. Washington Street, Chicago, Illinois at 9:30 a.m. You may be present at this hearing but your right to redeem will already have expired at that time. YOU ARE URGED TO REDEEM IMMEDIATELY TO PREVENT LOSS OF PROPERTY. Redemption can be made at any time on or before 1/8/2027 by applying to the County Clerk of Cook County, Illinois, at the Office of the County Clerk in Chicago, Illinois. FOR FURTHER INFORMATION CONTACT THE COUNTY CLERK ADDRESS: 118 N. Clark Street, Room 434, Chicago, Illinois 60602 TELEPHONE AND/OR EMAIL ADDRESS: (312) 603-5645 - tax.redemption@cookcountyil.gov MIDWESTERN INVESTORS LLC Purchaser or Assignee Dated: July 20, 2026 101, 10/2, 10/3/2026 140824



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CHICAGO

ACCUWEATHER



abc 7
**AccuWeather
TEAM**

Meteorologists Larry Mowry, Cheryl Scott, Jaisol Martinez, Tracy Butler and Greg Dutra

ABC 7 Outlook:
A chilly start to the day, and then mild in the afternoon with highs in the mid-60s. Mainly sunny with light wind.

Chicago forecast

Saturday Conditions
8 a.m. 10 a.m. Noon 2 p.m. 4 p.m. 6 p.m. 8 p.m.
AccuWeather.com UV Index™

1	2	4	4	2	1	0
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RealFeel Temperature®

52°	59°	66°	69°	68°	64°	64°
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Saturday Activities
8 a.m. 10 a.m. Noon 2 p.m. 4 p.m. 6 p.m. 8 p.m.
Golfing Index

7	8	10	10	10	9	8
---	---	----	----	----	---	---

Fishing Index

6	3	9	9	3	6	3
---	---	---	---	---	---	---

The higher the **AccuWeather.com UV Index** number, the greater the need for eye and skin protection. **0-2** Low, **3-5** Moderate, **6-7** High, **8-10** Very High, **11+** Extreme. The patented **AccuWeather.com RealFeel Temperature** is an exclusive index of effective temperature based on eight weather factors. **Golf and Fishing Indexes:** **0-2:** Poor; **3-4:** Fair; **5-6:** Good; **7-8:** Very Good; **9-10:** Excellent.

Chicago almanac

Friday temperatures
O'Hare through 4 p.m.

	Average	Record
Friday high: 67°	69°	91° (1971)
Friday low: 53°	51°	28° (1974)

Local temperatures
through 6 p.m. Friday

Location	High	Low	Average	High	Low
Aurora	66°	51°	70°	46°	
Gary	64°	59°	70°	50°	
Kankakee	69°	56°	72°	48°	
Lansing	66°	58°	70°	49°	
Midway	65°	55°	70°	52°	
Romeoville	66°	54°	70°	49°	
Valparaiso	67°	57°	72°	49°	
Waukegan	62°	51°	67°	48°	

Friday Precipitation

	2026	2025	Normal
Friday*	1.00"	0.00"	0.11"
Month to date	1.41"	0.00"	0.23"
Year to date	36.08"	22.91"	30.13"

*24-hour period ending 4 p.m. Friday

Pollen as of 9/30

Trees	Grass	Weeds	Mold
Absent	Absent	Low	High

Source: Loyola Medicine via NAB

Air Quality Index
Friday's reading

Good

Saturday's forecast

Good

Primary pollutant

Particulates

Source: AirNow.gov

Cosmos

Sun and moon

Sunrise	Sat. 6:49 a.m.	Sun. 6:51 a.m.
Sunset	6:29 p.m.	6:27 p.m.
Moonrise	11:45 p.m.	none
Moonset	2:47 p.m.	3:30 p.m.

Last New First Full

Oct 3 Oct 10 Oct 18 Oct 25

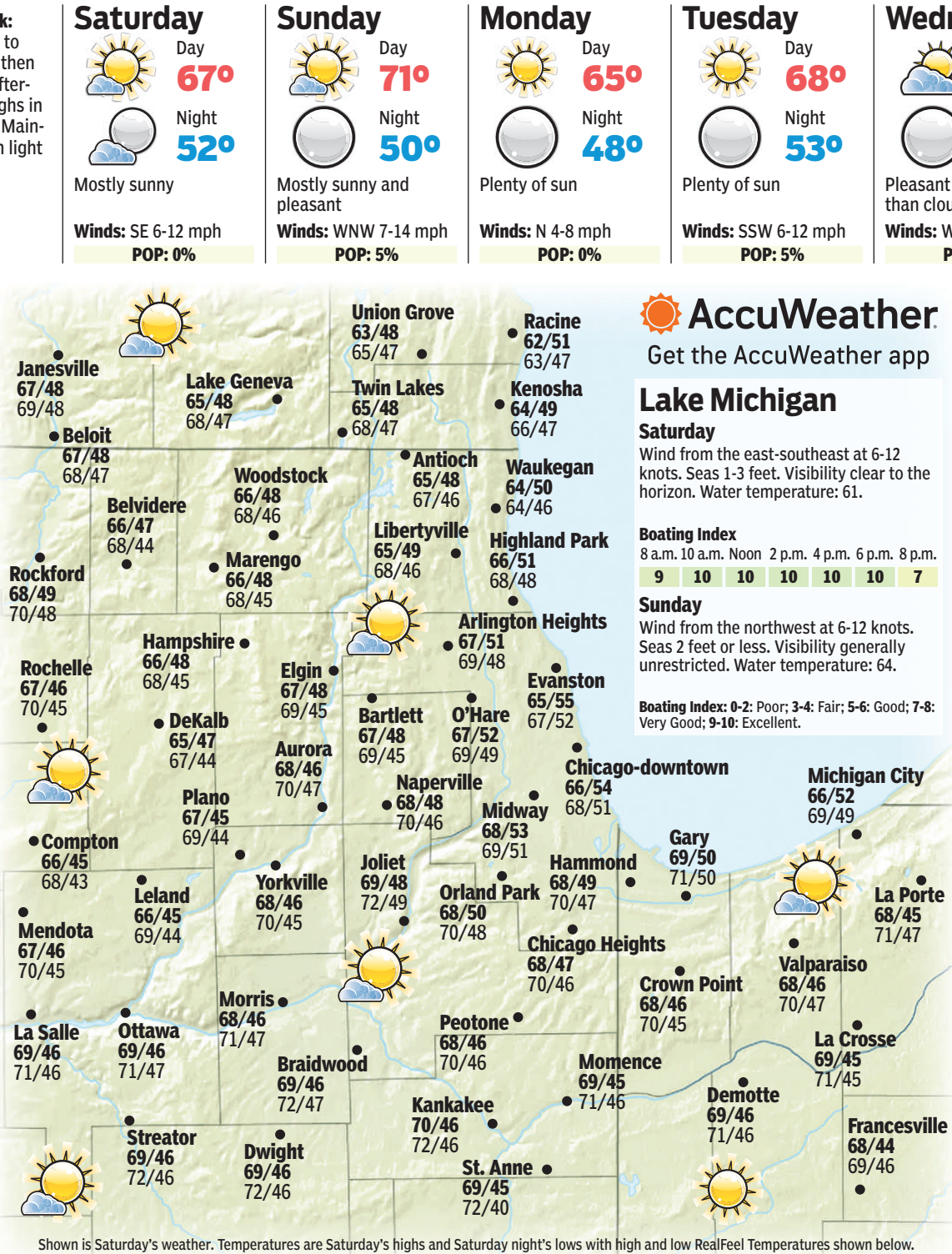
Saturday's Planet Watch

	Rise	Set
Mercury	8:58 a.m.	7:14 p.m.
Venus	9:33 a.m.	6:57 p.m.
Mars	1:03 a.m.	3:46 p.m.
Jupiter	2:32 a.m.	4:32 p.m.
Saturn	6:38 p.m.	6:59 a.m.

Best viewing times today: Venus: not visible Mars: 6:20 a.m. Jupiter: 6:20 a.m. Saturn: 7 p.m. Mercury: 7 p.m.

National cities

City	Sat.	Sun.
City	Hi/Low/W	Hi/Low/W
Abilene	74/64/sh	81/60/c
Albany, NY	66/43/s	66/52/pc
Albuquerque	75/56/s	79/53/s
Amarillo	73/52/pc	74/50/s
Anchorage	43/37/sh	48/41/r
Asheville	78/61/t	70/62/r
Aspen	75/42/s	73/40/s
Atlanta	84/71/t	75/69/r
Atlantic City	67/63/pc	67/62/r
Austin	84/72/t	84/71/t
Baltimore	69/61/pc	64/58/r
Billings	68/44/s	74/53/s
Birmingham	88/72/t	78/67/t
Bismarck	71/38/pc	67/43/s
Boise	85/55/s	89/58/s
Boston	66/53/pc	62/53/c
Brownsville	87/76/t	83/75/t
Buffalo	65/45/s	67/49/s
Burlington, VT	61/41/s	67/53/pc
Charleston, SC	84/74/t	82/71/t
Charleston, WV	68/60/pc	69/53/r
Charlotte	82/61/t	68/63/r
Chattanooga	85/70/t	75/65/r
Cheyenne	77/45/s	74/51/s
Cincinnati	71/52/pc	75/51/s
Cleveland	66/46/s	71/51/s
Colorado Spgs	81/48/s	70/47/s
Columbia, MO	75/50/s	79/48/s
Columbia, SC	84/69/t	75/67/r
Columbus, OH	69/49/pc	73/50/s
Concord	69/39/s	64/47/pc
Corpus Christi	89/75/t	85/74/t
Dallas	78/70/sh	83/67/c
Daytona Beach	88/77/t	89/74/t
Denver	83/49/s	81/54/s
Duluth	59/45/sh	60/36/s
El Paso	78/59/s	81/59/s





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Lake Michigan

Saturday
Wind from the east-southeast at 6-12 knots. Seas 1-3 feet. Visibility clear to the horizon. Water temperature: 61.

Boating Index
8 a.m. 10 a.m. Noon 2 p.m. 4 p.m. 6 p.m. 8 p.m.

9	10	10	10	10	10	7
---	----	----	----	----	----	---

Sunday
Wind from the northwest at 6-12 knots. Seas 2 feet or less. Visibility generally unrestricted. Water temperature: 64.

Boating Index: 0-2: Poor; 3-4: Fair; 5-6: Good; 7-8: Very Good; 9-10: Excellent.



Jaisol Martinez

Question: How much rain did we get in the area Wednesday through early Friday morning?

Answer: There were multiple rounds of rain in the Chicago area Wednesday, Sept. 30, through early Friday, Oct. 2. There was a wide area that reported 2"-3"+ of rain. We'll start with the two big airports. O'Hare reported 2.16" of rain and Midway recorded 2.32". Here is a list of other rain reports in this time period: Plainfield: 3.43", Sycamore: 3.43", Homer Glen: 3.19", Naperville: 3.13", Oswego: 3.12", Elgin: 2.98", Sugar Grove: 2.98", Chicago (near East Village): 2.86", Woodridge: 2.82", La Grange: 2.75", Geneva: 2.54", Frankfort: 2.38", Evanston: 2.28".

Do you have a weather question for the ABC 7 team? Submit them at abc7chicago.com/weather or send them to:

Ask ABC 7 Weather Team
190 N. State Street
Chicago, IL 60601

Regional cities

City	Sat.	Sun.
City	Hi/Low/W	Hi/Low/W
Illinois		
Carbondale	75/52/pc	80/51/s
Champaign	73/46/s	77/48/s
Decatur	73/48/s	77/48/s
Moline	69/49/s	72/41/s
Peoria	70/49/s	72/46/s
Quincy	71/50/s	73/47/s
Rockford	68/49/s	71/41/s
Springfield	73/46/s	76/44/s
Sterling	68/48/s	71/41/s
Indiana		
Bloomington	71/47/pc	74/50/s
Evansville	75/54/pc	78/51/s
Fort Wayne	67/44/s	73/45/s
Indianapolis	71/49/pc	76/50/s
Lafayette	71/44/s	74/45/s
South Bend	67/46/s	69/46/s
Wisconsin		
Green Bay	64/51/pc	67/39/pc
Kenosha	64/49/s	69/43/c
La Crosse	67/54/pc	66/42/pc
Madison	66/50/s	66/41/pc
Milwaukee	63/50/s	68/44/c
Wausau	62/50/pc	65/38/pc
Michigan		
Detroit	65/49/s	70/47/s
Grand Rapids	64/47/pc	66/44/pc
Marquette	55/47/c	56/39/sh
Sault Ste. Marie	58/50/c	61/43/r
Traverse City	64/48/pc	64/45/c
Iowa		
Ames	68/51/s	70/42/s
Cedar Rapids	67/51/s	69/41/s
Des Moines	69/54/s	68/45/s
Dubuque	66/51/pc	68/43/s

World cities

City	Sat.	Sun.
City	Hi/Low/W	Hi/Low/W
Acapulco	86/76/r	88/75/r
Algiers	91/74/pc	91/69/pc
Amsterdam	67/53/pc	67/52/c
Ankara	62/42/s	64/40/s
Athens	72/62/c	73/60/pc
Auckland	63/50/c	62/44/r
Baghdad	94/74/pc	93/76/c
Bangkok	92/79/r	94/80/r
Barbados	88/81/t	88/81/r
Barcelona	77/68/sh	76/67/sh
Beijing	74/53/pc	70/47/c
Beirut	82/70/sh	85/71/s
Berlin	66/51/pc	69/49/pc
Bermuda	84/76/s	83/78/s
Bogota	65/48/r	68/48/sh
Brussels	69/52/pc	69/50/s
Bucharest	69/41/s	73/42/s
Budapest	75/36/s	75/38/s
Buenos Aires	61/52/sh	70/58/pc
Cairo	87/67/pc	85/67/pc
Cancun	88/78/t	89/77/r
Caracas	92/78/r	92/77/t
Casablanca	84/68/pc	85/71/c
Copenhagen	62/52/pc	61/51/pc
Dublin	60/46/s	66/60/c
Edmonton	59/32/pc	66/35/pc
Frankfurt	72/50/r	70/51/pc
Geneva	73/57/sh	74/52/sh
Guadalajara	80/62/t	80/62/t
Havana	89/75/r	91/74/r
Helsinki	60/47/pc	59/44/c
Hong Kong	86/81/sh	88/77/r
Istanbul	72/59/pc	71/58/s
Jerusalem	79/60/s	78/60/s
Johannesburg	71/49/s	68/50/c
Kabul	84/63/pc	88/61/pc
Kingston	91/81/r	90/80/r

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US hiring slowing month before midterm elections

Unemployment rises to 4.2% amid economic grumblings

By Paul Wiseman
ASSOCIATED PRESS

WASHINGTON — U.S. employers added a disappointing 29,000 jobs and the unemployment rate ticked up last month, the government reported Friday, a month before voters go to the polls in pivotal midterm elections at a time of discontent over the state of the economy.

Hiring dropped from a revised 133,000 in August, the Labor Department said. The unemployment rate rose to a still-low 4.2% from 4.1% in August.

Economists had expected September payrolls to come in around 90,000.

Labor Department revisions also shaved 60,000 jobs off combined July and August payrolls.

The new hiring data could draw the Federal Reserve's attention back to hiring and jobs, given that one of the central bank's two mandates is to seek maximum employment. Many Fed officials have said in recent

weeks that they are primarily focused on their other mission, which is combating inflation. With the job market looking a bit weaker, the Fed may be more inclined to keep its key rate unchanged when it meets next month, rather than raise it.

Average hourly wages were up 3% last month from a year earlier, the smallest year-over-year gain since May 2021. "In this data, there is no sign that the labor market is stoking inflation," said Luke Tilley, chief economist at Wilmington Trust.

Still, the unemployment rate remains low and inflation has been above the central bank's 2% target for more than five years, so the Fed's concern about elevated prices is still front and center.

Federal, state and local governments cut 17,000 jobs last month. Professional and business services companies, which provide administrative and technical expertise, trimmed 9,000 jobs.

Healthcare companies created 17,000 jobs in September, but that was barely half the 33,000 they've added, on average, each month for the past year.

Bradley Saunders, an economist at Capital Economics, wrote that the slowdown in

healthcare hiring might reflect the Trump administration's revocation of work authorizations for 350,000 Haitians.

Construction companies added 11,000 jobs and manufacturers 9,000.

Unemployment rose partly because 485,000 people entered the workforce and not all of them found jobs right away.

The U.S. job market has proven resilient in the face of a series of shocks — trade wars, persistent inflation, high interest rates and a conflict with Iran that has driven energy prices higher. Friday's jobs report is the last one that will come out before the Nov. 3 elections that will determine whether President Donald Trump's Republicans maintain full control of Congress.

The U.S. job market has recovered from a dismal 2025, but most Americans are still unsettled about the state of the economy and the high cost of living.

Employers — businesses, government agencies and nonprofits — added an average 68,000 jobs a month so far this year. That's a big improvement on the 9,700 average jobs created every month in 2025, the weakest hiring outside a recession since 2002.

G7 nations to release oil to fight price surge

By Collin Binkley and John Leicester
ASSOCIATED PRESS

WASHINGTON — The Group of Seven industrial nations said Friday that they plan to release 100 million barrels of oil in the coming weeks, starting with "substantial" amounts of diesel after the fuel recently hit record high prices in the United States, where President Donald Trump said the diesel release would happen "immediately."

Trump and his Republican Party face pressure to address surging prices ahead of the Nov. 3 midterm elections, and Trump announced the action Friday on social media.

Trump's approval ratings on the economy hit a new low according to an AP-NORC poll as the Iran war and his trade battles have increased U.S. prices for oil and other goods.

Gas prices in the U.S. and abroad have soared during the seven-month-long war, a cost Trump has repeatedly said is worth it for making sure Iran does not obtain nuclear weapons. The national average for a gallon of diesel in the U.S. was \$6.37 Friday, according to AAA, after hitting a record \$6.52 Sept. 22.

France holds the rotating presidency of the G7 group and made the announcement in a statement after videoconference talks. The International Energy Agency will coordinate the effort to combat soaring fuel prices.

"We will implement ... a coordinated release through the IEA of 100 million barrels (MB) to begin immediately over 4 months, including a front-loaded substantial diesel release within the first 20 days by G7 members and partners," the statement said.

Some Republicans had called for Trump to ban U.S. exports of diesel to try to bring domestic prices down. But the G7 statement said the group, which includes the United States, also agreed not to limit energy exports to each other.



Claude Monet's "Le Jardin des Tuileries" is displayed during a preview Wednesday at Sotheby's in London. BEN BAUER/PA

‘Pretty rare’ works for sale

Paintings done by van Gogh, Cézanne go up for bidding in Sotheby's \$450M auction

By Jill Lawless
ASSOCIATED PRESS

LONDON — A dozen Impressionist and post-Impressionist artworks collectively valued at almost half a billion dollars are going up for auction after sitting unseen for decades in a fabled private collection in South America.

Sotheby's auction house said Wednesday that works by Vincent van Gogh and Paul Cézanne are expected to smash records for the artists in the Nov. 18 sale in New York. If so, it would be the latest sign that, in uncertain times, ultrawealthy art collectors are seeking security in masterpieces.

The paintings come from a collection amassed by the late Argentine art collector Nelly Arrieta de Blaquier and her sugar magnate husband, Carlos Pedro Blaquier, and are being sold by their children.

They include van Gogh's landscape "Chestnut Trees in Flower" estimated at \$180 million, and Cézanne's portrait "Arle-

quin," which carries an estimate of \$120 million.

Neither has been seen in public for half a century.

Helena Newman, Sotheby's head of Impressionist and modern art, said the collection was like a "mini- Musée D'Orsay," the Paris museum that holds one of the world's greatest collections of Impressionist and post-Impressionist artworks.

"In my 30-plus years at Sotheby's, I've never had the privilege of handling a collection of quite this content and caliber," she said.

Newman said van Gogh's painting of flowering chestnut trees captures the "explosion of energy and vitality" the artist felt after his release from a psychiatric asylum in May 1890. He took his own life two months later.

The Cézanne portrait is one of four paintings of the artist's son dressed as the Harlequin figure from clowning. The other three are in major museums.

Also in the collection are Parisian cityscapes by Claude Monet and Camille Pissarro, a horse-racing image by Edgar Degas and a boating scene by Pierre-Auguste Renoir, all valued in the tens of

millions of dollars.

Art expert Philip Hook, a former Sotheby's auctioneer, said the collection "really is the stuff of legend," because the collectors did not loan out the works for exhibitions.

"No one knew really what was in it. So now, for this to be revealed, is tremendously exciting," Hook said.

"They came out with a collection that, rather cleverly, is focused on getting one representative work by each of the major names (of Impressionist and post-Impressionist art), and that is incredibly difficult to do," he added. "They succeeded with huge, huge style and success."

Newman said the art sale is likely to attract global attention, with potential buyers ranging from American tech billionaires to well-endowed Middle Eastern institutions and wealthy collectors from North America, Europe, the Middle East and Asia.

"In times where there's a lot of global macro geopolitical uncertainty, it's almost like there's a return to really established, tried and tested" works that are "unquestionably great," Newman said.

"(This) museum-quality Impressionist collection ... is pretty rare."

Business briefs

ARGENTINA 'GOLDEN PASSPORT' MEANT TO WOO RICH OUTSIDERS

Argentina on Friday announced plans to offer citizenship to wealthy foreigners in exchange for cash contributions or investments in government bonds, as libertarian President Javier Milei seeks new sources of dollars for the debt-burdened nation.

Economy Minister Luis Caputo unveiled the so-called golden passport scheme at an investor event in Paris, saying applications are expected to open before the end of the year.

Applicants have two options: make a nonrefundable \$350,000 contribution to the Argentine Treasury or invest \$800,000 in a new government bond that must be held for seven years. Contributions would increase depending on family size, with a family of four expected to pay \$500,000, officials said.

Argentina's Treasury faces nearly \$25 billion in foreign-currency debt payments coming due in 2027. — *Associated Press*

CANADA ADVANCES OIL PIPELINE TO REDUCE DEPENDENCE ON US

TORONTO — Canadian Prime Minister Mark Carney has fast-tracked a proposed oil pipeline capable of carrying 1 million barrels a day to the Pacific coast, which could reduce the country's dependence on the United States and mend relations with oil-rich Alberta as separatists push for a referendum on leaving Canada.

Appearing Thursday with Alberta Premier Danielle Smith in Fort McMurray, at the heart of Canada's oil sands, Carney designated the Pacific Link pipeline as a project of national interest under legislation enacted to accelerate major infrastructure projects.

The proposed 775-mile pipeline is expected to cost between \$25 billion and \$31 billion and would run from Bruderheim, Alberta, to a deep water port near Delta, in British Columbia, largely following the Trans Mountain corridor. — *Associated Press*

G20 TRADE TALKS YIELD LITTLE PROGRESS AS TENSIONS SIMMER

MILWAUKEE — G20 trade ministers failed to reach an agreement to curb the flooding of markets with overproduced, underpriced goods, a practice the Trump administration says undercuts American manufacturers.

U.S. Trade Representative Jamieson Greer, emerging from the gathering Thursday, said talks were constructive despite not reaching consensus on the issue, which is known as "excess capacity."

The White House has accused trading partners of producing a gamut of goods in quantities surpassing demand, claiming it sends prices downward and unfairly skews competition.

The Trump administration views China as the leading offender, but has opened investigations into countries from Norway to Bangladesh. — *Associated Press*

Amazon to invest \$1B into data center areas

By Anne D'Innocenzio
ASSOCIATED PRESS

NEW YORK — Amazon is investing more than \$1 billion over the next five years into communities where it operates data centers for education, job training, water and energy preservation projects, and other local priorities as it reacts to a backlash from politicians and consumers to the tech industry's rollout of the massive buildings.

According to a blog post Friday by Matt Garman, Amazon's CEO of its cloud computing arm, Amazon has already spent more than \$1 billion in communities with a large data center presence over the past three years.

Garman also said that Amazon is no longer using nondisclosure agreements with government agencies it works with on its projects, and it said it hosts open houses in communities where it operates to share information about what it's doing. He also warned against the spread of what he believes is misinformation about data centers' impact on the environment and energy rates.

"If these measures are enacted, the U.S. could be writing its own losing ticket to this race, and the consequences would last generations," he wrote. "There is urgency to this data center build out because we aren't the only country that sees the benefits of AI for the economy and national security."

Garman's pledge comes as data centers,

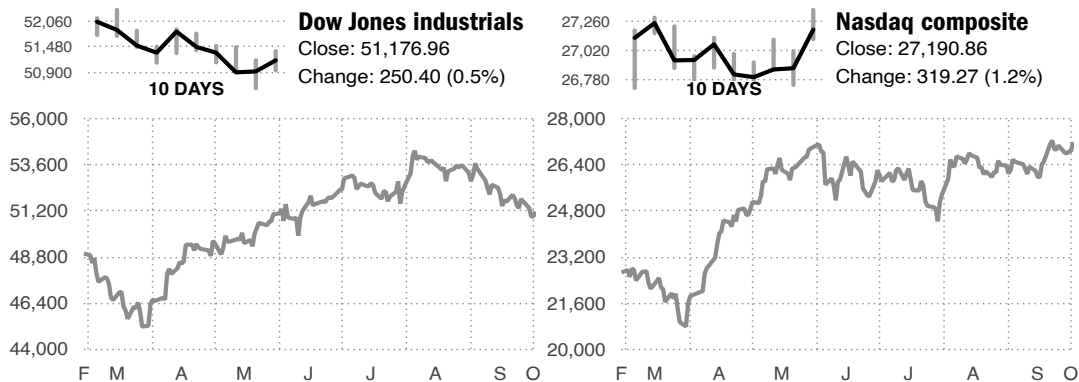
which power artificial intelligence and cloud computing, have become a political issue heading into the midterms as tech giants race to invest more money in expanding these infrastructures.

Small, under-the-radar data centers have been around for decades. But the explosion of AI chatbots has resulted in data centers that are bigger than anything just about any town has ever seen. Some of them dwarf football stadiums and factories and consume more energy than small cities.

By 2030, data centers will account for nearly 3% of the world's projected electricity use, with 935 trillion watt-hours, according to a United Nations University report released in June on these buildings' environmental footprint.

Market Roundup

DOW 51,176.96 250.40 0.49%	NASDAQ 27,190.86 319.27 1.19%	S&P 500 7,722.72 56.27 0.73%	EURO 1.1260 0.0022 0.20%	CRUDE OIL 91.26 -1.61 -1.73%	GOLD 4,143.80 -29.10 -0.70%	6-MO T-BILLS 4.29 0.01 0.23%	30-YR T-BONDS 5.63 0.02 0.39%
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StocksRecap

	NYSE	NASD
Vol. (in mil.)	4637	3515
Pvs. Volume	5229	3357
Advanced	1586	1773
Declined	1042	1556
New Highs	45	128
New Lows	65	246

	HIGH	LOW	CLOSE	CHG	%CHG	WK	MO	QTR	YTD
DOW	51,382.88	50,950.61	51,176.96	+250.40	+0.49%	▼	▲	▲	+6.48%
DOW Trans.	20,029.91	19,738.57	20,009.75	+405.24	+2.07%	▲	▲	▲	+15.28%
DOW Util.	1,025.15	1,013.61	1,018.02	+4.93	+0.49%	▲	▲	▲	-4.69%
NYSE Comp.	23,684.76	23,526.84	23,654.31	+127.47	+0.54%	▼	▲	▲	+7.50%
NASDAQ	27,353.68	27,112.32	27,190.86	+319.27	+1.19%	▲	▲	▲	+16.99%
S&P 500	7,754.67	7,700.51	7,722.72	+56.27	+0.73%	▼	▲	▲	+12.81%
S&P 400	3,688.72	3,652.40	3,668.01	+34.85	+0.96%	▲	▲	▲	+10.98%
DOW Total	76,458.83	75,921.15	76,132.52	+573.99	+0.76%	▼	▲	▲	+12.79%
Russell 2000	2,852.50	2,825.23	2,832.89	+26.27	+0.94%	▼	▲	▲	+14.14%

LOCAL STOCKS

NAME	CLOSE	CHG	%CHG	CHG	LO	HI	DIV
ANI Pharmaceuticals Inc.	72.18	-0.78	-1.1%	-6.76	69.58	97.00	...
AbbVie Inc.	262.82	+2.89	+1.1%	+34.33	190.75	269.39	6.92
Abbott Laboratories	97.50	+8.1	+0.8%	-27.79	81.97	135.36	2.52
Acco Brands Corp.	4.30	+0.6	+1.4%	+5.7	2.81	4.56	0.30
Allstate Corp., The	223.74	-0.67	-0.3%	+15.59	188.08	277.22	4.32
AptarGroup Inc.	119.91	-0.96	-0.8%	-2.05	103.23	146.91	1.92
Archer Daniels Midland Cc	80.45	+9.3	+1.2%	+22.96	55.58	88.75	2.08
Baxter International Inc.	23.49	-0.15	-0.6%	+4.38	15.73	30.00	0.04
Boeing Co.	193.56	+1.28	+0.7%	-23.56	176.77	254.35	8.22
Brunswick Corp.	65.43	+1.21	+1.9%	-8.81	58.56	90.25	1.76
CDW	133.29	-2.54	-1.9%	-2.91	97.12	162.47	2.52
CF Industries Holdings Inc	115.01	+4.7	+0.4%	+37.67	75.42	141.96	2.40
CME Group Inc.	263.14	-1.96	-0.7%	-9.94	218.31	329.16	5.20
CNA Financial Corp.	46.34	+4.6	+1.0%	-1.40	41.53	55.71	1.92
Century Aluminum	35.62	-0.37	-1.0%	-3.56	25.40	70.43	...
Chicago Rivet & Machine C	11.20	+3.3	+3.0%	-2.71	8.50	15.00	0.12
ConAgra Brands Inc.	13.36	+1.6	+1.2%	-3.95	12.53	20.32	0.70
Deere & Co.	687.00	+19.74	+3.0%	+221.43	433.48	721.22	6.48
Distribution Solutions Grp	34.98	+0.4	+0.1%	+7.59	19.02	35.06	0.48
Dover Corp.	189.69	+1.63	+0.9%	-5.55	158.97	237.54	2.10
Enova International Inc.	172.89	+1.40	+0.8%	+15.69	103.02	267.45	...
Equity Lifestyle Propert. In	58.25	+6.3	+1.1%	-2.36	57.46	69.00	2.17
Exelon Corp.	40.73	+2.6	+0.6%	-2.86	39.73	50.65	1.68
Federal Signal Corp.	116.34	+4.17	+3.7%	+7.75	101.18	134.51	0.60
First Indust.Realty Trust In	59.46	+5.9	+1.0%	+2.19	50.24	69.88	2.00
First Mid Bancshares Inc.	49.98	+7.0	+1.4%	+10.98	34.16	53.36	1.04
Fortune Brands Innovator	38.56	+0.4	+0.1%	-11.46	32.34	64.84	1.04
FreightCar America Inc.	6.90	+3.3	+5.0%	-4.17	6.35	14.90	0.36
Fuel Technologies Inc.	1.66	-0.06	-3.5%	+1.0	1.17	3.45	...
GATX Corp.	171.03	+2.15	+1.3%	+1.43	150.42	205.56	2.64
Gallagher & Co., Arthur J.	226.11	-5.71	-2.5%	-32.68	190.75	313.55	2.80
Grainger Inc., W.W.	1280.30	-1.38	-0.1%	+271.25	906.52	1419.91	9.96
Groupon Inc.	19.31	-0.22	-1.1%	+1.70	9.17	29.90	...
Hub Group Inc.	29.77	-0.38	-1.3%	-12.84	29.37	53.26	0.50
Huron Consulting Group Li	162.15	-6.27	-3.7%	-10.76	84.88	186.78	...
Hyatt Hotels Corp.	158.90	-2.04	-1.3%	-1.42	134.18	206.86	0.60
IDEX Corp.	232.99	+3.14	+1.4%	+55.05	159.27	243.80	2.92
Illinois Tool Works Inc.	262.92	+2.08	+0.8%	+16.62	238.82	303.16	6.88
Ingredion Inc.	95.33	+4.2	+0.4%	-14.93	93.97	123.49	3.32
JBT Marel Corp.	108.60	+1.74	+1.6%	-42.07	104.45	170.19	0.40
JPMorgan Chase & Co.	332.38	-0.80	-0.2%	+10.16	279.10	366.50	6.60

John B. Sanfilippo & Son I	68.52	+1.90	+2.9%	-2.08	59.07	92.08	0.95
Jones Lang Lasalle Inc.	306.81	-1.26	-0.4%	-29.66	259.83	393.84	0.43
Kemper Corp.	25.67	-0.27	-1.0%	-14.87	22.69	51.08	1.28
Knowles Corp.	40.05	+1.82	+4.8%	+18.62	20.57	42.93	...
Kraft Heinz	22.19	-0.27	-1.2%	-2.06	21.04	28.09	1.60
LKQ Corp.	22.80	+0.2	+0.1%	-7.40	21.17	37.13	1.20
Lifeway Foods Inc.	21.21	+1.1	+0.5%	-3.02	17.31	32.71	0.08
Littelfuse Inc.	456.53	+20.98	+4.8%	+203.61	233.36	500.57	3.20
MYR Group Inc. (Del.)	304.77	+6.85	+2.3%	+86.27	190.14	503.56	...
McDonald's Corp.	231.89	+0.6	+0.0%	-73.74	229.61	341.75	7.72
Methode Electronics Inc.	15.74	+1.45	+10.1%	+9.10	4.88	20.38	0.20
Middleby Corp	104.57	+1.88	+1.8%	-15.03	89.15	148.20	...
Mondelez International Inc	58.19	+4.3	+0.7%	+4.36	51.20	66.65	2.08
Morningstar Inc.	183.55	-7.66	-4.0%	-33.76	141.49	228.95	2.00
Motorola Solutions Inc.	447.41	-0.62	-0.1%	+64.09	359.36	494.85	4.84
NISOURCE Inc.	39.43	-0.07	-0.2%	-2.33	38.42	49.21	1.20
Northern Trust Corp.	171.40	+2.20	+1.3%	+34.81	121.12	193.89	3.52
Oil-Dri Corp. of America	89.66	-1.75	-1.9%	+40.72	45.61	107.00	0.90
Old Republic Intl Corp.	38.06	+5.7	+1.5%	-7.58	36.65	46.76	1.26
Old Second Bancorp Inc.	24.95	+3.2	+1.3%	+5.45	16.65	26.06	0.28
OneSpan Inc.	18.12	+0.8	+0.4%	+5.28	10.07	18.48	0.52
Packaging Corp. of Americ	228.54	-1.17	-0.5%	+22.31	191.50	259.98	6.00
Paylocity Holding Corp.	144.47	-2.13	-1.5%	-8.03	93.27	160.73	...
Portillo's Inc.	3.50	-0.02	-0.8%	-1.04	3.29	6.83	...
Richardson Electronics Lt	18.99	+4.3	+2.3%	+8.11	9.37	23.15	0.24
Ryan Specialty Holdings Ir	37.67	-0.72	-1.9%	-13.96	29.28	59.18	0.52
Stapan Co.	63.00	+1.47	+2.4%	+15.64	41.82	68.00	1.58
Suncoke Energy Inc.	9.90	+1.6	+1.6%	+2.70	5.52	10.68	0.48
Telephone & Data Systems	35.39	+1.9	+0.5%	-5.61	31.51	49.12	0.16
Titan International Inc.	6.99	+1.9	+2.8%	-0.84	6.37	11.70	0.02
Tootsie Roll Industries Inc	37.99	+1.5	+0.4%	+1.36	34.44	45.06	0.36
TransUnion	63.44	+1.26	+2.0%	-22.31	60.96	89.12	0.50
US Foods Holding Corp.	96.92	+2.99	+3.2%	+21.60	69.88	111.42	...
Ulta Beauty Inc.	543.69	+5.96	+1.1%	-61.32	443.60	714.97	...
United Airlines	112.51	+7.3	+0.7%	+6.9	84.64	138.77	...
Ventas Inc.	84.01	+2.8	+0.3%	+6.63	66.92	101.60	2.08
Wintrust Financial Corp.	145.02	+1.47	+1.0%	+5.20	119.61	167.22	2.20
Yunhong Green CTI Ltd.	2.78	-0.09	-3.0%	-0.84	2.38	10.29	...
Zebra Technologies Corp.	373.86	+4.1	+0.1%	+133.04	199.05	386.23	...

Commodities

Natural gas rose 2.43% to \$3.04. Unleaded gas fell 2.66% to \$3.31. Orange juice dropped 3.52% to \$1.37. Platinum increased 2.29% to \$1744.50.



FUELS	CLOSE	PVS.	CHG	%YT
Crude Oil (bbl)	91.26	92.87	-1.61	+58.
Heating Oil (gal)	4.54	4.64	-0.10	+114.
Natural Gas (mm btu)	3.04	2.97	+0.07	-17.
Unleaded Gas (gal)	3.31	3.40	-0.09	+93.

METALS	CLOSE	PVS.	CHG	%YT
Aluminum (ton)	3,208.50	3,198.00	+10.50	+10.
Copper (lb)	6.53	6.48	+0.05	+16.
Gold (oz)	4,143.80	4,172.90	-29.10	-4.
Platinum (oz)	1,744.50	1,705.50	+39.00	-14.
Silver (oz)	60.15	60.72	-0.58	-14.

AGRICULTURE	CLOSE	PVS.	CHG	%YT
Lumber (1,000 bd ft)	527.00	530.50	-3.50	-17.
Cattle (lb)	2.19	2.19	+0.00	-5.
Coffee (lb)	2.91	2.88	+0.03	-16.
Corn (bu)	4.97	5.02	-0.05	+13.
Cotton (lb)	74.03	74.03	+0.00	+15.
Orange Juice (lb)	1.37	1.42	-0.05	-33.
Soybeans (bu)	12.77	12.84	-0.07	+23.
Wheat (bu)	6.83	6.83	+0.00	+34.

MAJORS	CLOSE	CHG	%CHG	6MO AGO	1YF AGO
British Pound (GBP/USD)	1.3242	+0.0048	+0.36%	1.3224	1.344
Canadian Dollar	1.4246	+0.0027	+0.19%	1.3916	1.396
Euro (EUR/USD)	1.1260	+0.0022	+0.20%	1.1541	1.171
Japanese Yen	157.820	-0.2010	-0.13%	159.57	147.2
Mexican Peso	18.1462	-0.1474	-0.81%	17.780	18.41

EUROPE/AFRICA/MIDDLE EAST	CLOSE	CHG	%CHG	6MO AGO	1YF AGO
Israeli Shekel	3.0515	-0.0337	-1.09%	3.1230	3.317
Norwegian Krone	9.6156	+0.0023	+0.02%	9.6901	9.971
South African Rand	16.6401	-0.0197	-0.12%	16.801	17.25
Swedish Krona	10.0356	+0.0015	+0.02%	9.3910	9.393
Swiss Franc	.8284	-0.0025	-0.31%	.7982	.797

ASIA/PACIFIC	CLOSE	CHG	%CHG	6MO AGO	1YF AGO
Australian Dollar	1.4428	+0.0000	+0.00%	1.4476	1.515
Chinese Yuan	6.7045	+0.0000	+0.00%	6.8851	7.119
Hong Kong Dollar	7.8474	+0.0020	+0.02%	7.8376	7.781
Indian Rupee	95.4025	-0.8679	-0.90%	92.973	88.71
Singapore Dollar	1.2783	-0.0013	-0.10%	1.2850	1.288
South Korean Won	1341.19	-1.820	-0.14%	1509.2	1405.
Taiwan Dollar	31.8068	-0.0838	-0.26%	31.925	30.45

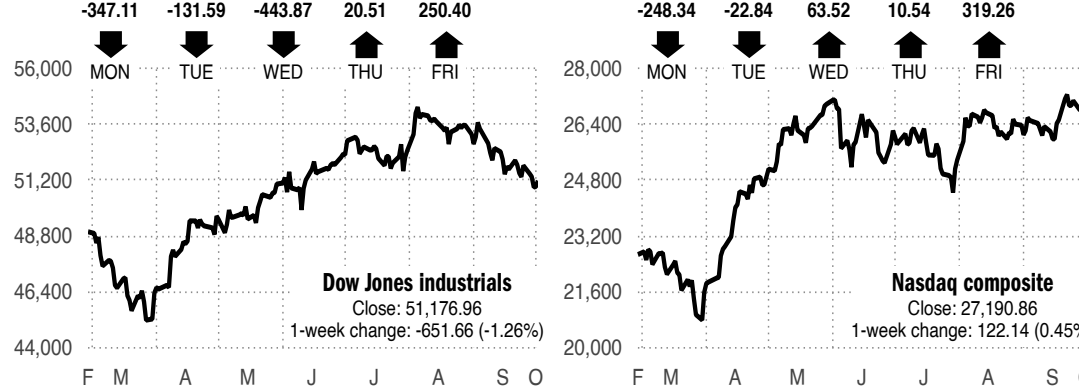
Interestrates



The yield on the 10-year Treasury note rose to 5.28%. Yields affect interest rates on mortgages and other consumer loans.

	PRIME RATE	FED FUNDS
YEST	7.00	3.88
6 MO AGO	6.75	3.63
1 YR AGO	6.75	3.63

WEEKLY RECAP



W E E K L Y P E R F O R M A N C E												
52-WEEK						WK	WK		YTD	1YR		
HIGH	LOW	INDEX	HIGH	LOW	CLOSE	CHG	%CHG	MO	QTR	%CHG	%CHG	
54,744.33	45,057.28	DOW	51,780.50	50,546.54	51,176.96	-651.66	-1.26	▲	▲	6.48	10	
24,825.70	15,064.48	DOW Trans.	20,029.91	19,330.08	20,009.75	+437.53	2.24	▲	▲	15.28	27.1	
1,202.79	998.69	DOW Util.	1,025.15	998.69	1,018.02	+7.70	.76	▲	▲	-4.69	-8.6	
24,866.75	20,906.45	NYSE Comp.	23,912.59	23,335.36	23,654.31	-258.28	-1.08	▲	▲	7.50	9.5	
27,353.68	20,690.25	NASDAQ	27,353.68	26,709.69	27,190.86	+122.14	.45	▲	▲	16.99	19	
7,816.70	6,316.91	S&P 500	7,754.67	7,616.78	7,722.72	-20.69	-0.27	▲	▲	12.81	15	
3,928.98	3,107.41	S&P 400	3,688.72	3,576.77	3,668.01	+19.44	.53	▲	▲	10.98	11.9	
77,476.73	62,488.62	DOW Total	76,458.83	75,047.24	76,132.52	-176.99	-0.23	▲	▲	12.79	14.6	
3,069.71	2,303.46	Russell 2000	2,852.50	2,775.36	2,832.89	-4.66	-0.16	▲	▲	14.14	15.2	

Malaysia’s gambit: Making its pungent durian most wanted

By Kanis Leung
ASSOCIATED PRESS

KUALA LUMPUR, Malaysia — Malaysia is pushing to take durian, whose powerful smell delights its lovers and repels its haters, beyond its roadside stalls and orchards to convince fans of the spiky fruit that its varieties are worth seeking out.

Devotees savor durians like wine. For Malaysian ones, the taste of their rich and creamy flesh varies across types. Some are prized for their sweet custard and fruity notes, others for a hint of bitterness, an alcohol tinge or even a peanut butter flavor.

Malaysians’ efforts to elevate the industry can be found in the capital, Kuala Lumpur, at a center devoted exclusively to the fruit and the growing variety of products made from it.

At the Kuala Lumpur Durian Experience Center, near the landmark Petronas Twin Towers, visitors venture into a replica durian orchard to discover the fruit’s culture and history. In another room, a theater show draws laughter. Downstairs, visitors enjoy platters and egg tarts crafted from it.

Launched this summer after an investment of nearly \$2 million, the two-story center spans about 20,450



A customer has a photograph taken beside a giant durian display at a durian stall June 22 in Petaling Jaya, on the outskirts of Kuala Lumpur, Malaysia. **VINCENT THIAN/AP**

square feet and is open daily. Its durian shop welcomes guests from morning to midnight.

Its founder, Edison Ang, said the center targets both local customers and tourists, especially those from China, the world’s biggest durian importer. He said Chinese

palates have long been influenced by Thai durian culture.

“What we actually hope for now is not to get people who don’t eat durian to start eating durian,” he said. “We hope consumers who are already eating durian from other countries will switch to Malaysian durian.”

In 2025, China imported 1.87 million ton of fresh durian worth \$7.5 billion, with volume jumping over six times in the past decade, according to its customs data.

Thailand’s earlier entry helped it secure over half that market by value in 2025. Malaysia, which began

exporting fresh durian to China in 2024, was dwarfed. But for the first half of 2026, the value of China’s fresh durian imports from Malaysia quadrupled compared with the same period last year.

Unlike their rivals, Malaysian growers typically do not harvest early, instead collect-

ing only naturally ripened fruit caught in nets or ropes as they fall.

That’s the industry’s biggest advantage and also its biggest weakness, Ang said, as sellers have to race against time because the fruit’s shelf life is at most two to three days. Any delays would affect its quality. When his stock was held up for several days during customs checks, his refund rate climbed, he said.

Durian sales are also sensitive to economic conditions, said Leron Yee, founder of DKing, whose business covers both export and domestic markets. When the Chinese economy performs well, his business improves, but if the buying power of Chinese consumers falls, he needs to find alternative markets, he said.

“It is a luxury, not a necessity,” he said.

Businesses are finding opportunities in what the fruit can become. Yee’s business sells durian paste, durian-flavored chocolate and mochi — and even mooncakes ahead of the Mid-Autumn Festival.

DurianBB founder Adrian Choy’s company offers durian ice cream, desserts and dried durian at a cafe, alongside coffee flavored with the Musang King variety and other items. His brand also offers guided farm tours.



A screen displays the new America.gov website during a launch event Tuesday in the East Room of the White House in Washington. **DOUG MILLS/THE NEW YORK TIMES**

New government chatbot offers facts, contradicts Trump claims

By Chris Cameron
THE NEW YORK TIMES

WASHINGTON — A new artificial intelligence-powered search tool that President Donald Trump unveiled this week to help Americans get information from the federal government provides facts that contradict false claims he has made about topics such as election fraud and immigration.

In an event announcing the website’s launch, Trump praised the tool that he said would be “one front door for every single question” someone could ask of the federal government.

“With America.gov, the entire government will fit in the palm of your hand,” Trump said, adding, “everything will be answered easily and quickly.”

But the president would not like many answers that America.gov provides.

Citing official government sources, the chatbot, which calls itself “America,” fact-checks an extensive list of Trump’s most common false claims.

They include election fraud, immigration, tariffs, inflation and the president’s signature policy bill that he signed into law last year.

According to America.

gov: It is Americans, and not foreign companies, that pay for Trump’s import tariffs; U.S. elections are generally safe and secure, and prosecuted cases of voter fraud are “tiny” compared with the hundreds of millions of votes cast; Trump is wrong when he says that 25 million immigrants illegally crossed the border under his predecessor, President Joe Biden; consumer prices are not going down, as Trump frequently claims.

Largely citing figures from the Congressional Budget Office, the nonpartisan scorekeeper, America.gov said that Trump’s signature domestic policy bill, signed into law last year, is estimated to add trillions of dollars to the national debt and cause more than 10 million people to lose their health insurance. The chatbot agreed with a statement that the law “on average made the poorest people in America even poorer and the richest people in America even richer.”

The chatbot avoids answering some questions it deems political and in some cases supports Trump’s proclamations when it can cite an official government source to do so.

The chatbot, for example, says that what was called the

Gulf of Mexico is the “Gulf of America (formerly the Gulf of Mexico).”

The website says on its FAQ page that “America.gov does not provide campaign or party information. Its answers are based on published government sources, and you can review those sources yourself.”

The White House did not address a question about whether Trump knew that the new government website frequently contradicted him.

In a statement, the White House said that “America.gov will continue to be updated to provide more features, resources and information from the federal government.”

Democratic lawmakers quickly promoted many of the chatbot’s statements, which supported campaign talking points criticizing Trump’s policies.

“Finally, a straight answer from someone in the Trump administration,” Sen. Adam Schiff, D-Calif., wrote with a screenshot of America.gov saying that Trump lost the 2020 election.

Schiff had recently asked some of Trump’s judicial nominees about the 2020 election during a public hearing. Some of the nominees declined to answer.

Senators reach bipartisan deal on bill to hasten energy projects

By Matthew Daly
ASSOCIATED PRESS

WASHINGTON — Senators from both parties said this week they have reached a deal on legislation aimed at speeding up permitting reviews for new energy and infrastructure projects that now face yearslong delays, as lawmakers seek to meet growing demand for electricity and other forms of energy.

The bill, proponents argue, would cut down the arduous timeline for getting big energy projects off the ground at a time when demand is rising because of mushrooming data centers for artificial intelligence. The bill would ensure AI data centers are forced to pay for the increased electricity they use and would mark a significant change to a landmark environmental law that critics say slows the process of building energy projects.

Sen. Shelley Moore Capito, R-W.Va. and chair of the Environment and Public Works Committee, called the bill “a major step toward making it faster and more efficient and easier to build infrastructure projects” of all types while maintaining important environmental protections.

“The American people sent us here to do big things. This is a big thing. It’s monumental and it’s legacy-setting,” Capito said at a news conference Wednesday at the Capitol where she was joined by GOP Sen. Mike Lee of Utah and Democratic Sens. Martin Heinrich of New Mexico and Sheldon Whitehouse of Rhode Island. The four senators lead the chamber’s energy and environment panels.

Heinrich said the bill “will mean more energy on the grid, more good-paying jobs and lower electricity costs for families and businesses. And as data centers drive demand for more power, it will ensure they pay their fair share of the grid upgrades they require — not leave that bill



Sen. Shelly Moore Capito, R-W.Va., and her staff celebrate the bipartisan deal Wednesday. **J. SCOTT APPLEWHITE/AP**

to American families.”

A vote on the bill won’t happen until after the midterm elections — reflecting the fraught political reality as elections loom that could change partisan control of both chambers. But the bill represents a rare instance of bipartisanship over the country’s energy policy.

Lee, who chairs the energy committee, said he is confident the bill will be approved in November.

Whitehouse, the top Democrat on the environment panel, also was hopeful but said Democrats were still seeking clarity on how the bill will prevent President Donald Trump’s administration from blocking wind and solar projects.

The administration suspended five offshore wind projects in December, citing unspecified national security concerns. The projects later moved forward after federal judges intervened.

A federal judge also struck down Trump’s executive order blocking wind energy projects early in his second term.

Brad Campbell, president of the Conservation Law Foundation, an environmental advocacy group, panned the deal, saying it “appears to adopt a fossil fuel industry wish-list.”

He said the bill could roll back protections for clean water and endangered

species, limit judicial review and curtail the power of the Environmental Protection Agency and states to consider impacts of energy projects.

Drew Maloney, president and CEO of the Edison Electric Institute, which represents for-profit utilities, said he was encouraged by provisions to streamline environmental permitting and “create project certainty.”

The group is reviewing the transmission provisions to see how they affect efforts to deliver electricity to its 250 million customers, he said.

In a statement, the White House said the bill would “deliver transformative policies to lower Americans’ energy and housing costs, drive new construction and investment in American infrastructure, and create American jobs.”

Trump’s opposition to wind power has been a consistent stumbling block to a deal on permitting reform, which Democrats say can only go forward if the administration agrees to allow previously approved projects to move forward.

Trump recently offered to ease his administration’s holdup on renewable energy projects, in part to entice Democrats to agree to a permitting deal. But it was unclear how long the offer would last and whether it would change after the election results are known.

Six Flags retires roller coaster in Calif. after injuries, lawsuits

By Neil Vigdor
THE NEW YORK TIMES

X2, the beleaguered roller coaster at Six Flags Magic Mountain near Los Angeles that has been at the center of numerous lawsuits, including at least two wrongful death cases, is permanently closing, the theme park’s operator said Tuesday.

The ride, which tops out around 200 feet and reaches speeds of up to 76 mph, has not operated since July, amid a flurry of complaints accusing Six Flags and S&S Worldwide, the company that built the roller coaster’s train cars,

of failing to warn riders about the risks.

Riders experienced up to four times the force of gravity on X2, which featured multiple inversions and twists and was classified as a “fourth-dimension” roller coaster because of the way its seats were designed. The seats rotated independently as the train traveled along the track, spinning riders as much as 360 degrees.

Its design spawned intense criticism over the years, with lawsuits linking it to cerebral hemorrhages and other traumatic brain injuries.

More than 16 million

people rode the roller coaster since it was renamed X2 in 2008 after a redesign, according to Six Flags. The original ride opened as X in 2002.

In a blog post Tuesday, Brian Oerding, the president of Six Flags Magic Mountain, said that the ride was being retired.

“While X2 consistently passed a multitude of safety tests, we have decided to close the ride because we believe it’s the right thing to do,” Oerding said. “Ride safety is a cornerstone of our business, and when we see guest confidence affected, we take it seriously.”

The roller coaster’s decommissioning came eight days after three people sued Six Flags and S&S Worldwide, claiming they suffered catastrophic brain injuries after riding X2.

The California Division of Occupational Safety and Health had begun an inquiry into the ride.

The announcement Tuesday also followed a settlement for an undisclosed amount in late August between Six Flags and the family of Christopher Hawley, 22, a San Diego State University graduate who died one day after riding X2 in June 2022. The case had

been scheduled to go to trial in September in Los Angeles County Superior Court.

Hawley lost consciousness after exiting the ride, according to a lawsuit filed by his family, who said the ride caused a catastrophic right subdural hematoma. The Los Angeles County medical examiner’s office ruled that Hawley had died from blunt head trauma and said that his death was accidental.

In a statement provided Tuesday by Wisner Baum, the law firm representing Hawley’s family, his mother, Anne Hawley, said she was relieved to learn that X2 had

been permanently shut down.

“This ride should have been closed long before our son Christopher was injured, and it certainly should have been closed after he died,” Hawley said. “Instead, it took more than four years and dozens of other injured riders for Six Flags to do the right thing.”

In court filings, Six Flags and S&S Worldwide argued that Hawley had an arachnoid cyst in his brain, a preexisting condition, that had ruptured and caused bleeding.

The companies said that X2 had passed industry-standard acceleration tests in 2008, 2018 and 2023.

Russian strikes target bridges in Kyiv

Latest tactic made as India joins group pitching truce offer

By Hanna Arhirova and Barry Hutton
ASSOCIATED PRESS

KYIV, Ukraine — Russian aerial attacks forced the partial closure Friday of three bridges over the Dnipro River in Kyiv, the Ukrainian capital's mayor said, in Moscow's latest effort to disrupt life in the city.

Meanwhile, Ukraine's top diplomat said officials have received separate proposals for a partial truce with Russia from the United States, Egypt, India and Turkey. The proposals envision halting attacks on energy infrastructure, which have caused fuel shortages in Russia and power outages in Ukraine, and on Black Sea shipping needed to get vital grain exports to world markets.

Earlier, President Volodymyr Zelenskyy said Ukraine had fired a domestically made ballistic missile in combat for the first time. It is a breakthrough in Kyiv's push to field a powerful weapon that Russia has used against Ukraine to devastating effect.

Zelenskyy trumpeted the launch with a post late Thursday on social media that included a video of a missile blasting off. "Ukrainian tactical ballistics. FP-7. First combat use," he wrote.

The post did not say what was targeted, and Zelenskyy's office declined to comment.

The Russian strikes forcing the full or partial closure of three of Kyiv's six bridges caused traffic logjams and appeared to be a new tactic in its campaign to torment the city's residents. Previously,



A man grieves next to his grandmother's body Friday after a Russian airstrike in Kharkiv, Ukraine. **ANDRII MARIENKO/AP**

Russia has hit apartment blocks, supermarket warehouses, gas stations and data centers, among other targets, in an escalation of attacks.

Oleksandr Pihalo, a Kyiv resident, said traffic was "jammed solid" and it took him 45 minutes to cover 2 ½ miles. "It's a total mess on the road today," he said.

One of the three bridges was hit again Friday afternoon, Mayor Vitalii Klitschko said.

Civilians "are bearing the brunt of this war," the U.N. High Commissioner for Human Rights, Volker Türk, said Friday in Geneva.

"The war in Ukraine is a human rights catastrophe that is growing and intensifying by the week, caus-

ing unfathomable pain to civilians," he said. "Across Ukraine, people are living in constant dread."

While the aerial war has intensified in recent months, fighting along the roughly 850-mile front line snaking through northern, eastern and southern Ukraine has been virtually deadlocked. Russia invaded its neighbor more than 4 ½ years ago, and there are no concrete signs that a peace settlement might be possible.

However, Ukraine has this year made some progress against Russia's bigger army, according to the Institute for the Study of War.

Russian forces lost control over almost 3,116 square miles of Ukraine between March

and September, the Washington-based think tank said in a report late Thursday. Also, it said that the Russian military suffered more than 46,000 casualties in September, the highest monthly number this year. It did not say how many Ukrainian troops were killed or wounded.

Russia fired more than 100 drones at Ukraine overnight, striking Kyiv and eight other regions, Zelenskyy said. Almost half of the drones were the jet-powered type that are hard to stop, he said.

A drone hit a high-rise apartment block in Kyiv, killing one person, he said. At least four people were reported wounded elsewhere.

Zelenskyy repeated his

appeal for foreign countries to close loopholes in international sanctions on Russia and to add more restrictions on its trade. He said Russia's drones and missiles are "critically dependent" on foreign components.

"Every Russian drone can actually be stopped right at the production line," Zelenskyy said in a post on X.

Ukraine has also bombarded Russia with the long-range drones and missiles it now produces, aiming at military manufacturing plants and oil refineries.

The Russian Defense Ministry said Friday that its air defenses overnight downed 646 Ukrainian drones over Russian regions,

occupied Crimea, the Sea of Azov and the Black Sea.

One person was wounded in Russia's southwestern Volgograd region, Gov. Andrei Bocharov said. The attack targeted "industrial infrastructure," he said.

Ukraine's Foreign Minister Andrii Sybiha said the partial truce proposals presented to Kyiv by four countries were the first time India has offered to play a role.

India is trying to balance its ties with Russia against its growing partnerships with the United States and other Western powers. A new U.S. sanctions package on Russia could impose up to 100% tariffs on New Delhi as a major importer of Russian oil.

Sybiha said Kyiv is ready to accept a ceasefire if it stops Russian attacks on Ukraine's power grid — as well as Ukrainian strikes on Russian oil refineries — and on cargo vessels exporting grain and other farm products through the Black Sea.

"We are ready for an energy and Black Sea ceasefire, but only in that combination. Energy and a ceasefire in the Black Sea," Sybiha told reporters Thursday, in comments embargoed until Friday.

He repeated Ukraine's offer of an unconditional ceasefire on the front line. But Moscow has rejected a ceasefire, saying a comprehensive peace deal must be agreed rather than a temporary truce.

Russia's Deputy Prime Minister Alexander Novak said that Ukraine attacked four Russian oil refineries overnight, but air defenses fended off the attacks.

The New York Times contributed.

ANALYSIS

Trump puts on show for fervent fans in Oklahoma

President dangles cash, dire warnings before midterms

By Katie Rogers
THE NEW YORK TIMES

DURANT, Okla. — During the first political rally of his monthlong midterm campaign season, President Donald Trump dangled the promise of cash, played news clips, introduced former professional basketball player Dennis Rodman, presented infographics on his endorsement success rate, pulled supporters onstage, including one of his White House aides — all while asking his most faithful supporters to pretend that he is on that ballot in November.

It was over the top, even for a showman.

At stake, the president told the rapt crowd, was Republican control of Congress, a secure border and economic stability. Something else was at risk, too: "Pretend I'm running, please. If we don't win, they'll end up impeaching me," Trump said shortly after taking the stage at a

casino event center in Durant on Thursday evening.

Trump served up reliable red meat, warning the crowd about socialists, open borders and rising crime if Democrats take majority control of either chamber of Congress in November.

But he was largely preaching to his most fervent fans, not the voters he will need to elect or reelect a slate of Republicans fighting in states from Alaska to Maine. He knew it.

"It's sort of about 35 races if you want to know the truth," Trump said of the key House and Senate elections that will decide control of Congress this fall. "I'm here in Oklahoma, and I'm really here because I love you people. I had to get here! I feel a little foolish, you know? I'm saying, 'Go out and vote, go out and vote,' but they're going to win in a landslide."

Still, Trump offered support to several of the state's Republican candidates, including Mike Mazzei, whom Trump has endorsed for governor, but who has distanced himself from Trump's decision to

import beef from other countries.

Mostly, the president wanted to talk to the news cameras stationed at the back of the room. Trump again offered a cash prize of \$5,000 to every American adult if his party keeps control, earning some of the loudest applause of the evening.

"Republicans can do it and Democrats can't," Trump said. "We're taking in massive amounts of money through tariffs and record-setting economic success. Democrat policies won't allow this to happen."

In reality, the proposal for the \$5,000 checks would be prohibitively costly, at more than \$1.3 trillion. But Trump rarely concerns himself with details on the rally stage. He suggested that the money could come from investment revenue.

When confronting the matter of political survival, Trump has always returned to his political rallies, drinking in applause from an adoring audience like spiritual Red Bull. Trump hasn't done these events much lately. He has been preoccupied for



On the campaign trail before the midterms, President Donald Trump dances at a rally Thursday at the Choctaw Event Center in Durant, Oklahoma. **JULIO CORTEZ/AP**

much of his second term with foreign conflicts and building a White House ballroom, and his advisers have said that there has been no need for him to rally, because there are no more races for him to run.

But Trump understands that the political landscape looks challenging for Republicans in the midterms, even as he rages against polling that shows his unpopularity. Several candidates have distanced themselves from his decisions in recent weeks, voting to rein in his ability to continue the Iran war without congressional approval.

Others have criticized immigration enforcement policies that have sepa-

rated families. Trump has responded by lashing out, accusing the news media of not reporting his accomplishments, and seeking to bar reporters from the White House.

He coaxed an aide onstage, praising her attractiveness, loyalty and kindness. He also gazed over at her mother and father: "I see why she's good looking," Trump said. "I believe in the racehorse theory. Fast horses, right?"

Beneath the variety-show veneer was a more serious warning from Trump: all of this fun would be over if Democrats control Congress.

"The last time the radical-left Democrats had power,

they gave you the worst inflation in American history, the highest energy prices in American history, the worst trade deficit in American history," Trump said. "We've not forgotten the disasters they created, and we're never going back."

Trump also praised the U.S. military for "knocking the hell out of Iran," and said that the war would be over soon. He also praised himself for giving members of the military \$1,776 checks. That money, with a price tag of about \$2.6 billion, came from military housing funds.

"I never fail people," Trump said. "I always come through."

FBI gives staffers classified 'Patel Report' about times when it 'fell short'

By Eric Tucker
ASSOCIATED PRESS

WASHINGTON — The FBI has released a classified report to its workforce examining what it says are chapters from the bureau's history "where this institution fell short," according to an internal message obtained Friday by The Associated Press.

It was unclear what episodes from the FBI's past are chronicled in the new "Patel Report." But the document's existence is in keeping

with Director Kash Patel's frequent criticism of the leaders who preceded him as well as with his determination to rid the FBI of agents and other employees he contends have politicized the bureau in the past. Patel's critics, however, accuse him of politicizing the FBI.

Though Patel pledged at his confirmation hearing last year that he would not look "backward," he has encour-



Patel

aged investigation of former senior officials and has presided over waves of terminations, including of employees who participated in years-old investigations of President Donald Trump, were photographed taking a knee during a 2020 racial justice protest and contributed to a disputed analytical memo about Catholic extremism.

"The Patel Report looks backward because account-

ability demands it," says a memo to the workforce signed by the FBI's co-deputy directors, Christopher Raia and Andrew Bailey, that describes the document as marking the "closing of one chapter in our history and the beginning of another complete with a brighter future ahead."

Bailey announced his resignation earlier this week, and his last day is Friday. The FBI declined to comment on the report.

The message also says:

"We cannot change what happened before we arrived. But we can confront it honestly. We can recognize failures instead of protecting them. We can hold people accountable. We can fix what was broken. And we can build safeguards strong enough to ensure the mistakes of the past are never allowed to define this institution again. These steps are consistent with any institution of excellence that is constantly striving for improvement."

The FBI message says the

report is meant to "promote fierce organizational accountability" and rebuild "public trust."

But Patel's critics say the politically charged investigations into perceived adversaries of Trump that the FBI has started under his watch, as well as the punishment of agents who participated in investigations into the Republican president to which they were assigned, have eroded faith in the nation's premier federal law enforcement agency.

GOP weighed down by Trump, war

Redistricting in Texas, Florida to keep House control may backfire

By Jesse Bedayn and Bill Barrow
ASSOCIATED PRESS

HARLINGEN, Texas — Eric Flores, a former federal prosecutor and Army National Guard infantry captain, was one of the Republican Party’s prized recruits in this year’s midterm elections. With help from a redrawn congressional map in Texas, he seemed primed to dislodge longtime Democratic Rep. Vicente Gonzalez in a region that swung toward Donald Trump in the last presidential election.

Now Flores is one of several candidates in tougher races than originally envisioned as Republican-run states heeded Trump’s call to begin an unusual round of redistricting to help retain control of the U.S. House.



Republican U.S. House candidate Eric Flores knocks doors Sept. 18 in Harlingen, Texas. **JESSE BEDAYN/AP**

Republicans hoped to pick up as many as nine seats combined in Texas and Florida. But even though the districts were redrawn to make them easier to win for Republicans, the party is weighed down by the public’s dissatisfaction with Trump, the economy, the war with Iran that has raised gas prices and the president’s deportation agenda.

The political landscape is competitive enough that Vice President JD Vance was in Texas on Wednesday, appearing with Flores and promoting him up as “a fighter.” Acknowledging the broader discontentment with high prices, Vance blamed it on the “hole that Joe Biden left us,” saying the previous Democratic administration “created the problems and we’re solving them.” Vance visited Florida on Thursday.

The House Democrats’ national campaign chair, Rep. Suzan DelBene, recently was in Florida districts that Republicans are hoping to claim.

“Republicans arrogantly thought they were going to redistrict seats to pick up more,” DelBene said in an interview during her trip. “Instead, what they have is people across the state souring on the Republican agenda.”

Mike Marinella, the House Republicans’ campaign spokesman, said the party can still capitalize this year “with a more favorable map, historic fundraising and spending advantages, stronger candidates and a common-sense agenda.”

TEXAS

Republicans won 25 of Texas’ 38 seats in the U.S. House as Trump returned to the White House two years ago. Partially using that election as a baseline, the redrawn map was intended to help Republicans win up to 30 seats.

Key to this plan was the Rio Grande Valley, a heavily Latino region on the southern

tip of Texas that had shifted toward Trump.

The 34th Congressional District, where Flores is running, includes some of the valley, and it went for Trump by 10 percentage points over the Democratic nominee, Vice President Kamala Harris. But Flores said he expected his race to be close, which he credits to his opponent’s five terms in office.

Flores received Trump’s endorsement and it is still pinned to his X account, and he spoke at the president’s unusual midterm convention in Dallas. But Flores also removed from his website a promise to “SUPPORT PRESIDENT TRUMP’S AGENDA” as he looked toward general election voters and widening his base of support.

“If I tell them the red meat issues or I tell them, you know, oh, Republican, Democrat, or anything like that, you lose them,” he told The Associated Press. “I just

sell them myself, sell them what I stand for.”

Republicans in Washington acknowledge that inflation, Trump’s tariffs and the war in Iran have made their path harder. Latino voters’ discontent with Trump’s immigration agenda further scrambles their efforts.

Republicans are also facing the potential loss of an incumbent who represents a redrawn district. Rep. Monica De La Cruz, who is running for a third term, has a strong challenge from musician Bobby Pulido. A Latin Grammy winner whose top song on Spotify has 619 million streams, Pulido does not face the usual first-time candidates’ challenge of establishing name ID.

“I want a picture!” Eloise Ibarra, 42, exclaimed as Pulido walked through the crowd at a high school football game. Ibarra later said she “probably” would vote for Pulido after sitting out the last presidential race.

“I don’t really like his policies,” she said about Trump. “It’s very expensive, I go to the grocery store and buy \$50 worth of stuff and it’s like five items.”

Democrats argue that Republicans miscalculated this year.

“I think Republicans counted on Hispanics, and they counted on rural Texas, to deliver votes for them, and these are the two places that are hurting the most,” said Terri Burke of the Texas Democratic Party. Speaking of redistricting, she said, “this is really no longer such a slam dunk for the Republicans anywhere.”

FLORIDA

Republicans already had 20 out of Florida’s 28 House seats, and they wanted to boost that to 24 with their new congressional map. But much like in Texas, their plan was based on 2024 results, when voters, including many Latinos, were dissatisfied

with Biden on the economy and immigration.

Republicans went after Rep. Kathy Castor in metro Tampa and Rep. Darren Soto in the Orlando area, while putting South Florida Reps. Jared Moskowitz and Debbie Wasserman Schultz into the same district.

Moskowitz shifted to a nearby Republican-leaning district, and Wasserman Schultz ran for another term in a separate, heavily Democratic district. Castor and Soto face longer odds in their redrawn districts, though DelBene believes they have a shot in the current environment.

The new map did not stop Pia Dandiya, an Ivy League-educated school principal whose parents immigrated from India, from making her first House campaign for Congress.

She is running in the 22nd Congressional District, where Trump won by double digits in 2024 and where Republicans had hoped to pit Moskowitz against Wasserman Schultz.

But Dandiya notes that Biden outpaced Trump in the same collection of precincts in 2020, and she calls herself “a happy road warrior” as she travels 150-plus miles between campaign stops.

“The way this district has been drawn just shows yet again that we are living in a world where elected officials are choosing voters instead of voters choosing elected officials, and it should never be that way,” she said. DelBene and the Democratic Congressional Campaign Committee tapped her as one of their “Red to Blue” priority candidates.

Dandiya said voters’ current circumstances matter more than how they voted two years ago.

“Cost of living is not an issue that is exclusively impacting Democrats. It is an issue that is ubiquitous,” she said, adding that she hears the same concerns even in her district’s more conservative communities.



FlyDubai Capt. Smit Machchhar, who is recovering in a hospital, managed to open the cockpit door, allowing passengers to restrain the attacker. **ISRAEL'S FOREIGN MINISTRY**

Stabbed airline captain hailed as hero recalls ‘fighting for my life’

By Sheikh Saaliqu
ASSOCIATED PRESS

NEW DELHI — The Indian airline captain who helped thwart an apparent attempt to crash a FlyDubai flight described Friday how he fought for his life in the minutes after his co-pilot stabbed him and the plane began a steep descent.

Capt. Smit Machchhar, recovering in an Abu Dhabi hospital, told Indian Prime Minister Narendra Modi in a televised video call that he knew he had to get back on his feet to save his passengers.

“I had so many wounds. I had fallen down,” he said from the hospital, his head bandaged and tubes in his nose, before breaking down as he recalled the attack.

“I was fighting for my life. At one point, I realized that if I didn’t get up ... then passengers would lose their lives,” he told Modi.

Machchhar, who is from Mumbai, was seriously injured in Wednesday’s attack but managed to open the cockpit door, allowing passengers to enter and restrain the attacker as the Boeing 737 descended sharply, witnesses and Israeli authorities said. He has been hailed as a hero, with world

leaders saying he helped avert a disaster.

The flight, carrying 182 people from Dubai to Tel Aviv, was diverted to Tabuk in northwestern Saudi Arabia for an emergency landing. FlyDubai said Wednesday that the jet was secured by on-duty crew members “who diverted and landed the aircraft safely.”

A regional official said the crew members were pilots in training.

Israeli Prime Minister Benjamin Netanyahu said the attacker, an Omani national, was arrested in Saudi Arabia and was undergoing interrogation there. The motive for the attack was not clear.

Modi told Machchhar his “courage, patience and presence of mind” saved many lives.

Machchhar said his flying experience allowed him to sense the plane’s steep descent even after he was knocked down by the attacker.

“I have been flying planes for 17 years and serving as a captain for the last 11 years. I can sense exactly what is happening with the aircraft even with my eyes closed. When I was down, I could feel that the aircraft was plummeting,” he said.

Machchhar said that

during those difficult moments, he recited the Hanuman Chalisa, a Hindu devotional hymn dedicated to Lord Hanuman, the monkey god, and traditionally recited as a prayer for strength and courage.

“Lord Hanuman gave me courage,” he told Modi.

Machchhar, who is married and has two children, has worked for FlyDubai for about four years, according to his LinkedIn profile. Before joining the airline, he spent 11 years with SpiceJet, an Indian low-cost carrier, where he served as a senior commander and line training captain. He logged more than 9,750 flying hours with SpiceJet.

Philip Kean, CEO of Mainland Air, the New Zealand flight school where Machchhar trained, said pilots are taught how to take over if a fellow crew member becomes incapacitated.

But the training does not typically prepare them for a stabbing attack by a colleague, he said Friday.

“I don’t think there’s much in the handbook for being stabbed,” Kean said.

“You’re friends and you’re flying together,” he said. “Nobody would expect ... a person to have a go at you like that.”

Questions on aviation security further unsettle shaken region

By Sam Mednick and Aamer Madhani
ASSOCIATED PRESS

TEL AVIV, Israel — This week’s attack on a pilot by a co-pilot who tried to crash a Tel Aviv-bound flight left the region’s travel industry in crisis Friday, raising questions about aviation security and further unsettling a Middle East already shaken by the U.S.-Iran war.

Nothing is publicly known about the motive of the co-pilot, who came close to crashing the aircraft and killing all 182 people aboard Wednesday’s FlyDubai flight from Dubai. A regional investigation is underway.

The UAE has canceled all flights to Israel, complicating travel for hundreds of passengers who fly between the countries on a typical day. Israel and the UAE agreed on repatriation flights, beginning Friday, to bring back passengers stranded in the UAE after commercial travel between the two countries was suspended, according to an Israeli official who was not authorized to comment publicly and spoke on condition of anonymity.

But it was unclear late Friday whether they had begun. Earlier, the national carrier El Al said the UAE was holding up the necessary landing permits to allow it to fly into Dubai.

The Ben Gurion International Airport in Tel Aviv listed carriers Arkia and Israir with flights scheduled to arrive from Dubai late Friday and early Saturday. El Al was expected to fly passengers from Dubai to Israel on Sunday.

Dubai has been a popular destination for Israelis since Israel and the UAE established ties in 2020 as part of the Trump administration’s Abraham Accords to normalize ties between Israel and Arab countries.

Israeli Prime Minister Benjamin Netanyahu reiterated his claim on Friday that the co-pilot, identified by



Passengers from a FlyDubai aircraft that made an emergency landing in Saudi Arabia arrive Wednesday at the airport near Tel Aviv, Israel. **OHAD ZWIGENBERG/AP**

Israeli officials as an Omani citizen, had undergone “Islamist radicalization” but provided no evidence to back the assertion.

Israeli investigators are involved in the probe, but the Emiratis are in the lead, according to an official who wasn’t authorized to speak to the media and spoke on condition of anonymity. It’s unclear if the attacker was part of a group, said the official, adding that there is currently no evidence of a link with Iran.

UAE senior diplomatic adviser Anwar Gargash on Friday called the FlyDubai attack a “dangerous terrorist act” in a post on X. He credited the flight captain for preventing a catastrophe.

The moment is a test for the UAE government, which has burnished a reputation for building effective measures against extremist activities but has also bristled in the past over criticism of security lapses.

Details of the harrowing flight, which made an emergency landing in Tabuk, Saudi Arabia, continue to emerge.

The first signs of trouble came more than two hours into the flight when the aircraft suddenly dropped from 33,000 feet to 16,600 feet — the sharpest altitude drop recorded by data tracking platforms. But moments before the nosedive, passengers seated near the front of

the plane heard sounds of a fight inside the cockpit, said passenger Daniel Schlichter, who was seated in the second row.

Seconds later, it ascended to 21,725 feet before soon dropping back to 15,000 feet, which it maintained until safely landing more than an hour later.

“The plane started going down very quickly and we all went back backwards, like the gravity took us backwards,” Schlichter said. The shouting of the children as the plane plummeted, he added, was “horrific.”

“One of the things that I will never forget is the shouting of the children,” Schlichter said. “I could hear the children shouting, ‘We don’t want to die! We don’t want to die!’”

The captain managed to open the cockpit door, allowing passengers to enter and restrain the attacker as the Boeing 737 — with 174 passengers and eight crew members, most of them Israelis — descended sharply.

The passengers wrestled the co-pilot from the cockpit and onto the floor of the main cabin where they bound his hands with headphones. They laid the wounded pilot inches from him, and a dentist attended to his wounds. Schlichter and the dentist, Dr. Shota Musayev, both said there was no visible knife or other weapon at the front of the aircraft.

Jet drones outpace Ukraine defenses

Engineers racing to build interceptors that can match them

By Samya Kullab and Volodymyr Yurchuk
ASSOCIATED PRESS

KYIV, Ukraine — Russia's new class of jet-powered drones rip across the night sky in Kyiv at hundreds of miles per hour, leaving Ukrainian air-defense units only moments to intercept them. It's rarely enough time. With many of the drones getting through to the capital, defense manufacturers are scrambling to develop a new generation of interceptors to counter the deadly threat. They are building their own jet-propulsion systems and training artificial intelligence to help guide the chase.

They need to move fast because the Russian drones are driving a new tactic, ramped up in recent weeks, to hit the infrastructure keeping Ukraine's war-battered economy afloat. Recent targets have included energy systems, key industries, railways, post offices, shopping centers, telecom networks, gas stations and grain exports. Russia also has an advantage with its ballistic missile arsenal, which poses another challenge as Ukraine runs low on interceptor missiles. The effects of the barrage are being felt in Kyiv, which increasingly resembles a front-line city, without the relative safety that had long set it apart from the fighting. Food supplies have been disrupted, explosions echo day and night, and residents scramble for cover from strikes that reach closer to the city center. Ukrainian officials say they are testing new interceptors that have successfully hit jet-powered Russian drones, which fly much higher and faster than propeller-driven drones and are much harder to stop.

"They're moving so fast that we can't get a proper lock on them," said Volody-



A Ukrainian air-defense soldier gets ready to attempt to repel another drone attack from Russia on Sept. 19 in Kyiv, Ukraine. EFREM LUKATSKY/AP

myr Serdiuk, commander of an air-defense unit.

Building the prototype interceptors in sufficient numbers, and training pilots to fly them, could take up to six months, manufacturers say. President Volodymyr Zelenskyy has called for faster production.

Air-defense crews have no time to wait. Facing constant waves of drones, they improvise, but lives are lost almost daily.

Serdiuk's air-defense crew begins their night shift at 8 p.m.

He studies a tablet connected to a centralized radar system to track the sky above his sector. A circle marks the stretch of airspace his unit is responsible for protecting.

"It's like chasing a pig in the forest," he said of the new drones, which are based on Iranian-designed Shahed models.

His son is serving on the

front line in eastern Ukraine and now calls him in Kyiv just to check that he is safe, a measure of just how much life in the capital has deteriorated.

To the west, the lights of Kyiv twinkle on the horizon. To the east, the green countryside and suburbs stretch into the darkness, with a power plant visible in the distance.

Then a red marker appears on the screen, moving rapidly across the map. It's a jet-powered Shahed drone.

"Exit!" someone cries. Serdiuk looks up.

Moments later, the Shahed streaks across the night sky. It is already beyond his unit's reach. His team relies on heavy machine guns, but their rounds cannot match the drone's speed or altitude.

Then, a flash. Seconds later, the sound of an explosion reaches them from several miles away.

In that particular attack,

it was not clear if the blast was from the Russian drone that flew past them, as official channels reported, or from a Ukrainian air-defense rocket, as witnesses at the site told The Associated Press.

The same sequence happened again and again throughout the night.

Even if the drones pass directly overhead, "the problem is they're flying too high" to fire at them accurately, said Sean Almeida, a former U.S. Marine and volunteer for the unit.

Ukraine's air defenses use electronic warfare and AI to steer incoming Russian drones into narrow corridors in the sky, giving interceptors a better chance of catching them.

But the latest jet-powered Shahed drones are testing that strategy. The fastest Ukrainian interceptors typically reach 180 to 250 mph, not fast enough to meet the new threat.

Crews have started training on a new interceptor that includes a cooling system to keep its batteries from overheating as the drone is pushed to higher speeds to match the jet-powered enemy.

For now, salvation can appear on a radar screen as a blue blip representing one of Ukraine's few F-16 fighter jets, scrambled to hunt down the fastest drones. They are capable of stopping the drones, but they need a lot of maintenance. Many are currently out of service and awaiting repairs.

"It's very encouraging to see the blue part," Almeida said.

As air-defense crews hunt drones, Ukrainian engineers are racing to set up industrial production.

Ukraine had been warned that faster, jet-powered drones were coming, but manufacturers did not have a ready solution when the

new variants appeared, said Oleksii Babenko, CEO of Vyriy Drones.

Defense companies are now pursuing faster interceptors, new propulsion systems and autonomous guidance capabilities. The biggest challenge is scale. Acquiring components, testing designs and training crews take time.

Miniature turbojet engines are one of the bottlenecks, with much of the supply coming from European manufacturers whose production capacity is far below Ukraine's potential needs.

At least one Ukrainian defense company has successfully tested an interceptor against the new threat. Babenko estimates it could take three to four months to scale up and close the gap. Military analyst Taras Chmut puts the timeline at six months or more.

"Right now, we're in a race for speed," Babenko said.

NEWS BRIEFING

49th Kennedy Center Honors to take place elsewhere amid fight

FROM NEWS SERVICES

This year's Kennedy Center Honors will be held at Washington's Capital One Arena, not the riverfront building that's been at the center of a legal fight over adding President Donald Trump's name to the building.

The 49th annual awards are set to take place at Washington's downtown arena, a Kennedy Center spokesperson said Friday. Few other details were immediately available, and an explanation for the change wasn't given.

The center's board voted last month to close the iconic performing arts venue along the Potomac River waterfront after a federal judge blocked the institution from returning Trump's name to the building.

Trump has said in social media posts that the center needed to close for safety repairs.

But he said the repairs would only happen if the board was allowed to move forward with plans to add his name to the building.

A federal judge has twice said that can't happen without the approval of Congress, which has allocated \$257 million for repairs.

The president hosted the 2025 awards, whose honorees included Sylvester Stallone and George Strait. He said at the time that he would rename the facility the "Trump Kennedy Center," and not long after workers began adding his name to the building.

The board of trustees, named by Trump, voted unanimously for the change, which has been challenged in court since.

But the law explicitly prohibits the board of trustees from making the center into a memorial to anyone else, and from putting another person's name on the building's exterior.

The Kennedy Center Honors, which recognize people for lifetime contributions to American culture through the performing arts, was established in 1978. This year's event will take place Dec. 7.

Failed execution: Christa Pike was placed on a ventilator and remained unconscious in a hospital in the hours after her failed execution in Tennessee, her attorneys said in a court filing Friday.

Hospital staff, her lawyers said, were working to save Pike's life and as of late Thursday were trying to clear the two doses of the drug that the state uses to execute prisoners.

The stunning failure in Tennessee's execution chamber Wednesday night has left both sides of the death penalty debate demanding answers. Tennessee Gov. Bill Lee has ordered an independent review.

The court filing offered the first detailed account of Pike's condition after an ambulance carried her away from Riverbend Maximum Security Institution in Nashville.

Pike's attorneys said they believed problems with the IV lines caused the pentobarbital to flow into her body instead of her bloodstream.

State officials have not offered any explanations about what went wrong.

Cornell faces questions: The woman who accused members of a Cornell University fraternity of gang rape was "failed" by people obligated to protect her, including campus police and the county prosecutor, New York Gov. Kathy Hochul said Friday.

Hochul said at a news conference that she decided to appoint Attorney General Letitia James as a special prosecutor to take over the investigation after learning "troubling details" about



Anti-war protest in Germany: A sign reads "no war in my name" during a demonstration by hundreds of people against mandatory army service, increases in defense spending and against any wars Friday in Berlin. EBRAHIM NOROOZ/AP

how authorities have handled the woman's claims thus far, including that the district attorney closed the case without having anyone interview the accuser or anyone else involved in the alleged attack.

"In what world does the district attorney not even interview her, or anyone else involved, or even request the full transcript?" Hochul said. "This woman, this young woman, had already endured something that is utterly unspeakable.

"And then at every turn, she was failed by people and institutions with an obligation to protect her."

She also assailed the Cornell University Police Department for not fully conveying the woman's story to prosecutors.

"After this young woman came forward, she spoke to the police. She sat for hours and told them exactly what happened to her. And according to new reports, she could not have been clearer that she was 100% confident that she had been raped," the Democratic governor

said. "Yet, shockingly, those words never made it into the account that the Cornell police sent to prosecutors."

Mangione case: Police bodycam footage released Friday shows the moment officers located and arrested Luigi Mangione at a Pennsylvania McDonald's in connection with the shooting death of United Healthcare CEO Brian Thompson in Manhattan.

In one video, officers ask Mangione to lower the face mask he was wearing to hide his identity.

"That's 100% him," one officer says eagerly as they step outside to speak out of Mangione's earshot.

"I told you, man," another responds off camera.

Later, an officer searches Mangione's belongings and smiles widely as she pulls out a gun cartridge, seemingly confirming they'd found their suspect.

A Manhattan judge unsealed the recordings Friday after CNN petitioned for their release.

Ebola outbreak: Congo's Ebola outbreak has killed more than 4,000 people, authorities said, as they struggle to contain what has become the fastest-growing Ebola outbreak in history.

The latest figures released by the Health Ministry on Thursday showed that 4,018 people have died among 8,300 cases recorded since the outbreak was declared in eastern Congo on May 15.

The aid group Doctors Without Borders said Friday the outbreak has worsened in the North Kivu province, accounting for 40% of new confirmed cases since the end of August.

"It is like fighting a wildfire," said Stephanie Hoffman, MSF coordinator in Butembo. "Multiple outbreaks are developing at the same time, with varying intensity and in different locations."

Some health workers, meanwhile, gathered at the epicenter in Ituri Province to demand payment for wages owed to them. The protesters, who included surveillance team members, waved

placards saying, "No money, no data!" and "No payment for months."

Congolese authorities did not immediately address the issue.

Spanish housing crisis: Spain's progressive government was dealt a costly legislative defeat Friday when lawmakers rejected a package of emergency measures aimed at tackling the nation's housing affordability crisis, as protesters gathered outside Parliament demanding help for renters.

The setback sparked speculation in Spanish media that Prime Minister Pedro Sánchez could consider bringing forward elections from next year.

His office did not immediately respond to questions from The Associated Press regarding a possible snap election.

Sánchez spoke at the end of a five-hour parliamentary debate, making a last-gasp appeal to lawmakers to vote for the measures that he called "necessary."

REVIEW

Mäkelä returns to some favorite symphonists

By Hannah Edgar
FOR THE CHICAGO TRIBUNE

If there was a “greatest hits” list for Chicago Symphony music director-to-be Klaus Mäkelä, it would look a lot like his recent programs.

Over the summer at Ravinia, he conducted the complete “Firebird” from memory, the same vehicle for his CSO debut in 2022. Now, for his first residency of the 2026-27 season, he revisits symphonies he has conducted elsewhere, but not in Chicago: Jean Sibelius’s Symphony No. 7, Dmitri Shostakovich’s Symphony No. 4, and Gustav Mahler’s Symphony No. 9. (Next week is more Stravinsky and William Walton’s “Belshazzar’s Feast,” a monster he has also conquered in other cities.)

Posterity alone can determine what works or composers Mäkelä will be most associated with. But these three symphonists are surely on any working shortlist so far. His debut record was a Sibelius cycle, followed by Shostakovich’s fourth through sixth symphonies (both with the Oslo Philharmonic). His most recent is a live Mahler 8 with the Royal Concertgebouw of Amsterdam, and he’s already performed the Third and Fifth symphonies here in Chicago.

Pairing Sibelius’s elliptical last symphony and Shostakovich’s epic, long-withheld Fourth — as he and the CSO did on Sept. 24 — was an inspired move. Both symphonies teeter over an abyss: Sibelius’s over his self-imposed compositional silence, which lasted thirty more years until his death, and Shostakovich’s against state censorship, which would irrevocably change the way he wrote. Both, too, leave one aching with curiosity about where each composer might have gone next, had those chasms not opened up before them.

These symphonies are also the antithesis of crowdpleasers. They’re deeply sophisticated, conceptual and mature, even within the outputs of each of their composers.

Conducting from memory, Mäkelä’s Sibelius unspooled as one long sentence, the orchestra sounding like it was straining against gravity itself. Arrival points floated by with a buoyancy rarely achieved in this dense, monumental scoring. Then, they’d be yanked to solid, rocky earth again.

The symphony eventually untethers itself in one of the most miraculous endings in the repertoire, a brief C-major resolution, flung into the sky. Mäkelä handled this perfectly — faithful enough to convey its abruptness, but stretched out just enough to assume a sense of finality.

Just as Sibelius’s symphony is cast in one tightly crafted movement, Shostakovich’s Fourth — his most radical, and arguably his finest — at once nods to symphonic convention and shatters it. It’s structured in two massive outer movements, with a slip of a middle movement between them. (It quotes several Mahler symphonies, a nice teaser for the following week.) The CSO last played this daunting symphony nearly 20 years ago with Bernard Haitink, releasing a recording of their efforts in 2009.

The time away made itself known in occasionally shaky ensemble work. But expressively, the CSO corps were spot-on, capturing the symphony’s dizzying brutality but also its intense diligence. Though conducting with a score, Mäkelä brought the same unfussy, natural transitions of his memorized performances to this one.

This concert also revealed in the CSO’s new arrivals. Recently appointed bass clarinet Pavel Vinnitsky has sounded enchanting all season so far, whether as a soloist or a persuasive ensemble voice. (Listen for the moment in the first movement of the Shostakovich when he and English hornist Scott Hostetler sing to each other across the woodwinds.) Both symphonies also have prominent trombone sections, carried grandly and sensitively by principal Tim Higgins.

A MAHLER MISS

As he had for Sibelius, Mäkelä dispensed with the score for Mahler’s Ninth — already an audience magnet, even without a star on the podium. Thursday’s concert drew a near-capacity crowd, damp from the day’s rain.

Here, Mäkelä once again led with an assured and opinionated sense of flow. He urged the orchestra to surge past many by-now conventional slowdowns, especially in the first movement. By being more picky about when the music truly eases up, inner moments felt more precious, fragile.

That said, it didn’t feel particularly introspective. The last time the CSO played Mahler’s Symphony No. 9 at a



Klaus Mäkelä and members of the Chicago Symphony Orchestra acknowledge applause following a performance of Mahler’s Symphony No. 9 at Chicago Symphony Center on Oct. 1. **TODD ROSENBERG PHOTOS**



Principal viola Teng Li in a performance of Mahler’s Symphony No. 9 on Oct. 1.



Mäkelä leads a performance of Sibelius’s Symphony No. 7 on Sept. 24.

downtown concert, Jakub Hrůša — himself once a contender to become the CSO’s new music director — was on the podium. His Mahler 9 was tense, furious, and very, very loud.

Mäkelä’s traversal of the same symphony was different in its virtues but alike in its flaws. It was extroverted, it was heroic and, once again, almost ridiculously loud. The maximalism often echoed his apocalyptic “Rite of Spring” from earlier in the year — but I’m not convinced it fit.

That Mahler 9 confronts its composer’s own impending death is a classical music truism. The harder question is what to do with the 70-plus minutes before said death. Hrůša raged against the inevitable, while Mäkelä indulged, as though living every last scrap of life to the fullest. The hushed final bars also landed differently for each: Hrůša’s fought for breath, but Mäkelä’s was completely serene, as if knowing it was leaving a life well-lived.

When that ending came, this listener never quite grieved either loss. Both conductors seemed to have busied themselves more with the musical workings of the score rather than its emotional freight. The orchestra itself was coarser than the previous week, too, from string solos to various brass bloopers.

Those who attend Mäkelä’s fall concerts will note a shuffle onstage: He’s

swapped the cello and viola sections, with violas sitting at the edge of the stage.

“As a cellist, I used to love playing in the middle because you face the audience,” he told journalists during a rehearsal break last week. “In our orchestra, the violas have a lot of power. So, the violas could be on the side, which is often a place that is challenging.”

Having heard the new seating twice now, from both sides of the lower balcony, my early impression is that the strings sound more blended — which has pros and cons. The cellos’ warmth now suffuses through the overall ensemble, and the violas are far more subtle, coloring other lines rather than standing out on their own.

That could be problematic when the section actually needed to be heard. During their fugue entrance in the first movement of the Shostakovich, they sounded muted, as though on the other side of a thick curtain. And principal Teng Li, an extraordinarily powerful player, was still overpowered by woodwinds during her Mahler solos.

Mäkelä says he’ll assess the new seating based on musician feedback. “It might stay for now, but it might stay for the future,” he said.

Program repeats 7:30 p.m. Saturday, Oct. 3 and 3 p.m. Sunday, Oct. 4 at Chicago Symphony Center, 220 S. Michigan Ave.

Tickets \$59-\$339, chicagosymphony.org.

CHANGES AT CHICAGO SYMPHONY CENTER, INCLUDING THE NAME

The viola-cello flip isn’t the only thing different at 220 South Michigan. Last Thursday, CSO’s administration unveiled an organizational rebrand that revamped its logo, website, usher uniforms, interior decorations, and more.

It also changed the organization’s name, shifting from the cumbersome “Chicago Symphony Orchestra Association” to simply “Chicago Symphony.” Likewise, its home venue is no longer Symphony Center but “Chicago Symphony Center.” (In a city that hates name changes, the orchestra itself is still, mercifully, “the CSO.”)

The biggest changes are aesthetic. Scrubbing the bass clef that was long its trademark from every corner of Symphony Center, the organization has adopted a more minimal insignia: a red, common-time C with a streak behind it, like a serif Cleveland Cavaliers logo.

The streak is meant to be a sideways music note, representing “forward motion,” says Chicago Symphony president Jeff Alexander. Alexander did not provide an end-to-end cost of the rebranding initiative but told the Tribune it was taken from the typically allocated budgets of participating departments.

Meanwhile, the Chicago Symphony administration and orchestra officially ratified a new three-year agreement on Sept. 19. Musicians’ base compensation increased to \$206,045, with a 4% increase guaranteed for the first two years and 4.5% in the third.

The contract also allows for changes to the orchestra’s audition procedure. For the first time, candidates must submit a résumé before being invited for an audition. Prior to the new contract, the CSO was unique among peer orchestras in that its preliminary round was open to anyone.

Musicians’ committee chair Bill Buchman says the new process balances more efficient auditions and accessibility to promising musicians, regardless of background.

“Those who submit a résumé that doesn’t demonstrate professional experience of a certain level, or training of a certain kind, we ask them to submit a recording of themselves that will then determine whether they may be invited to schedule a live audition,” he said.

The CSO’s new contract places it within the top three highest compensated orchestras in the country, after the Los Angeles Philharmonic and Boston Symphony. Elsewhere, the orchestral landscape is more tumultuous. The Cleveland and San Francisco Opera orchestras recently returned to work after contract negotiations snowballed into brief strikes. Unable to square a \$10 million deficit, the Nashville Symphony — the adventurous former orchestra of Grant Park director Giancarlo Guerrero — announced this week that it suspended its 2026/27 season, as the Chicago Sinfonietta did earlier this year.

“All businesses and all orchestras go through cycles,” Alexander said. “Thankfully, we’re in a very positive cycle right now.”

Hannah Edgar is a freelance critic.



Buddy Guy performs Thursday at the Radio City Music Hall. **CHARLES SYKES/INVISION**

CELEBRITIES

Bluesman Guy feted in sold-out show

FROM NEWS SERVICES

Two months past his 90th birthday, Buddy Guy is still up for a little bragging, a lot of cursing and a long night of partying. The blues great was celebrated Thursday with a sold-out show at Radio City Music Hall in New York, where a lineup of guest musicians and a house band led by Rolling Stones drummer Steve Jordan had the audience on its feet for much of the three-hour-plus “Buddy’s Got the Blues” concert. Guy himself was only on stage part of the time, but his name was heard throughout and his spirit always present. One of the last of the Chicago bluesmen who thrived in the mid-20th century, Guy has become so much the ideal that musicians didn’t need to perform his songs to summon his legend. John Mayer, with an ache in his voice on Otis Redding’s “I’ve Got Dreams to Remember,” and Eric Gales and Joe Bonamassa jamming on the Jimmy Reed standard “Baby What You Want Me to Do,” seemed as fitting as Susan Tedeschi and Derek Trucks reviving an old Guy-Junior Wells favorite, “Messin’ with the Kid.” But no one was going

to top the guest of honor. Guy opened the show with a long, raunchy acoustic workout of John Lee Hooker’s “I’m in the Mood” and only seemed to get friskier after bringing out his electric guitar. He joked with longtime friend Shemekia Copeland on a duet of “Rock Me Baby,” left no doubt about the meaning of “to buzz all night long” in Slim Harpo’s “I’m a King Bee” and carried on a lot more when joined by one of his few contemporaries, Bobby Rush. Everyone came on at the end for an all-out, self-fulfilling “Got My Mojo Workin’.” Guy is still making plans. His team announced this week that he has a new album out next year, produced by Jordan and featuring Ivan Neville, Willie Weeks and others who played at Radio City Music Hall. Guy didn’t seem at first to have a lot on his mind Thursday, but the tributes offered by the performers and the presence of Rush, who testified that he would have walked from Mississippi just to be here, left him moved and near tears. “I didn’t think this many people would be coming out for a 90 year old man,” Guy said. “This is the greatest day I ever had in my life.”

Bush weds Harris in private ceremony: Actor Sophia Bush and soccer star Ashlyn Harris were secretly married last year, the “One Tree Hill” alum reveals in an upcoming memoir. The private ceremony in upstate New York in summer 2025 was just this side of an elopement, with Harris’ children the main attendees, Vogue reported, citing “And I Will Tell You Mine: Notes from a Life in Progress,” due out Oct. 27. The newlyweds, first linked in 2023, officially came out in 2024. They’ve spent the past year visiting family and friends to deliver their happy news in person, the couple told Vogue. The low-key ceremony featured flowers they picked themselves, and their wedding night saw everyone roasting marshmallows. “The kids were just running and happy,” Harris said. **Oct. 3 birthdays:** Singer Chubby Checker is 85. Musician Lindsey Buckingham is 77. Drummer Tommy Lee is 64. Actor Clive Owen is 62. Singer Gwen Stefani is 57. Actor Neve Campbell is 53. Singer India.Arie is 51. Actor Tessa Thompson is 43. Rapper A\$AP Rocky is 37. Actor Alicia Vikander is 38. Actor Noah Schnapp is 22.

Neighbors shame underweight woman, press her to eat more



R. Eric Thomas
ASKING ERIC

Dear Eric: I struggle with a post-surgical medical condition that has required me to be on IV nutrition daily and I have lost a considerable amount of weight. I do enjoy food, but I cannot eat much. I was happy to attend a cookout and meet folks in my community, but I was overwhelmed by strangers telling me that I needed to eat. I brought a dish and I loved tasting a bit of everything that was offered, and I welcomed the opportunity to meet my neighbors. I’m grateful I’m feeling well enough to socialize. Several women who I had never met cornered me and said that I was too skinny and I needed to eat more. I said I was enjoying the food and the company, but they wouldn’t let it go. Two of them filled a plate, placed it in front of me and told me to eat. I said, “No thank you. I’ve enjoyed what I have eaten.” They kept pushing me, saying I was too skinny and I looked like a gangly young boy (I’m a 54-year-old woman), but I knew if I pushed myself to eat, I would be sick. I continued to say, “No thank you,” but they kept going on about how bad my body looked so I left before I started to cry. Should I have told them about my medical history? I feel as though politely declining extra food should have been sufficient and I don’t feel as though I need to disclose my condition to defend myself. I would love to be more active in my community as I get stronger, but I don’t have the constitution to

handle body shaming. I don’t need to be told that I am underweight. I am well aware of it and I struggle every day. — *Skinny and Hungry* **Dear Skinny and Hungry:** Those women may have thought they had good intentions, but they were bullying you and you didn’t owe them anything more than the response you gave. Even if you didn’t have a medical condition, they don’t have any right to goad you into eating more. One plate at a cookout is not going to meaningfully impact your weight. And it’s outrageous that strangers think they can offer unsolicited advice on another person’s body. Don’t let their shocking lack of boundaries keep you away from social gatherings. Hopefully the other people in your community have better manners. If these strangers approach you again, you can be firm and clear, “your comments about my body aren’t welcome and I won’t tolerate any more.” **Dear Eric:** I really like entertaining. I’m obsessed with Ina Garten. I tell other people she’s my celebrity mom. People always seem to have a good time when they come over to my house. But the problem is my “Jeffrey.” Ina’s Jeffrey is her husband, who is really supportive and basically loves everything his wife does. My Jeffrey is an introvert who doesn’t understand why I spend so much on flowers that are just going to die or linen napkins when “paper is just fine.” I don’t think my husband likes my parties. He always looks miserable when I say I’m inviting another couple over. This is a major part of who I am, and it always has been. But he’s never really gotten into it. I don’t know what to do to make

my Jeffrey more like Ina’s Jeffrey. Help? — *Kinda Garten* **Dear Kinda:** Who doesn’t love Ina? She’s incredibly intelligent, creative, funny, and seemingly a blast to be around. She’s one-of-a-kind. That last part is crucial. There’s no other Ina. And there’s no other Jeffrey. So, it’s time to embrace the fact that you’re your own person, with your own relationship, and your husband is not Jeffrey. One of Ina Garten’s most famous memes finds her suggesting a specific bespoke ingredient or meal component and then adding, “or if you don’t have that, store-bought is fine.” There’s a lesson here. I’m not saying that your husband is “store-bought.” I’m saying that it’s important to accept what we have and enjoy it. Part of that acceptance may involve recognizing that your husband may not be the right audience for all your gatherings. If you have a desire to have a big, extrovert-filled event, perhaps that’s an opportunity for you two to make separate plans. To wit, Jeffrey doesn’t co-host Ina’s shows with her. Jeffrey (a noted economist) does whatever Jeffrey does with his days. It doesn’t have to be an event for both of you. Concomitantly, you may want to think about how you might tailor an event to his style of engaging, so that you get to host like you like to and he, and any other introverts in your life, can find a comfortable entry point. *Send questions to eric@askingeric.com or P.O. Box 22474, Philadelphia, PA 19110. Follow him on Instagram and sign up for his weekly newsletter at rericthomas.com.* *Copyright 2026. Distributed by Tribune Content Agency*

Classic rock band still creating new music even after 50 years

Note to readers: Publishers Weekly was unable to provide the national bestsellers lists by press time. **By Jim Harrington**
SAN JOSE MERCURY NEWS

Lawrence Gowan, the vastly talented vocalist-keyboardist, comes across every bit as enthusiastic and energetic online as he does on the stage with Styx, the classic-rock act he’s been helping lead ever since Dennis DeYoung was booted from the fold at the end of the ’90s. Gowan, a classically trained pianist who also forged a successful solo music career in Canada in the ’80s and ’90s, made his Styx recording debut with “Cyclorama” in 2003 and has been on all of the band’s albums that have followed. Of course, these newer offerings don’t get the attention bestowed on the multiplatinum-selling classics — like 1978’s “Pieces of Eight” or 1981’s “Paradise Theatre.” Yet, the Styx recordings featuring Gowan — including last year’s “Circling from Above” — are all enjoyable and worth the attention of classic rock fans. The same can be said for the group’s live show, which I can attest that the 2026 version of Styx — featuring Gowan, Todd Sucherman, James “JY” Young, Tommy Shaw, Terry Gowan, Will Evankovich and, in a reduced role, Chuck Panozzo — still rocks. This interview with Lawrence Gowan has been edited for clarity and length.

Q: Do you have a first memory of hearing Styx? **A:** There was a record store in Toronto called Sam the Record Man and that was very much kind of a real listening post. I would go into that record store three-four times a week,



Lawrence Gowan performs with his band Styx in Nashville, Tennessee. **JASON KEMPIN/GETTY 2024**

just to kind of look at album covers and listen to whatever the guy at the desk was playing. He was like the equivalent of the local disc jockey. He was the arbiter of taste, because whatever he’s kind of already gleaned, having gone through a good number of records, probably during the day when the store is empty, just determined what’s going to be played. I remember that I’d heard (Styx’s) “Lorelei” and “Crystal Ball” on the radio in Toronto. And I really liked both those songs. I assumed that the band was from England because they had this kind of progressive rock sound and I thought they were just singing with quasi-American accents. **Q: Because the band had so much success with power ballads and straight-ahead rockers, do you think people sometimes overlook or downplay Styx’s prowess in the prog-rock world?** **A:** Really good question. I think the heat of a hit single can categorize a band forever in the general public’s mind. It’s quite possible there are people who know “Owner of a Lonely Heart” by Yes — which is progressive, but at the same time very much ’80s and using Trevor Horn’s production — and not know that the same band would do something like “Tales from Topo-

graphic Ocean” or “Close to the Edge,” something that’s a much kind of deeper dive, so to speak, into the progressive world. **Q: For many of your contemporaries, the words “new material” can be quite taboo. But Styx makes new material a priority, as if you’re saying to listeners: “We’re not just a nostalgia act, and creating new songs is important to us.”** **A:** You couldn’t have put that better, quite honestly. This is Styx’s 54th year of existence now. And there’s never going to be a Styx show where we’re not going to play “Come Sail Away,” “Fooling Yourself,” “Blue Collar Man,” “Grand Illusion” and ... I could keep going. Those have to be in every show. That’s what most people have bought tickets to hear. But as new musical ideas come into our heads, it keeps us engaged. And it’s not about reaching the top of the charts that is driving it. It’s more to do with keeping the audience out there fully engaged in the fact that, “Wow, they’re still doing new things, they’re still finding new ways of extending what Styx can explore musically.” These are really vitally important things to us, and as long as everyone’s committed to do it and leaning into it, then it’s very worthwhile to push on and do it.



Gracie Abrams performs in May 2023 in Nashville, Tennessee. **GEORGE WALKER IV/AP**

MUSIC REVIEW

Abrams treats fans to strengthened voice, carefully written lyrics on LP

By Elise Ryan
ASSOCIATED PRESS

Crises loom across singer-songwriter Gracie Abrams’ third album, “Daughter from Hell.” A knife — stabbed in the heart or stuck in her side — appears as a repeated motif. “Hell” takes on different forms; it’s an insult thrown in “Sober” and a place she breaks away from in the title track. The project finds Abrams in a darker place than her previous two records. But by employing a broader array of instruments and production styles, the resulting 16 tracks live up to the bigger arenas she now fills, even if many of the songs feel like a return to her introspective form. Electric guitar opens the title track, where Abrams’ layered voice longs for the traits of her mother: “And I want your patience / I want your grace / I want your sugar,” she sings. Aaron Dessner, a collaborator on Abrams’ previous projects, co-writes and produces across the album. Here, his touch is felt in the guitar riffs that build toward the song’s midpoint, and the shaker and tambourine that fill them out. The pair flex across the tracks; Abrams’ poetic



‘DAUGHTER FROM HELL’
Gracie Abrams (Interscope)

language only sometimes tripping on itself. On the acoustic guitar and piano-set ballad “Death Wish,” she reflects on a fractured relationship. “How long will you give me?” she pleads before the pace picks up. “Till you twist the knife with a smile while you kill me?” “The Knife,” a highlight, immediately follows as Abrams examines her own affinity for recklessness. Her voice, occasionally lowered to a bedroom-pop whisper (fans of her early work will be drawn to the lilting “Good Reason” and the sweet and synth “Afflictions”), has strengthened since her restrained debut, 2023’s “Good Riddance.” As the track builds — starting as a stripped back piano ballad, before turning itself over to

drums, guitar and a 21-piece orchestra — so does her confidence. The influence of Phoebe Bridgers is felt in that second-half surge. The anxious “Look at My Life” (co-produced by Dan Nigro) carries some of the same fast-paced energy of her song “Risk.” This time the focus is on her mental health, and the disassociation required of her only-growing fame, rather than the more universal thrill of a new crush. “Mini Bar,” written with friend and “Sue Me” hitmaker Audrey Hobert, offers some levity, both with its buoyant sound and cheeky lyrics. Backing vocals from Bon Iver’s Justin Vernon add dimension to a few tracks, including “Broke My Heart,” while a feature from Marcus Mumford fills out “What if it’s right?” Actor Paul Mescal, Abrams’ boyfriend, cowrites “Imaginary Friend.” Lyrically, the beautiful “Humming” is the album’s most ambitious. Abrams is confronted with the heavy realities of the world that’s raising her. “Do we stay numb? / But you can’t when you’ve seen / How they all get off on their grieving,” she sings, her words chosen carefully. As they always have been.

What to watch SATURDAY

October 3, 2026

All times Central. Start times can vary based on cable/satellite provider. Confirm times on your on-screen guide.

MLB Playoffs: Division Series: Game 1

TBS/truTV & FOX/FS1, beginning at noon Live

The best-of-five-game Division Series opens today with the American League on TBS and truTV, and the National League on FOX or FS1.

A Knight to Remember

Hallmark Channel, 7 p.m. ■ Original Film

A statue of an English knight (James Trevena) arrives in Chicago for an art exhibit and things get a little crazy. While cleaning the statue, museum conservator Emily (Julie Gonzalo) impulsively kisses the statue, bringing him to life.

A Doctor to Die For: The Sarah Harris Story

Lifetime, 7 p.m. ■ Original Film

Based on a true story, the film follows Sarah (Siobhan Williams), a young woman drawn into a dangerous relationship with a middle-aged oral surgeon, Dr. James Ryan (Luke Macfarlane), with a mysterious past.

Austin City Limits

PBS, 10 p.m. (KETC St. Louis, 11 p.m.; Not available in Chicago)

English singer-songwriter Sienna Spiro performs highlights from her acclaimed debut studio album *Visitor*, released in July.

Saturday Night Live

NBC, 10:25 p.m. Live

Dakota Johnson (*Verity*) hosts with musical guest Turnstile (“Birds”).



ALLISTER FOSTER, HALLMARK MEDIA

CATCH A CLASSIC Two for One: John Turturro

TCM, beginning at 7 p.m.

John Turturro, known for playing fierce, unforgettable characters ranging from pizza maker Pino in *Do the Right Thing* (1989) to crime boss Carmine Falcone in *The Batman* (2022), shares two of his favorite films tonight. First is 1947's **Out of the Past (pictured)**, widely regarded as the gold standard of film noir. Robert Mitchum delivers a definitive performance as a quiet gas station owner whose dark past as a private detective catches up with him through a dangerous assignment for a ruthless gambler, played by Kirk Douglas. Jane Greer costars as the ultimate femme fatale. Following that is **The Set-Up** (1949),



RKO RADIO PICTURES

directed by Robert Wise, a gritty, 73-minute film noir that unfolds in real time. Robert Ryan stars as Bill “Stoker” Thompson, an aging fighter whose crooked manager secretly takes a bribe for him to lose his next match. Stacked against a much younger and fitter opponent, with a large bet riding on his fall, Stoker must decide whether to surrender or go down fighting.

MOVIES YOU’LL LOVE



BROOKE PALMER

Little Nicky (2000, Comedy) Adam Sandler, Patricia Arquette **VH1, 5 p.m.**

Oppenheimer (2023, Biography) Cillian Murphy, Emily Blunt **E!, 5 p.m.**

It (2017, Horror) Jaeden Lieberher, Jeremy Ray Taylor **AMC, 6 p.m.**

Thor: The Dark World (2013, Action) Chris Hemsworth, Natalie Portman **FX, 6 p.m.**

Grumpy Old Men (1993, Comedy) Jack Lemmon, Walter Matthau **CMT, 6:15 p.m.**

Bean (1997, Comedy) Rowan Atkinson, Peter MacNicol **VH1, 7 p.m.**

Trading Places (1983, Comedy) Dan Aykroyd, Eddie Murphy **Sundance, 7 p.m.**

Grizzly Night (2025, Drama) Charles Esten, Oded Fehr **SHO, 8 p.m.**

Step Brothers (2008, Comedy) Will Ferrell, John C. Reilly **Comedy Central, 8 p.m.**

Ghostbusters (1984, Comedy) Bill Murray, Dan Aykroyd **FX, 8:30 p.m.**

Carrie (2013, Horror) Chloë Grace Moretz, Julianne Moore **AMC, 9 p.m.**

Hostel (2005, Horror) Jay Hernandez, Derek Richardson **IFC, 9:45 p.m.**

Lee Cronin’s The Mummy (2026, Horror) Jack Reynor, Laia Costa **HBO, 10:25 p.m.**

Addams Family Values (1993, Comedy) Anjelica Huston, Raul Julia **Freeform, 10:55 p.m.**

From the editors of TV Weekly and tvinsider.com



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“The Secret Lives of Mormon Wives” will spin off a second series based in Orange County, the Hulu streaming service announced at an event on April 22. **FRANK MICELOTTA/DISNEY**

TV NEWS

‘Mormon Wives’ set up secret lives in Orange County spinoff

FROM NEWS SERVICES

The Orange County-based spinoff of “The Secret Lives of Mormon Wives” will premiere Nov. 12. “The Secret Lives of Mormon Wives: Orange County” is the first new version of the series that originated in Utah in 2024 and has aired five seasons so far on Hulu and Hulu on Disney+.

Unlike “The Real Housewives of Orange County,” which airs a new episode once a week, “The Secret Lives of Mormon Wives: Orange County” will drop all 10 episodes of its debut season Nov. 12, making it a bingeable alternative to the traditional style of weekly episodes.

The series includes Jen Affleck, who was a cast member of the original “Secret Lives of Mormon Wives” series.

The other eight wives include Bobbi Althoff and Aspyr Ovard, both of whom are well-known influencers, as well as McCall DaPron, who is the sister of Mayci Neeley, another of the original “Mormon Wives.”

Salomé Andrea, Madison Bontempo, Chandler Higginson Brooks, Ashleigh Pease and Avery Woods round out the Orange County cast members.

It’s likely that the arrival of “Mormon Wives: Orange County” will collide briefly with “Real Housewives of Orange County.”

If the housewives keep to the 20-episode seasons of recent vintage, they should be smack in the middle of a trio of reunion shows when the “Mormon Wives” land in O.C.

‘Game of Thrones’ movie will hit theaters in 2029: The Targaryens are looking to conquer the summer box office.

“Game of Thrones: Aegon’s Conquest” will hit theaters June 1, 2029, according to Deadline.

The movie, written by “House of Cards” showrunner Beau Willimon, will reportedly be directed by Owen Harris. Harris directed three episodes of the “Game of Thrones” spinoff “A Knight of the Seven Kingdoms.”

Additional details, including the movie’s story, have yet to be revealed. The title hints that the film will follow Aegon the Conqueror, who, along with his sister-wives Visenya and Rhaenys, invaded Westeros and conquered most of the Seven Kingdoms with the help of their dragons, Balerion, Vhagar and Meraxes.

Following his victory, King Aegon I became the

first monarch to rule Westeros from the Iron Throne and the founder of the Targaryen dynasty. The conquest took place around 300 years before the events of “Game of Thrones” and is detailed in George R.R. Martin’s book “Fire & Blood.”

“Aegon’s Conquest” would mark the first time the original Aegon is depicted onscreen, but the “Game of Thrones” franchise has featured multiple Aegon Targaryens over the years.

Bush joins Fox News Media: Billy Bush, the veteran on-air host, has signed on as a contributor to Fox News.

Bush will comment on cultural issues across Fox News Media platforms. He made his first appearance recently on Fox News Channel’s “Jesse Watters Primetime.”

“I’m excited to join Fox News Media and its loyal audience to share my perspective on the people, ideas and moments shaping today’s culture as well as the ones trying to undo it!” Bush, 54, said in a statement.

Bush currently hosts a digital show, “Hot Mics with Billy Bush,” that covers sports, politics, entertainment, tech and pop culture.

Crossword

1	2	3	4		5	6	7	8	9		10	11	12	13
14					15						16			
17					18						19			
20					21						22		23	
			24						25			26		
27	28				29		30	31		32				
33				34					35		36		37	38
40							41					42		
43					44					46	47			
				48		49		50					51	
52	53	54					55			56		57		
58					59			60	61				62	63
64				65		66						67		
68						69						70		
71						72						73		

By Stella Zawistowski. © 2026 Tribune Content Agency, LLC. All rights reserved.

10/3/26

ACROSS

- “___ is it!”
- Bacon slice
- Catalog
- Angry tirade
- Author Viet ___ Nguyen
- Fascinated by
- López of baseball
- Total stranger, slangily
- Garden area
- 1994 Disney film: 3 wds.
- Adam’s mate
- Put at stake
- 25 Added bubbles to
- Lamb’s bleat
- Contort
- Knight’s title
- Upward rise
- Rich cake
- Louse eggs
- “Takes ___ to tango”
- Breakfast or dinner
- Sharp intakes of breath
- Captures the attention of
- Japanese money
- Actress Elisabeth
- Eisenhower’s nickname

- Grilled sandwich
- At any ___
- The whole shebang
- Tool for turning
- Singer Ora
- Allowed by Islamic law
- Tax
- “___ my dead body!”
- Nail polish brand
- Family diagram
- Tenure in office
- Auditorium capacity
- Government IDs: Abbr.

DOWN

- Moderate pace
- KJV Bible verb
- Works together (with)
- Vodka brand
- Golf hits
- Comparison word
- Military position
- Mumbai’s land
- Samsung products
- Raised edge
- Arm of the sea
- Kitchen appliance
- Carried along
- Book’s ID: Abbr.

Solutions

S	N	S	S		S	L	V	E	S		W	R	E	L
E	E	R	L		E	I	S	S	E		R	E	A	O
A	A	E	T		T	V	T	V	H		V	L	I	R
R	E	A	I		R	D	M	E	R	O	S		T	V
			E	L	V	R			E	I	S	V	O	L
E	K	I		E	N	H	S		N	E	A			
S	T	T	V	R	H	L	N	E		S	d	S	V	O
T	V	E	W		O	M	L			S	L	I	N	
E	L	R	O	L		N	O	I	S	N	E	O	S	V
					R	I	S		d	N	E	B		V
D	E	L	V	R	E	V			X	S	I	R		
E	A	E			O	N	I	X	N	O	I	T	E	H
L	O	T	d		O	D	N	V	R		O	L	L	O
O	L	N	I		H	N	V	H	L		L	N	V	R
L	S	I	T		d	I	R	L	S		S	I	H	L

- Unyielding courage
- Pleasant scent
- Explosion sound
- Japan’s region
- Evening, for short
- Football attempts
- Sports awards
- Actor Chris
- Late-game pitchers
- Chat
- “Need anything ___?”
- Tennis-match parts

- Track obstacles
- Hindmost
- Small market segments
- Divination deck
- ___ Garden
- Make changes to
- Wipe data from
- Leans slightly
- “Frozen” queen
- Bide your time
- Smooth-surfaced
- Some whiskeys
- Pitcher’s moneymaker

Horoscopes



If October 3 is your birthday: October could be a big month for you, beginning the process of turning 2026 around into a much better year. An insight or a series of them could reset your mind and give you new strength. Be sure something has both merit and transparency before you bring your belief.

Aries (March 21-April 19): Stars are climbing nicely for the next week and moves made during this time will have better odds of better outcomes.

Taurus (April 20-May 20): Even the most basic tasks can become easier and more effective if you're open to learning new techniques and methods.

Gemini (May 21-June 20): Finding ways to bring creative joys into your daily process could make life sweeter — new ideas could beckon.

Cancer (June 21-July 22): After an emotional day or so, today you could appear to be all business. Your home space could get an important reset in the next week, don't be afraid to embrace something new and better.

Leo (July 23-Aug. 22): Logic could be building, the same with wisdom. Your insights could be especially powerful in the next few days. Note them down and share them with others.

Virgo (Aug. 23-Sept. 22): Dial in your knowledge about money, both transactional and energetic. And, be open to deeper understanding. The next few days could be pivotal in your relationship with abundance.

Libra (Sept. 23-Oct. 22): Your thoughts about your relationship with the world, including career, could shift from more emotional to more practical quickly.

Scorpio (Oct. 23-Nov. 21): You might get a better reception teaching reality hacks instead of making emotional arguments. The next four days could bring an understanding that could be life changing. Pay attention.

Sagittarius (Nov. 22-Dec. 21): Get your mind clear and your emotions quieted before you try to discuss any kind of money situation — it's about more than recognition right now.

Capricorn (Dec. 22-Jan. 19): If you're coming from two different places it can be hard to get on the same page. Give it a few hours at least.

Aquarius (Jan. 20-Feb. 18): Lean into what you know works for getting things done, that's the likely road to better progress now. It's important to keep knowledge circulating, share what you know and what you learn.

Pisces (Feb. 19-March 20): While you may have a broader understanding, pesky details and uncooperative people could keep the situation chained to the ground for a while longer.

— Magi Helena, Tribune Content Agency

The Argyle Sweater By Scott Hilburn



Bliss By Harry Bliss



Bridge

Both vulnerable, South deals

North		East	
♠	K Q 10 8 4	♠	6
♥	Q 6	♥	10 8 5 3 2
♦	Q J 7	♦	6 4
♣	K Q 6	♣	J 10 9 4 2
South			
♠	A J 7 5		
♥	A J 7		
♦	K 9 8 5		
♣	A 5		

South's jump to three spades showed a maximum with four-card support. It was possible to be off the ace-king in a red suit, but North was not the type to worry. He blasted into slam after learning that South had three key cards. Zero or three but surely three on the bidding. South won the opening trump lead in hand with the jack and saw that a successful heart finesse would see the contract home safe. A three-three diamond split, or the fall of the 10, would provide 12 tricks without the need for a finesse. South led a spade to the king and a spade back to his ace, drawing trumps. He followed with a low diamond toward the queen, as the contract was always cold if West held the ace of diamonds. West had to duck or give up the twelfth trick, so the queen took the trick.

South came back to his hand with ace of clubs to lead a low diamond. West had to duck again, so South took dummy's jack and cashed the king and queen of clubs, discarding the nine of diamonds from his hand. He led a diamond to West's ace and West had to lead a heart or give up a ruff-sluff, the contract making either way. Had East been able to win the first diamond and shift to a heart, South would have risen with his ace and cashed all his black-suit winners. He would still have had excellent chances to make his contract, although it would not have been cold. Nicely played!

— Bob Jones, Tribune Content Agency

Grand Avenue By Mike Thompson



Baby Blues By Rick Kirkman and Jerry Scott



Zits By Jerry Scott and Jim Borgman



Mr. Boffo By Joe Martin



Frazz By Jef Mallett



Classic Peanuts By Charles Schulz



Pickles By Brian Crane



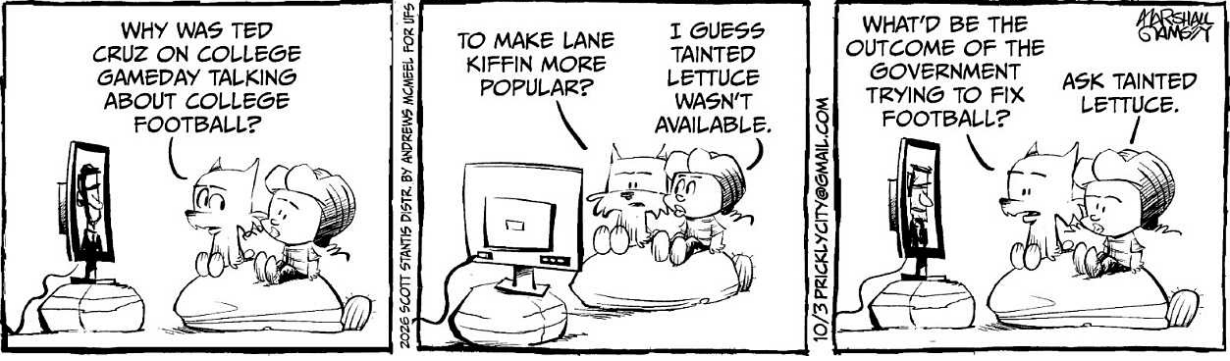
Dick Tracy By Charles Ettinger and Mike Curtis



Animal Crackers By Mike Osburn



Prickly City By Marshall Ramsey



Dustin By Steve Kelley and Jeff Parker



For Better or for Worse By Lynn Johnston



Blondie By Dean Young and John Marshall



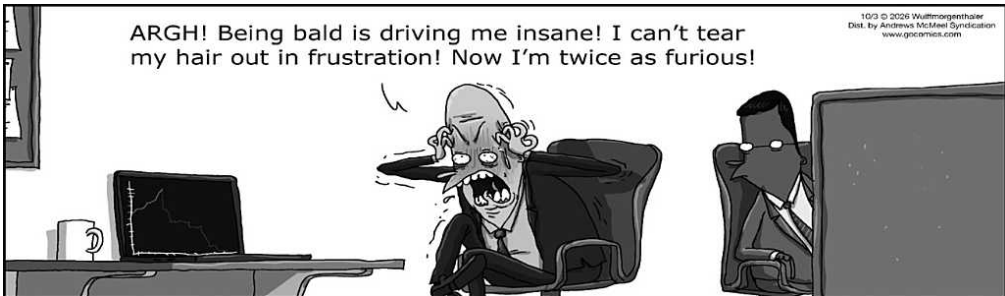
Hägar the Horrible By Chris Browne



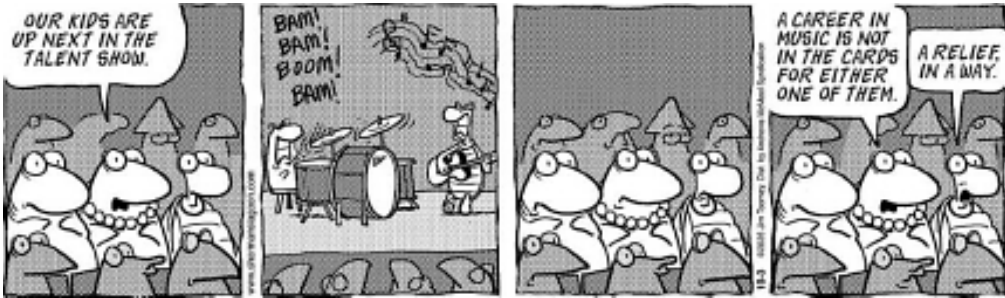
Mutts By Patrick McDonnell



WuMo By Mikael Wulff and Anders Morgenthaler



Sherman's Lagoon By Jim Toomey



Brewster Rockit: Space Guy! By Tim Rickard



Broom-Hilda By Russell Myers



Trivia Bits

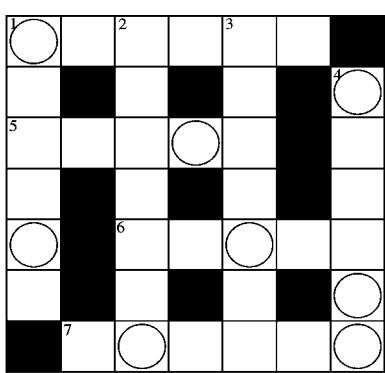
Why does the planet Neptune appear to be blue?

- A) It's surrounded by methane gas.
- B) It's covered with algae-filled water.
- C) The rocks on its surface are blue.
- D) The color is determined by its distance from the sun.

Friday's answer: South Africa.

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Jumble Crossword



10-3-26

DOUBLE BONUS

The circled letters can be unscrambled to form two different BONUS answers.

By David L. Hoyt.

CLUE

- 1. Dry, barren region
- 2. Back
- 3. Set aside
- 4. Turned into currency

CLUE

- 1. Hold
- 2. Back
- 3. Set aside
- 4. Turned into currency

How to play - Complete the crossword puzzle by looking at the clues and unscrambling the answers. When the puzzle is complete, unscramble the circled letters to solve the BONUS.

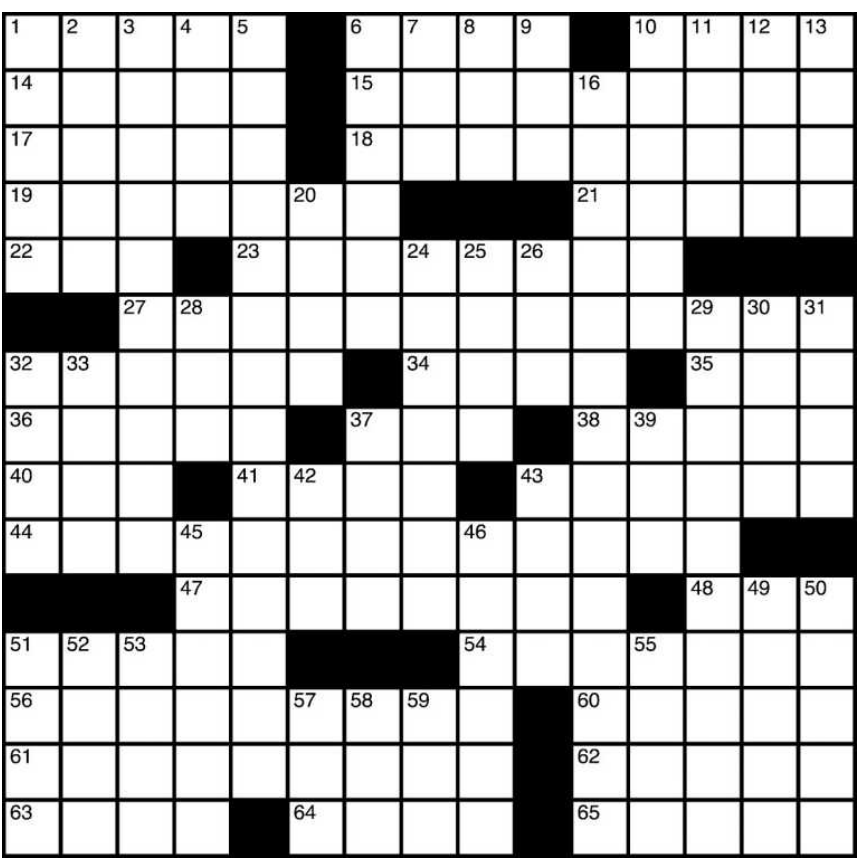
CLUE: Led

CLUE: Attributed

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Crossword



Across

- 1 Item dropped in the drink
- 6 Chiromancer's target
- 10 Overwhelm
- 14 Hair extension
- 15 Cookies and cream treat
- 17 Baseball's all-time RBI leader
- 18 Rescuers on the run?
- 19 Bases for busts
- 21 Not accidental
- 22 Oft-redacted fig.
- 23 Many an adoptee
- 27 Ones correcting they're gaffes, perhaps?
- 32 French "deadly"
- 34 Christmas song
- 35 "Pass"
- 36 Tough to form a bond with
- 37 Media that led to record losses

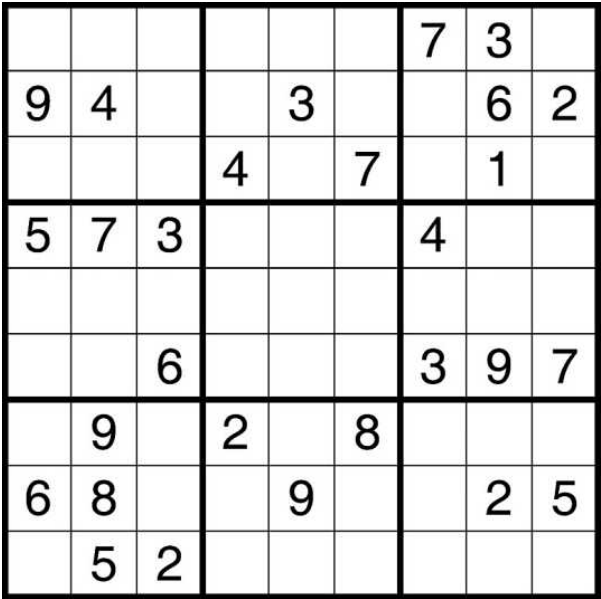
Friday's solution



By Tom Pepper. Edited by Patti Varol. © 2026 Tribune Content Agency, LLC.

Sudoku

10/3



4	7	9	6	1	8	5	2	3
6	1	3	5	2	4	9	8	7
5	8	2	7	9	3	1	4	6
3	9	1	2	4	5	7	6	8
2	5	8	9	7	6	4	3	1
7	6	4	8	3	1	2	9	5
8	2	7	3	5	9	6	1	4
9	4	6	1	8	7	3	5	2
1	3	5	4	6	2	8	7	9

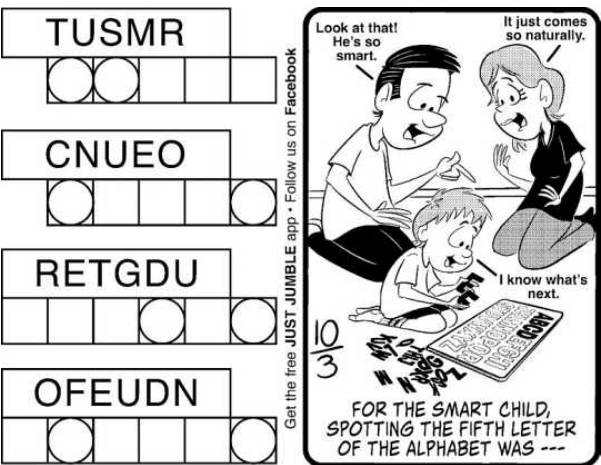
Complete the grid so each row, column and 3-by-3 box in bold borders contains every digit 1 to 9.

Friday's solutions

By The Mephram Group
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Jumble

Unscramble the four Jumbles, one letter per square, to form four words. Then arrange the circled letters to form the surprise answer, as suggested by this cartoon.



Answer here

" - " " "

Friday's answers

Jumbles: USHER FEVER EMBLEM ELICIT
Answer: The lawyers who had faith that teaming up would result in success were — FIRM BELIEVERS

By David L. Hoyt and Jeff Knurek. © 2026 Tribune Content Agency, LLC. All rights reserved. PlayJumble.com

- 24 Long jumper's destination
- 25 Olympic archer?
- 26 Safety gear for ER workers
- 28 "The White Tiger" actor Rajkummar
- 29 On easy street
- 30 Sandra's "Ocean's 8" co-star
- 31 DIY help site
- 32 "Fire Country" actress Diane
- 33 Chewy brand
- 37 Lombardy birthplace of Pliny the Elder and Pliny the Younger
- 39 "Ugh!"
- 42 Not square
- 43 Spot for unique gifts
- 45 Mike Brown's NBA team
- 46 Afternoon outing?
- 49 "Almost Famous" director
- 50 Underground government operation?
- 51 Reddish-brown horses
- 52 Toner additive
- 53 Turn on an axis
- 55 Toffee bar
- 57 Certain parent
- 58 57-Down in a meadow
- 59 Semi

Want more PUZZLES?
Go to chicagotribune.com/games

MAKE BAD BOTS SHOW THEMSELVES.

Bad bots steal content, drive up costs, and crowd out real users. Some even hijack devices in American homes to appear human and evade detection. There might be Chinese bots using your phone right now.

The **Stealth Bot Prohibition Act** would force bad bots to reveal their identities, giving businesses, news publishers, and web hosts the information they need to protect their work.



TELL CONGRESS TO ACT.

Contact your members of Congress today and ask them to co-sponsor the Stealth Bot Prohibition Act.
NewsMediaAlliance.org/StopBadBots



Sox break pitching traditions

They don't have a rotation, but it doesn't matter

CLEVELAND — If you're a baseball fan of a certain age, you've probably spent most of your life knowing some certainties about a pitching staff. The five best guys (or four if you're really old) are the starters who will try to get you through the bulk of the game. The best reliever is the closer, who pitches the last inning or possi-



Paul Sullivan
IN THE WAKE
OF THE NEWS

bly part of the eighth if he's dominant enough. The next-best relievers — preferably one left-hander and one right-hander — are the setup men, the potential bridges from starter to closer. And the pitcher who is least effective on the staff is the mop-up man, whose main function is keeping the better relievers from being

overused. For years managers used that basic blueprint, or something close to it, to get through the regular season. Then when the playoffs arrived, the best three or four starters went longer because the season was almost over and they could empty their bullets in the biggest games. But baseball has changed, for better or worse, and now anything goes. Boston Red Sox ace Sonny Gray was removed in the fifth inning of a do-or-die wild-card game Wednesday, and Gray and

his teammates grumbled about how the game got to this point. Which brings us to the 2026 Chicago White Sox, who are trying to win with a "no-rotation" rotation. Will Venable, the second-year White Sox manager, announced Friday that left-handed reliever Hagen Smith would start Game 1 of the American League Division Series against the Cleveland Guardians, serving as the opener Saturday, as he did in pitching

See SULLIVAN on Page C3

AL DIVISION SERIES White Sox vs. Guardians

All games on TBS, truTV and HBO Max
Game 1: noon Saturday in Cleveland
Game 2: 4 p.m. Monday in Cleveland
Game 3: 3 p.m. Wednesday at Rate Field
***Game 4:** Thursday at Rate Field
***Game 5:** Oct. 10 in Cleveland
*if necessary

MORE INSIDE
3 keys for the White Sox against their AL Central rival. **Page C3**



CHRIS SWEDA/CHICAGO TRIBUNE

COLLEGE FOOTBALL NORTHWESTERN VS. PENN STATE

Next-gen Wildcats

Northwestern runs onto the field as the team is introduced before taking on Penn State in the inaugural game at the new Ryan Field on Friday in Evanston. After years of buildup, the Wildcats christened the \$875 million, privately funded venue that coach Ryan Braun called "the best stadium in all of football." Northwestern announced a sellout of the 35,000-seat stadium for the opener, which was played 100 years to the day that the old stadium opened.

■ For the result and more coverage, go to chicagotribune.com/sports | More college football, **Back Page**

CUBS

Hoyer: 'We let home field slip away'

By Meghan Montemurro
CHICAGO TRIBUNE

Thirty-seven hours after the Cubs season ended unceremoniously with a wild-card-round sweep in San Diego, president of baseball operations Jed Hoyer tried to put the year in context Friday afternoon. With exit interviews with players and coaches underway Friday, there was one overriding sentiment: disappointment. "The season was unlike any season I've been through in 25 years," Hoyer said. "There was a number of times I think things felt incredibly dire during the season. We had a mid-April stretch where it felt like every reliever was hurt. Now we had a late-June stretch where we were scrambling to fill out a rotation in any way. We survived those things incredibly well. We also had periods of the year, long periods, where I thought we looked like maybe the best team in baseball. "These fans deserve home playoff games. We let home field slip away by playing poorly in September, especially the last week and then we let a chance to go deep in the playoffs and really get this team playing in the postseason." The Cubs return most of their strong position-player core for

See CUBS on Page C4



Cubs President Jed Hoyer, from left, general manager Carter Hawkins and manager Craig Counsell watch players work out Monday before facing the Padres in a wild-card series in San Diego. **BRIAN CASSELLA/CHICAGO TRIBUNE**

BEARS

What to watch for in Sunday's Bears-Jets matchup

By Sean Hammond
CHICAGO TRIBUNE

Ben Johnson wants to keep the New York Jets guessing as long as possible. The Chicago Bears coach has not named a starting quarterback for the Week 4 matchup at Soldier Field. The hope is it adds a little extra guesswork for Jets coach and former Detroit Lions colleague Aaron Glenn. Starting quarterback Caleb Williams is still dealing with a strained hamstring and has been ruled out, so either backup Tyson Bagent or third-string QB Case Keenum will start Sunday.

UP NEXT

  **Jets at Bears**
Noon Sunday, Fox-32

But nothing definitive has been announced. The Bears and Jets have not squared off since Nov. 27, 2022. Backups Trevor Siemian and Mike White started that game, with White leading the Jets to a 31-10 win at MetLife Stadium. The Jets haven't won at Soldier Field since 1997. Here's what to watch for when the Bears (2-1) face the Jets (1-2) at noon Sunday on the lakefront.

WHO STARTS AT QB FOR THE BEARS?

Keenum was the star of Monday night's win over the Philadelphia Eagles. He threw for 247 yards and contributed three total touchdowns in his first game action since 2023. The Bears went with Keenum because Bagent missed nearly the entire week of practice with a concussion. Bagent cleared concussion protocol by Sunday and served as Keenum's backup Monday. So what do the Bears do now? Go with the backup on the depth chart or the hot hand? "Whoever we feel like gives us

See BEARS on Page C4



Bears coach Ben Johnson covers his mouth while calling a play during a preseason game against the Browns in August. **JOHN J. KIM/TRIBUNE**

Coming up

Team	Saturday	Sunday	Monday	Tuesday	Wednesday
 BEARS		NYJ noon Fox-32			
 WHITE SOX	@CLE noon TBS		@CLE 4 p.m. TBS		CLE 3 p.m. TBS
 BULLS					PHX (exh.) 7 p.m. CHSN
 BLACKHAWKS	@BUF 6 p.m. CHSN			STL 7 p.m. CHSN	
 FIRE					VAN 7:30 p.m. Apple TV
 STARS		DEN 3 p.m. CBSSN			



Bulls player Caleb Wilson left, Chicago Bears quarterback Caleb Williams second from left, and Bulls player Matas Buzelis right, celebrate after a Chicago Cubs victory over the Brewers at Wrigley Field on Sept. 3. CHRIS SWEDA/CHICAGO TRIBUNE

BULLS

Buzelis, Wilson ready to compete

Buzelis on Wilson: ‘He feels like my brother’

By Julia Poe
CHICAGO TRIBUNE

Matas Buzelis isn’t so sure about the concept of friendly competition — especially when it comes to Chicago Bulls rookie Caleb Wilson.

Only a few months after their first meeting, Buzelis and Wilson are already fast friends. But that doesn’t mean the pair lets each other off the hook. Buzelis feels the best way to translate that friendship onto the court is to channel it into a heightened competitiveness. And for his money, there’s one main way that either young star can make the other better.

“We can try to kill each other on the court,” Buzelis said.

Buzelis is serious. So is Wilson. The early weeks of training camp under new coach Tiago Splitter already included plenty of five-on-five scrimmaging. And the young duo spent those sessions — and the last few weeks of optional training sessions — trying to take each other’s heads off whenever they’re paired up.

In some scrimmages, Buzelis and Wilson are paired up. On other days, Splitter divides them and lets them go head-to-head. Both try to dunk on the other — and both deny that any such attempt on their own life was successful.

“If we’re going to mess around, let each other score — that’s not going to get us to the level we want to be at,” Buzelis said.

The Buzelis-Wilson pairing provides plenty of interesting schematic questions for Splitter in his first year as a coach. Both can play the 4, although it appears Buzelis likely will slide out to more of a 3 position when he shares the court with the rookie. Splitter often brushes off this type of delineation in his mostly positionless style of play, but a full move to the wing would only benefit Buzelis in the frontcourt system.

Both Buzelis and Wilson have similar strengths in their arsenal, highlighted by bounding athleticism and a desire to dunk early and often. Wilson needs to work on his shot.

Buzelis needs to improve his close-range finishing. Both are hungry to make those improvements as quickly as possible. But Buzelis is encouraged by the early flow the pair has found together, which allows the team to stretch



Bulls forward Caleb Wilson screams during his photo session during the Bulls Media Day at the United Center on Monday. STACEY WESCOTT/CHICAGO TRIBUNE

the defense and put excess pressure on the rim.

“We just know where we’re at out on the court,” Buzelis said. “We don’t really have to play to one strength. We can do everything on the court.”

At times, it’s hard to remember that this partnership is only a few months old. Buzelis and Wilson first met when the No. 4 pick attended a predraft workout at the Advocate Center.

After Wilson was drafted in late June, Buzelis welcomed him into the city’s most star-studded friend group, an ensemble that includes Cubs star Pete Crow-Armstrong and Bears quarterback Caleb Williams.

The pair spent the summer raising hell at Cubs games, traipsing through VIP sections at the Summer Smash festival and watching Kanye West perform at Soldier Field. Wilson and Buzelis spent most of their time together in the Advocate Center, logging multiple workouts per day over the summer.

Competitiveness defines both of their personalities. And yet Buzelis never feels any pressure or discomfort in how Wilson’s stardom sits aside his own. They want the same thing.

They know they can’t achieve it without one another. And Buzelis feels Wilson pursues that goal in a way that is familiar to his own approach.

“He feels like my brother, bro,” Buzelis said. “I don’t know. It’s like my twin. We’re very similar in the way we talk. I remember watching some of his interviews and it just reminded me of how I was talking, how I was thinking. He’s very confident. Sometimes you meet people and you just connect very easily.”

Despite this early bond, however, Wilson and Buzelis still have everything to prove on the court. The pair will play its first minutes of live-action basketball together Wednesday in the preseason home opener against the Phoenix Suns, but the real first test is the Oct. 21 season opener in Toronto.

The Bulls need this to work. Wilson and Buzelis are both high-upside players with the potential to grow into real-deal pieces for this franchise to build upon. The Bulls haven’t cashed in on two draft picks like this in years. If it works, the team could be on track for a grassroots rebuild that creates long-term success in the modern NBA.

But that ultimately comes down to how Wilson and Buzelis perform. Both are aware of the pressure — and neither wants to give it too much attention. For Buzelis, any speculation about this duo’s future is only outside noise.

“Who cares what people think?” Buzelis said. “We’re going to figure it out.”

MAMMOTH 6, BLACKHAWKS 0 LATE THURSDAY

Hawks foes scoring early, often in first 2

By Kalen Lumpkins
CHICAGO TRIBUNE

SALT LAKE CITY — That was ugly.

The Chicago Blackhawks were coming off a less-than-ideal season opener, a 5-2 loss to the Vegas Golden Knights. The Hawks struggled on the road against the Stanley Cup runners-up.

Salt Lake City was a perfect place for a rebound. The Hawks had had the Mammoth’s number, winning four straight games against the newest NHL team.

Thursday’s game was a whole different story.

The Hawks were overwhelmed against their Central Division foe in a 6-0 pummeling. The Hawks (0-2-0) have been outscored 11-2 to start the season.

“I don’t think we played very good individually, I thought we made our decisions too slow,” coach Jeff Blashill said. “I didn’t think we played to the level that we’re capable of.”

The first period, much like in Las Vegas, was bad for the Hawks. It was scoreless until Mammoth forwards Dylan Guenther and Michael Carcone scored 40 seconds apart at 16:41 and 17:21, respectively.

The Hawks trailed by the same margin after one period in the opener.

“Momentum in games matters — a lot of times when you’re on the road, especially against what I think are really good teams, you’re going to get pinned in a little bit,” Blashill said. “You’ve got to manage that and try to get out of there without giving up goals, without taking penalties, which we didn’t do on either night.”

Blashill’s line combinations took to the ice Thursday, shuffling Frank Nazar with Patrick Kane, Anton Frondell, Roman Kantserov, Teuvo Teräväinen and Tyler Bertuzzi.

“It’s always fun to play with (Kane) and Roman, I thought we had some good looks there towards the end,” Nazar said. “It’s good going out there with everybody and trying to do our best to create something.”

It might not be the best idea to mix lines this frequently with a young team, and Blashill’s switches seem to be made in panic rather than strategy. The young, new-look Hawks need to develop chemistry with the recent roster additions.

Blashill brushed off the notion of his lineups thwarting team flow Wednesday.

“It is what it is,” Blashill said. “We’re trying to find the right combos and we’ll see when we get there.”

The right combos were not there at the Delta Center. A below-average first period was followed by a second in which the Mammoth had 29 shot attempts with 13 on goal, compared with 12 attempts and two shots on goal for the Hawks.

Ryan Donato, Nick Lardis, Ryan Greene, Kantserov, Kane and Nazar finished with zero shots on goal. And Blashill noticed.

“We’ve got to get to some lines that we feel can produce offense and generate chances,” he said.

Lines have been ever-changing, but the defensive pairs may need a refurbishing. The Hawks bluelin-

ers combined for nine giveaways, five shots attempts blocked and a non-positive rating for all.

“It’s tough to say one or a few specific things (that went wrong) at this point,” defenseman Ian Cole said. “Obviously it wasn’t good enough. We’re going to have to take the next 48 hours and look at it and fix some things.”

Bowen Byram’s first couple of games with his new team haven’t been great. Blashill did switch Byram to pair with Levshunov for a bit, but he doesn’t have plans to involve Kevin Korchinski or Ethan Del Mastro yet.

“I’m not there, probably, we’ll see,” Blashill said. “We consider everything, so we’ll look at it and see if we think the two other options are better than the options that played.”

Cole — the 37-year-old veteran who signed a one-year, \$4 million contract in the offseason after two seasons in Utah — received a brief but warm welcome back in the first period. Unsurprisingly, that wasn’t the focus postgame.

“It was nice (but) unfortunately the outcome of the game kind of overshadows everything,” Cole said. “We’re professional athletes and we get judged based on whether we win or lose hockey games. Tonight was obviously not a great game.”

The Mammoth made clearing the puck nearly impossible, creating an endless slew of scoring chances. The Hawks spent nearly the entire game in their own zone.

The Mammoth had 65 total shot attempts, 32 on goal with five players scoring. They also won 39 of 54 faceoffs.

“Certainly large parts of the first and the first half of the second, we couldn’t get out of our end,” Blashill said. “I thought we overcomplicated it a bit again. It’s just a process.”

Kantserov was close to his first NHL goal in the third period but was unable to rebound Levshunov’s shot. Mammoth goaltender Karel Vejmelka (15 saves) pounced on the loose puck, just one of the highlights of his ninth career shutout.

The opening two games couldn’t have gone much worse for the Hawks, and a hungry Sabres team awaits them Saturday in Buffalo, N.Y.

“I don’t think we can let it snowball,” Cole said. “There’s going to be ups and downs through the course of the season. We would have preferred not to start down, but I think that there is a reality where if we can steel ourselves and we can get our mind right in how we approach the long run over the course of 84 games, we could look back at this and say, ‘Hey, this could’ve been good for us.’”

Added Nazar, bluntly: “It’s two games.”

Blashill’s confidence in his team hasn’t wavered. But he noted that the Sabres offer a grand opportunity.

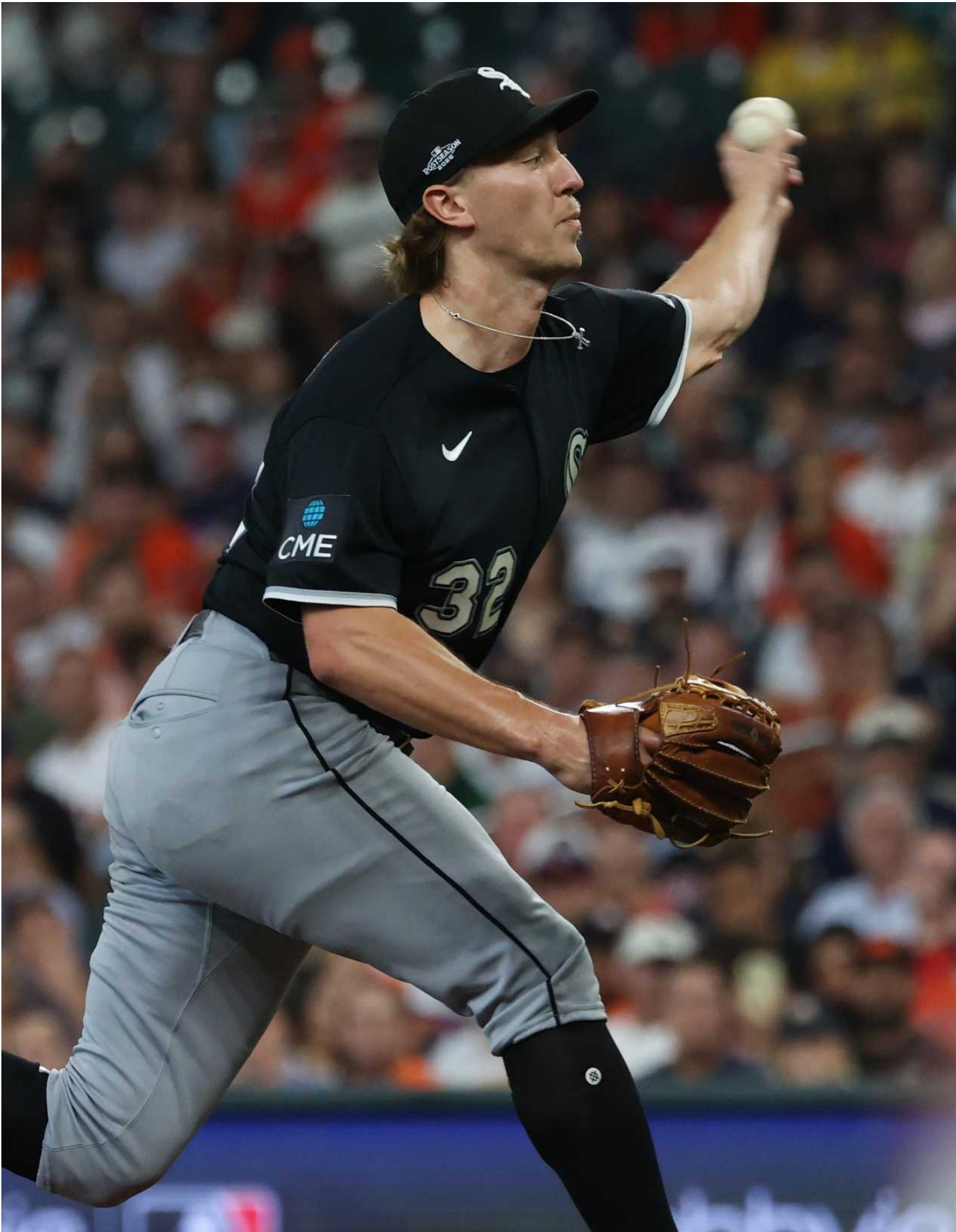
“You’ve got to go change that with your play,” Blashill said. “You’ve got to find a way to win a hockey game Saturday against a really tough opponent in their building.”

“I don’t think there’s any lack of belief in our group. We’re 0-2, that’s the fact of it. We haven’t played nearly our best, but it’s neither more nor less than that.”



Mammoth right wing Dylan Guenther scores against Blackhawks goalie Arvid Söderblom during the second period on Thursday in Salt Lake City. MELISSA MAJCHRZAK/AP

WHITE SOX



White Sox starter Hagen Smith delivers against the Astros in the first inning of Game 1 of the wild-card series on Tuesday in Houston. JOHN J. KIM/CHICAGO TRIBUNE PHOTOS

AL DIVISION SERIES

3 keys vs. Guardians

By LaMond Pope
CHICAGO TRIBUNE

CLEVELAND — Hagen Smith excelled as an opener for the Chicago White Sox in Game 1 of the American League wild-card series against the Houston Astros.

Smith looks to set the tone again as the starter of the AL Division Series opener Saturday against the Cleveland Guardians.

“Excited about Hagen for the same reason that we chose him in Houston, I think he gives us a really good shot up front here,” manager Will Venable said Friday during a workout day at Progressive Field. “Considering the lineup that we expect the Guardians to have, obviously the type of team that we know very well, Hagen is our guy.”

Smith allowed two hits and struck out one over three scoreless innings in the 6-3 victory against the Astros on Tuesday.

“It’s cool, obviously,” Smith said of Saturday’s assignment. “I want to go out there and do the best I can for the team.”

Parker Messick is starting Game 1 for the Guardians. He made four starts against the Sox in the regular season, going 2-1 with a 2.81 ERA and 29 strikeouts in 25 ⅔ innings.

“It’s just another time where we get to face a fun team and they get to face us,” Messick said.

Here are three keys for the best-of-five matchup.

WHAT TYPE OF WEAPON WILL THE OFF DAYS BE?

Game 1 is Saturday and the teams are off Sunday. Game 2 is Monday and the teams are off Tuesday before the series switches to Rate Field for Game 3 on Wednesday.

The schedule could help the clubs as they build their pitching plans.

“We are very much going to utilize these off days to help us best utilize our best pitchers,” Venable said. “And I think that’s one of the advantages of these off days for us and how we are built is that — we’ll use Hagen Smith and Grant Taylor as an example, we could potentially use them in each one of these first three games.

“That’s very, very helpful. They have a bunch of resilient guys over there, too, but as you look at the guys that you want to cover the most innings in this series, I don’t think it’s any secret Hagen and Grant are two of our best arms. These off days serve us well to be able to expose them to each one of these games if need be.”

The Sox will be mindful of usage.

“If we use Hagen for three innings, let’s say, tomorrow and he needs an extra day, maybe he’s not in the mix in Game 2, but we’ll take it game by game,” Venable said. “We can use our guys frequently up front here just knowing we have the off days.”



White Sox shortstop Colson Montgomery celebrates with teammates in the clubhouse Wednesday after a 7-3 win over the Astros in Houston.

WILL REST OR RHYTHM PREVAIL?

A common debate during this time is whether it will be more beneficial to rest/recover — as the Guardians had the opportunity to do with the bye. Or is it more important to maintain the rhythm established during the season — as the Sox did during the wild-card series.

Venable saw the opportunity for so many young players to get postseason games under their belt as a plus.

“That was a good environment as a play-off environment in which they felt the environment, they felt the leverage of different moments and have that experience under their belt now,” Venable said.

Tristan Peters was one of those players. The outfielder described his first postseason series as “incredibly fun, intense (and) stressful, honestly.”

“It’s just a different environment so far and it’s been a ton of fun,” Peters said Friday. Venable noted that the sweep of the Astros did allow for the team to get a breather.

“Yes, it would be great to have the rest,” Venable said. “At the same time, kind of feel like we’re coming in rested. We didn’t have to totally gas out our pitching staff. These guys got two days off and they’re in a good spot. Hagen and Grant got three days off. So we feel like we got a little bit of both.”

HOW WILL FAMILIARITY FACTOR INTO THE MATCHUP?

Just how tight were the regular-season games between the teams? The Sox held a 7-6 series edge, outscoring the Guardians 58-57.

“I think every game against them felt kind of like a playoff game the way that the games were played,” Sox left fielder Sam Antonacci said Friday.

It’s fitting the teams meet in the playoffs. Venable said the Guardians have threats up and down the lineup.

“The thing with the Guardians that will be driving a lot of our approach is if we give them free passes, they will beat us,” Venable said. “That means if we don’t catch the ball and we make errors, they will beat us. If we walk guys, they will beat us. If we allow a bunch of stolen bases, they will beat us.”

This is the third year in a row the Guardians have played a division foe in the playoffs (Detroit Tigers in the 2024 ALDS and 2025 wild-card series).

“There’s no secrets,” Guardians manager Stephen Vogt said. “We know them. They know us. So it’s just go out and execute and let’s see who can win three games before the other team.”

SULLIVAN

from Page C1

three scoreless innings in Game 1 of the wild-card win in Houston.

It’s no surprise. The Sox have used openers a league-leading 32 times this season, including Smith’s outing Tuesday. If it ain’t broke, don’t fix it.

But does the no-rotation rotation have its limits, or can Venable’s Sox keep succeeding in the postseason with a bullpen-first strategy?

Venable acknowledged Sean Burke could start Game 2 on Monday, as he did in a four-inning start in Game 2 against the Astros, in which starters Anthony Kay and Erick Fedde both pitched in relief. But other than Burke, it might be a guessing game from here on out.

Can Smith come back to start Game 3 at home Wednesday, giving him three starts in their first five playoff games? Who knows what’s up Venable’s sleeve?

“I think the way it’s set up with these off days, we’re going to leverage the arms that we want to leverage when we want to use them throughout these first couple,” Venable said. “And if that means that one of the guys who we’ve been giving starts to throughout the season takes a bulk role in that, there’s certainly potential for that. But I think you can expect us to mix and match and use our best arms in the most optimal way.”

That suggests Smith and Grant Taylor can be the designated bookends of multiple games, with Jordan Hicks, David Sandlin and Sean Newcomb in the middle and Kay, Fedde and Davis Martin as the wild cards.

It’s almost the polar-opposite approach that then-manager Ozzie Guillén employed in the 2005 postseason, when José Contreras, Mark Buehrle, Freddy Garcia and Jon Garland combined for a 2.84 ERA in 12 starts, leading the Sox on an 11-1 run to their World Series title.

In the five-game win over the Anaheim Angels in the AL Championship Series, the four starters had four straight complete games and combined for 44 ⅓ of the 45 total innings, with Neal Cotts contributing the other two outs in the ninth inning of the Game 1 loss. The rest of the bullpen had a nice seat to watch the starters dealing.

“I don’t know if you’ll ever see that again,” Sox catcher A.J. Pierzynski said afterward. “Managers just don’t do that anymore. They don’t have confidence to let guys go 120 pitches and throw nine innings.”

In the World Series, advance scout Bryan Little and his crew gave Guillén and pitching coach Don Cooper a near-perfect report on strengths and weaknesses of the Astros hitters.

Contreras and Buehrle both went seven innings in the first two wins at Sox Park, and Garland went seven in Game 3 in Houston before the Astros tied it off Dustin Hermanson in the eighth.

Guillén was forced to use his well-rested bullpen when the game went 14 innings but also used Orlando “El Duque” Hernández and Buehrle. After Geoff Blum’s go-ahead home run in the 14th, Buehrle notched the infamous “buzzed save” by getting the final out after having a few beers in the clubhouse. “No more than three ... I swear,” he later said.

Buehrle wound up on a Wheaties box, but he didn’t become a legend for his cereal-eating habits.

Game 4 was as old-school as it gets, with Garcia going seven shutout innings, Cliff Politte and Cotts getting the Sox through the eighth and Bobby Jenks closing out a 1-0 win to start the parade plans.

“That type of game is like the ones I watched for 162 games during the regular season,” Guillén said in the celebratory clubhouse.

Venable’s approach in the postseason also mirrors what he has done for much of the season.

General manager Chris Getz knew he didn’t have a dominant rotation in spring training, and opening-day starter Shane Smith was quickly dispatched to Triple-A Charlotte after three starts. Martin, Burke, Kay and Fedde have been the mainstays, though Fedde, who signed at the start of spring training, had only 15 starts in his 33 games.

Taylor has evolved into the de facto closer but can go three innings if needed. He also was used as an opener in April. Seranthony Domínguez led the team 12 saves, even after being dispatched at the trade deadline.

Openers aren’t a new concept. “Bullpenning” has been around for the last decade. Cubs manager Craig Counsell also used openers in last year’s postseason.

But is it possible no team has been as unconventional as the ’26 Sox in this particular run?

“It’s possible,” Getz said during the wild-card celebration. “We weren’t trying to re-create the wheel. We were trying to optimize the group that we had. So much of (baseball) has relied on starting pitching. We would’ve liked to do that. But if we were trying to win games, we had to lean on the strength of the club, and we’ve done that.”

The Sox’s strategy has been criticized, especially when an opener puts the bulk pitcher in a hole. Guillén himself has said on the Chicago Sports Network he’s not a fan of openers.

But if the Sox go all the way without a true rotation, the players may never have to buy a meal or drink in Chicago again. Or at least that’s the adage.

“More often than not I’ll just roll in and buy a drink or buy my dinner,” Blum told me last week in Houston. “But every so often, if there is a hard-core Sox fan in the bar or in the restaurant, there will be a free drink that will show up once in a while.”

So it’s kind of true?

“It still carries a little bit of weight,” Blum said. “We’re not quite the ’85 Bears, but the ’05 Sox do OK.”

CUBS

from Page C1

2027, with impending free agents Ian Happ and Seiya Suzuki being the notable exceptions. They have work to do, though, to better this roster, which Hoyer acknowledged among the three key takeaways from his end-of-season news conference.

THE BULLPEN MUST IMPROVE THROUGH INTERNAL AND EXTERNAL OPTIONS.

The Cubs built a bullpen in 2025 that proved pivotal in their run to the playoffs and during a post-season stretch that took them to the brink of the National League Championship Series.

The 2026 pen became a much different story. The Cubs' top offseason reliever acquisitions missed most of the season. Hunter Harvey made just four appearances before going on the injured list in early April and never coming back, while Phil Maton went on the IL three times with a reoccurring knee issue that turned into a partial patellar tendon tear and season-ending debridement surgery. The two veterans combined for a 6.25 ERA and minus-0.6 fWAR in 35 appearances.

"I did a poor job in the bullpen this year — full stop," Hoyer said. "So I take responsibility for that and something that we'll look to improve on this offseason because it didn't work out as well as it did in '25 this last year."

Maton remains under contract for next year, joining a returning group of Ryan Zeferjahn, Daniel Palencia, Ryan Rolison and Jacob Webb — if they pick up his \$2.5 million club option. It's a solid starting point, but the Cubs need more out of their relievers in 2027.

"We sort of built the (2026) bullpen with the same philosophy with the same thoughts in mind (as 2025), and we didn't get it right, and that's something that we've spent a lot of time talking about already and we'll continue to talk about," Hoyer said. "The overall quality of the pitching has to improve, and that's really the thing that when I think about our offseason, when I think about seasons to come, that has to be the goal is to get our pitching infrastructure and pitching quality to the level of our position-player group."

If the Cubs aren't going to spend money on relievers in free agency, something Hoyer has been philosophically opposed to doing in the past, they must do a better job of developing relievers within the organization, which it has struggled to produce with reliability, particularly when it comes to high-leverage arms. This won't be an easy puzzle to solve, complicating an area that must improve.

ROTATION NEEDS MORE SWING-AND-MISS

The Cubs enter the offseason with abundant questions surrounding the rotation.

Their three in-season trade acquisitions — Clay Holmes, David Peterson and Kevin Gausman — will be free agents. And

with Shota Imanaga entering free agency, Matthew Boyd potentially hitting the FA market, too, if either side doesn't pick up his \$15 million mutual option, plus a trio of starters — Ben Brown, Cade Horton and Justin Steele — coming off injuries that cast uncertainty of how much they can be relied on in 2027, the Cubs have a lot of work to do.

"We gave up far too many home runs this year, and whether that's a stuff issue, a fly-ball-tendency issue, all those things I think are fair things to look at," Hoyer said. "I think I said hundreds of times during the course of the year, we can't catch homers."

"It's having the humility to look at every aspect of the chain from scouting, player development, major-league development, all those things. Ultimately that's my responsibility."

Edward Cabrera's disappointing season also complicates how the Cubs attack the rotation. Blister issues and an underwhelming performance, featuring a 5.96 ERA in 18 games (15 starts), wasn't what the Cubs expected when they traded for Cabrera before the season. Hoyer said he and the organization need to own that they didn't get the most out of the 28-year-old.

"We have to think a lot about what things contributed to him struggling and we have to look at ourselves and look at what did we not do to get the most out of him," Hoyer said. "He did struggle a lot with these blister issues, and how much that impacted those different spin pitches is unclear, but he's super talented. He has the swing-and-miss stuff that we're looking for."

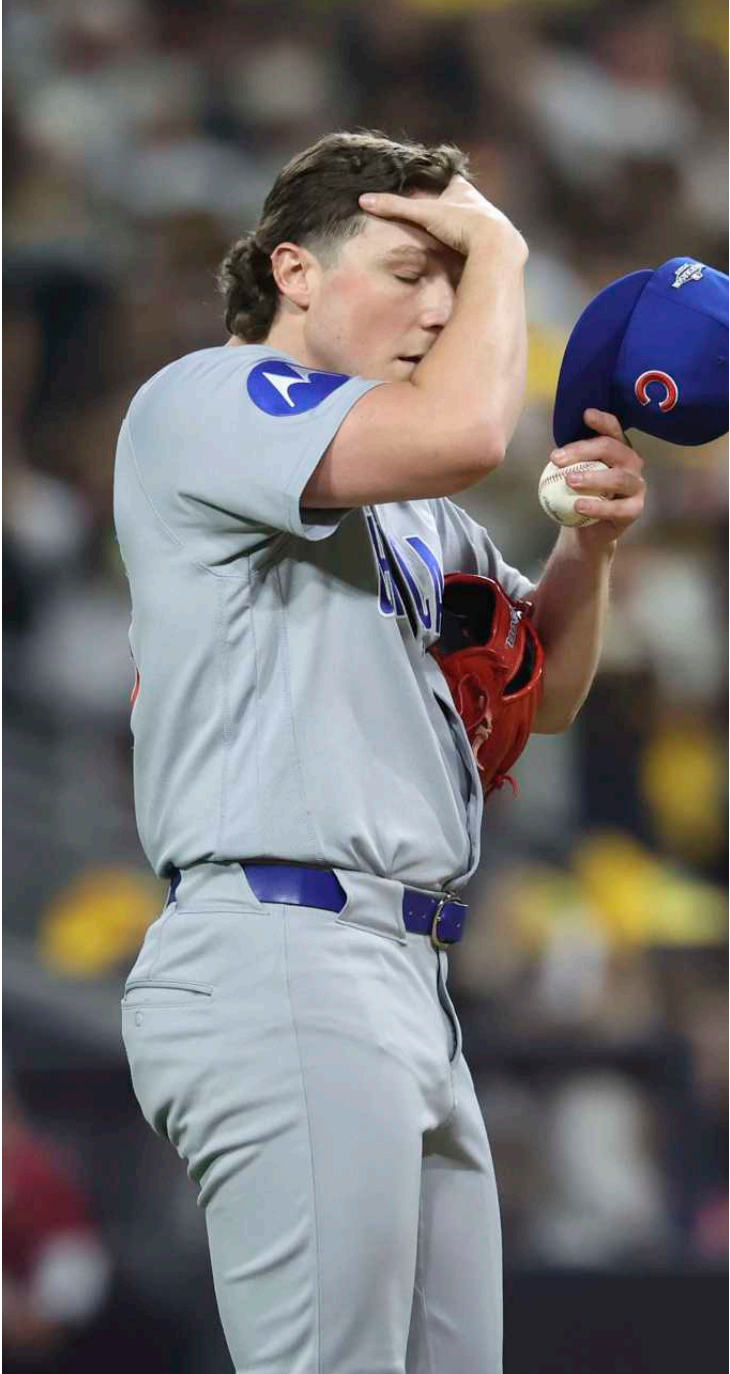
LOOMING LOCKOUT COULD HAVE CUBS BEING MORE AGGRESSIVE IN NOVEMBER

Nobody knows what roster-building parameters will exist in the next collective bargaining agreement, with the current iteration expiring at the beginning of December.

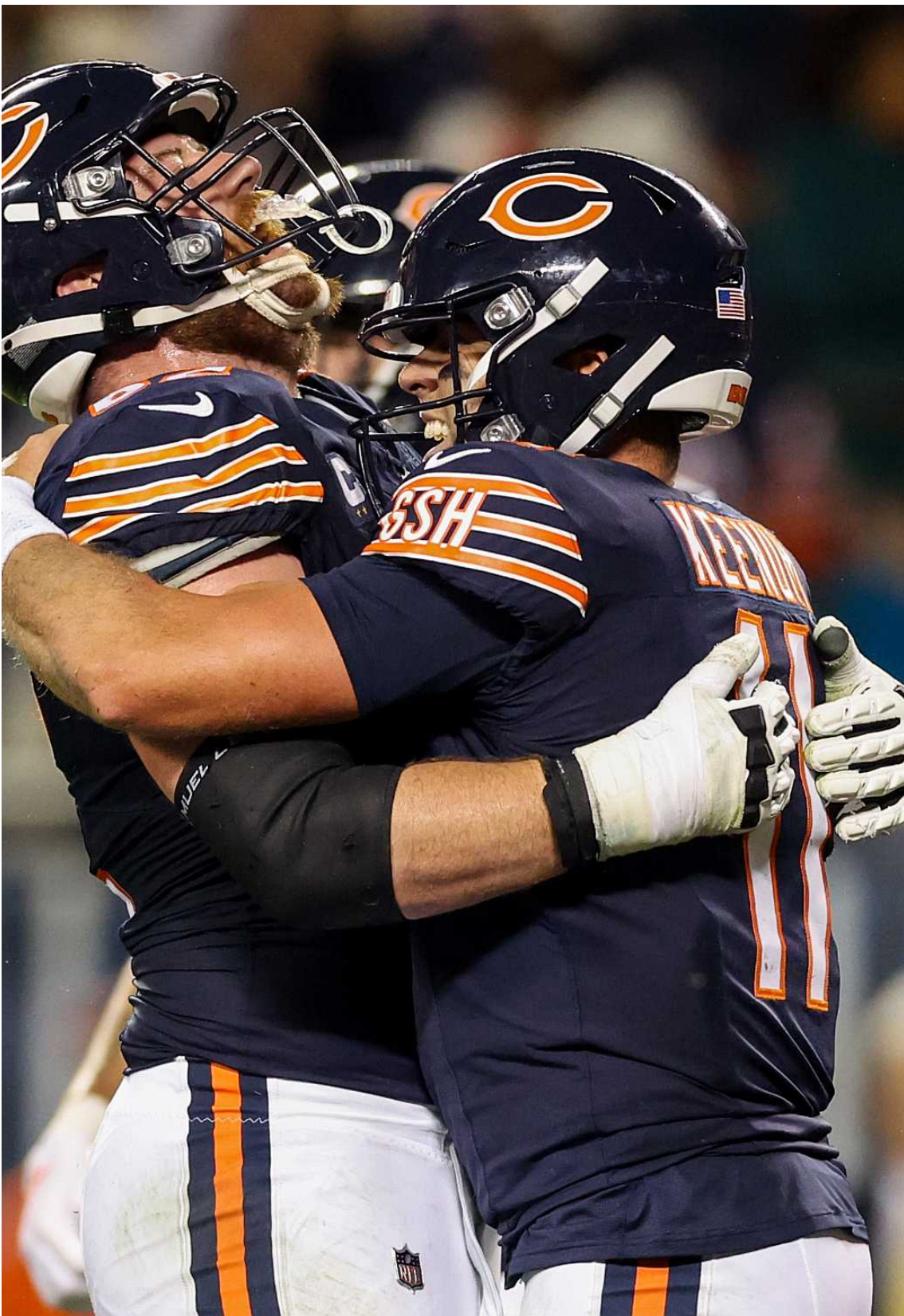
The Cubs, prior to the last CBA expiration and subsequent lockout before the 2022 season, completed a final-hour deal to sign starter Marcus Stroman to a multiyear contract. Hoyer anticipates that period in November in the lead-up to an expected owners lockout to be active, adding that deals will get done if they make sense. Given their rotation needs, it would make sense if the Cubs looked into re-signing someone such as Holmes, Peterson or Gausman before the lockout if the other side is willing.

"Last time there was sort of a sprint in the moments before and then there was like a sprint in the moments after (the lockout), and that may be a blueprint for how this goes again," Hoyer said. "We're going to have likely an empty period in there, but yeah, I think there will be activity in November for sure."

"We're going to have to be creative. We're going to have to fill a number of holes. I don't think the timing affects that. I think that can get done. We have to make good decisions and we have to find deals that make sense for both sides."



Cubs reliever Ryan Rolison regroups as he struggles through the fifth inning Tuesday against the Padres in Game 1 of their wild-card series in San Diego. **BRIAN CASSELLA/CHICAGO TRIBUNE**



Bears quarterback Case Keenum, right, celebrates Monday with guard Joe Thuney after rushing for a touchdown during the fourth quarter against the Eagles at Soldier Field. **ARMANDO L. SANCHEZ/CHICAGO TRIBUNE**

BEARS

from Page C1

the best chance to win," Johnson said this week.

Rest assured, Johnson went into the week with a plan; he's just not ready to share it publicly right now.

Bagent has been the team's primary backup since his rookie season in 2023. As Johnson said after last week's win, Bagent won the backup job coming out of training camp "for a reason."

The Bears believe in Bagent, so much so that they gave him a new contract last year and rebuffed calls from at least one other team asking if Bagent might be available in a trade over the offseason.

But Keenum became the talk of the NFL this week when he helped beat the Eagles pretty soundly.

"I have absolutely zero ego in this," Bagent said. "And nobody is a bigger cheerleader and fan of Case Keenum than I am. I think he's the epitome of what I believe a quarterback is and is supposed to be. So it was fun to watch him play."

Bears offensive coordinator Press Taylor sees a little bit of Johnson in Bagent.

"He operates the system at a high level," Taylor said. "He's an extremely intelligent person, extremely competitive person. There's a little bit, you sense a little bit of him and Ben are kind of similar in the competitive edge that they both carry but also just the intelligence they carry."

Taylor said the Bears "recalibrate" every week.

"The variables are never ending, honestly," he said.

Last week, Bagent was in concussion protocol for much of the week. The Bears had to work through that variable, and they felt it was best to stick with Keenum after Keenum had taken reps with the starters all week.

This week, Bagent is cleared and fully healthy. Like Keenum last week, Bagent hasn't started a game since 2023. He has started four games in his NFL career — all during his rookie season.

PLAYER IN THE SPOTLIGHT: JETS QB GENO SMITH

When the Bears faced Smith a year ago in a Week 4 matchup against the Las Vegas Raiders, the veteran quarterback was turning the ball over at a high rate. The Bears picked him off three times in that game, and Smith went on to lead the league with 17 interceptions.

Over the offseason, Smith reunited with the Jets, with whom he began his career as a second-round draft pick in 2013. So far this season, Smith has yet to throw an interception and has lost only one fumble. He's completing a league-best 75.5% of his passes.

"That means he's making the right decision," Bears defensive passing game coordinator Al Harris

said. "He's done an excellent job of that, completing passes and getting the ball where he needs to go."

The turnovers killed the Raiders a year ago. They went 2-13 with Smith starting at quarterback, although he was far from their only problem. That was after the journeyman backup revived his career as a starter with the Seattle Seahawks following Russell Wilson's exit.

First-year Jets offensive coordinator Frank Reich has Smith taking care of the football. The Jets are one of four teams that have not thrown an interception.

"You can just tell they're operating pretty well," Bears linebacker T.J. Edwards said. "It's confidence in his skills, he trusts his arm. But I do think just what they do schematically and how they run the ball and the players they have, the personnel in terms of the speed that they have, it's a serious group."

If Bagent plays, this will be a notable matchup for the West Virginia native, who grew up watching Smith lead one of the most prolific college offenses of its time at West Virginia from 2009-12.

AARON GLENN'S DEFENSE IS IMPROVING.

The Jets have had one of the league's tougher defenses through three weeks of the season. Glenn is a defensive coach at heart, but that really didn't show in his team last season.

This year, it's a different story.

The Jets rank second in yards allowed (258.3 per game) and third against the pass (171). Their 8.6% sack rate ranks seventh. Remarkably, the Jets still don't have an interception since Glenn became the coach last year. Their last interception came during the finale of the 2024 season on Jan. 5, 2025. That's more than 20 consecutive games without a pick.

Even so, the Jets defense is going to be a test for a backup quarterback.

"Their front is really good," Bagent said. "Edge rushers are great. They've got veteran leadership in the middle at linebacker, and then I think they're very well coached on the back end. So it'll be a tough group."

David Bailey, the No. 2 draft pick in April, and Kingsley Enagbare, who signed with the Jets in March, each have two sacks this season. Veteran middle linebacker Demario Davis joined the Jets in free agency and leads the team with 22 tackles.

KEEP AN EYE ON ...

Left tackle and cornerback.

Starting left tackle Braxton Jones suffered a right knee injury in the third quarter against the Eagles. Johnson on Friday ruled Jones out for Sunday's game and announced that backup Theo Benedet will start.

Second-year tackle Ozzy Trapilo will get another week of rest as he returns from a serious knee injury suffered in January. Trapilo has been a full participant in practice,

but Johnson said the Bears aren't quite ready to throw him into a game yet.

"We're still working out Ozzy just to make sure that the confidence is back," Johnson said. "He's looking better each and every week. He was one of those guys in Wednesday night's practice in pads that he stood out in a good way. I think he's going the right way and he might be available sooner rather than later."

For this week, though, it will be Benedet at left tackle. An undrafted rookie in 2024, Benedet started eight games last season, including seven at left tackle.

As for cornerback, rookie Malik Muhammad played ahead of Tyrique Stevenson last week. Stevenson was nagged by a hamstring injury during the practice week ahead of the Eagles game.

"We just felt good going into that game with starting Malik on the outside and having Cam (Lewis) play more of the nickel role," Johnson said. "So each week is a little bit different. I was really pleased, and honestly we were a little surprised with how quickly Tyrique came back from the injury."

Stevenson is not on the injury report this week, so it will be notable if Muhammad starts ahead of him against the Jets. It's also possible the Bears move Muhammad back to nickel, where he played in Weeks 1 and 2, because Lewis is doubtful with a hip injury.

INJURY UPDATES

The Bears officially ruled out Williams on Friday, meaning he will miss his second consecutive game. The team also ruled out Jones at left tackle. Lewis (hip) is doubtful and did not practice Friday.

Running back D'Andre Swift (knee) popped up on the injury report Thursday but was a full participant Friday and holds no injury designation.

"Whenever you get in a short week with running backs that's what happens," Johnson said Friday when asked about Swift. "He's still feeling the effects of a Monday night football game. I think we're going to get him out there today. We'll work him out and see how he's doing. But I'm optimistic for Sunday."

Three Bears players on the physically unable to perform list were ruled out ahead of the game: cornerback Kyler Gordon (calf), linebacker Noah Sewell (Achilles) and defensive end Shemar Turner (knee). The earliest those three could be activated from PUP would be Monday.

The Jets ruled out running back Breece Hall (quad), receiver Adonai Mitchell (finger), tight end Mason Taylor (thumb) and left guard Dylan Parham (knee). All four are starters. They also ruled out backup linebacker Kiko Mauigoa (quad).

Jets edge rusher Kingsley Enagbare (knee) and tight end Kenyon Sadiq (back) are questionable. Both were limited participants in practice Friday.

SCOREBOARD

NHL

EASTERN CONFERENCE

ATLANTIC DIVISION

	GP	W	L	OT	Pts	GF	GA
Florida	2	1	0	1	3	4	4
Boston	1	1	0	0	2	3	0
Montreal	1	1	0	0	2	3	2
Toronto	2	1	1	0	2	4	4
Detroit	0	0	0	0	0	0	0
Ottawa	0	0	0	0	0	0	0
Buffalo	1	0	1	0	0	3	6
Tampa Bay	1	0	1	0	0	1	5

METROPOLITAN DIVISION

	GP	W	L	OT	Pts	GF	GA
Pittsburgh	1	1	0	0	2	7	0
Columbus	1	1	0	0	2	6	3
New Jersey	1	1	0	0	2	3	2
N.Y. Rangers	2	1	1	0	2	5	4
Carolina	1	0	0	1	1	0	1
Philadelphia	2	0	1	1	1	2	10
Washington	0	0	0	0	0	0	0
N.Y. Islanders	1	0	1	0	0	1	2

WESTERN CONFERENCE

CENTRAL DIVISION

	GP	W	L	OT	Pts	GF	GA
Utah	1	1	0	0	2	6	0
Colorado	1	1	0	0	2	8	4
Minnesota	1	1	0	0	2	3	1
Dallas	0	0	0	0	0	0	0
St. Louis	0	0	0	0	0	0	0
Winnipeg	0	0	0	0	0	0	0
Nashville	1	0	1	0	0	1	3
Chicago	2	0	2	0	0	2	11

PACIFIC DIVISION

	GP	W	L	OT	Pts	GF	GA
Edmonton	2	1	0	1	3	14	13
Seattle	1	1	0	0	2	6	1
Vegas	1	1	0	0	2	5	2
San Jose	1	1	0	0	2	4	3
Vancouver	2	1	1	0	2	13	14
Anaheim	0	0	0	0	0	0	0
Los Angeles	1	0	1	0	0	4	8
Calgary	1	0	1	0	0	1	6

Note: Two points for a win, one point for overtime loss. Top three teams in each division and two wild cards per conference advance to playoffs.

Friday's results

N.Y. Rangers at Detroit, late
Washington at Carolina, late
Boston at Winnipeg, late
St. Louis at Dallas, late
Anaheim at Vegas, late

Saturday's games

Carolina at Philadelphia, 6 p.m.
Chicago at Buffalo, 6 p.m.
Montreal at Pittsburgh, 6 p.m.
Ottawa at Toronto, 6 p.m.
Seattle at Edmonton, 6 p.m.
Utah at Columbus, 6 p.m.
Washington at Tampa Bay, 6 p.m.
New Jersey at N.Y. Islanders, 6:30 p.m.
Boston at Minnesota, 7 p.m.
Dallas at Nashville, 7 p.m.
St. Louis at Colorado, 8 p.m.
Calgary at Vancouver, 9 p.m.
Los Angeles at San Jose, 9 p.m.

Thursday's results

New Jersey 3, Philadelphia 2, OT
N.Y. Rangers 5, Tampa Bay 1
Columbus 6, Buffalo 3
Minnesota 3, Nashville 1
Seattle 6, Calgary 1
Utah 6, Chicago 0
Edmonton 9, Vancouver 7
San Jose 4, Florida 3, OT

WNBA Playoffs

FIRST ROUND

(best-of-3; *-if necessary)

#2 GOLDEN STATE 1, #7 DALLAS 1 Sunday, Sept. 27: at Golden State 104-80.
Wed, Sept 30: at Dallas 108-100 (OT)
Friday: Golden State, late

#8 NEW YORK 2, #1 MINNESOTA 0. #4 ATLANTA 2, #5 WASHINGTON 1. #3 LAS VEGAS 2, #6 INDIANA 1 Thu, Oct. 1: at Las Vegas 94-83.

WNBA SEMIFINALS

(Best-of-5; *-if necessary)

#4 ATLANTA vs. #8 NEW YORK
Game 1: Sunday at Atlanta, 1 p.m.
Game 2: Wednesday at Atlanta, TBA
Game 3: Fri. Oct. 9 at New York, TBA
Game 4: Sun., Oct. 11 at New York, TBA*
Game 5: Wed., Oct. 14 at Atlanta, TBD*
#3 LAS VEGAS vs. DALLAS/GOLDEN ST.
Sunday: G1 vs. GS/Dallas, TBD
Wednesday: G2 vs. GS/Dallas, TBD
Fri, Oct. 9: G3 vs. GS/Dallas, TBD
Sun, Oct. 11: G4 vs. GS/Dallas, TBD*
Wed., Oct. 14: G5 vs. GS/Dallas, TBD*

NBA

EXHIBITION SCHEDULE

SATURDAY'S GAME

Miami at Toronto, 6 p.m.

SUNDAY'S GAMES

Utah at Denver, 6 p.m.
Golden State at L.A. Clippers, 6 p.m.

MONDAY'S GAMES

Memphis at Atlanta, 6 p.m.
Phoenix at Detroit, 6 p.m.
New York at Philadelphia, 6 p.m.
Minnesota at Milwaukee, 7 p.m.
L.A. Lakers at Sacramento, 9 p.m.

Soccer

MLS

	Eastern	W	L	T	Pts	GF	GA
Nashville	18	3	6	60	55	21	
New England	14	9	4	46	45	36	
Inter Miami	12	5	10	46	64	50	
Charlotte	12	8	7	43	47	38	
Chicago	12	8	6	42	46	38	
Philadelphia	11	10	6	39	54	44	
Orlando	10	13	4	34	48	64	
NY Red Bulls	9	12	6	33	34	51	
NYCFC	8	10	9	33	41	36	
Cincinnati	8	9	9	33	55	64	
D.C. United	6	8	12	30	34	42	
Columbus	8	14	5	29	39	43	
Toronto	6	10	11	29	39	51	
Atlanta	7	14	6	27	32	45	
Montréal	6	15	6	24	34	54	

	Western	W	L	T	Pts	GF	GA
Vancouver	15	6	5	50	59	26	
St Louis City	13	6	8	47	48	36	
Dallas	13	6	8	47	50	42	
San Jose	13	6	45	49	39		
Houston	13	9	5	44	34	32	
LAFC	11	9	8	41	43	30	
Seattle	10	9	8	38	35	35	
Colorado	11	13	3	36	38	38	
LA Galaxy	9	10	9	36	37	44	
Portland	9	10	5	32	48	51	
Salt Lake	9	13	5	32	40	44	
San Diego	8	11	8	32	47	47	
Austin	7	10	10	31	35	47	
Minnesota	7	12	8	29	40	49	
Kansas City	6	18	3	21	32	65	

Three points for win, one point for tie.

THURSDAY'S RESULT

Seattle 2, Sporting Kansas City 1

TUESDAY'S MATCH

Vancouver at Chicago, 7:30 p.m.

NWSL

	Club	W	L	T	Pt	GF	GA
Gotham FC	16	4	6	54	34	20	
San Diego	15	8	3	48	38	27	
Washington	14	8	4	46	36	24	
Utah	14	9	3	45	43	34	
Portland	12	7	7	43	43	35	
Angel City	12	8	6	42	44	28	
Kansas City	12	9	5	41	43	37	
Seattle	12	10	4	40	33	31	
N. Carolina	12	11	3	39	49	37	
Denver	9	9	8	35	42	37	
Orlando	10	13	3	33	35	41	
Houston	8	12	6	30	32	36	
Bay FC	7	14	5	26	27	37	
Boston	7	14	5	26	32	44	
Louisville	7	17	2	23	15	60	
Chicago	5	19	2	27	15	51	

Three points for win, one point for tie.

FRIDAY'S RESULTS

San Diego at Orlando, late
North Carolina at Seattle, late

SATURDAY'S MATCHES

Utah Royals FC at Louisville, 3 p.m.
Bay FC at Kansas City, 5:30 p.m.
Boston Legacy FC at Portland, 7:45 p.m.

NFL

AMERICAN CONFERENCE

	EAST	W	L	T	Pct	PF	PA
Buffalo	3	0	0	100	101	78	
N.Y. Jets	1	2	0	.333	64	61	
New England	1	2	0	.333	36	51	
Miami	0	3	0	.000	36	86	
SOUTH	W	L	T	Pct	PF	PA	
Jacksonville	2	1	0	.667	82	36	
Indianapolis	1	2	0	.333	72	91	
Tennessee	0	3	0	.000	37	59	
Houston	0	3	0	.000	54	75	

NORTH

Cleveland	3	1	0	.750	81	95
Baltimore	2	1	0	.667	92	78
Cincinnati	2	1	0	.667	80	63
Pittsburgh	2	2	0	.500	77	87
WEST	W	L	T	Pct	PF	PA
Kansas City	3	0	0	100	88	50
Las Vegas	3	0	0	100	88	54
Denver	2	1	0	.667	60	70
L.A. Chargers	0	3	0	.000	44	76

NATIONAL CONFERENCE

	EAST	W	L	T	Pct	PF	PA
Philadelphia	2	1	0	.667	55	69	
N.Y. Giants	2	1	0	.667	46	55	
Dallas	1	2	0	.333	88	82	
Washington	1	2	0	.333	75	92	
SOUTH	W	L	T	Pct	PF	PA	
Carolina	1	2	0	.333	89	83	
New Orleans	1	2	0	.333	81	83	
Atlanta	1	2	0	.333	51	68	
Tampa Bay	0	3	0	.000	62	79	

NORTH

Minnesota	3	0	0	100	71	41
Detroit	2	1	0	.667	93	95
Chicago	2	1	0	.667	89	53
Green Bay	1	2	0	.333	56	91
WEST	W	L	T	Pct	PF	PA
San Francisco	3	0	0	100	98	50
Seattle	2	1	0	.667	75	50
L.A. Rams	1	2	0	.333	61	63
Arizona	1	2	0	.333	63	81

Sunday's games

Indianapolis vs Washington at London, UK, 8:30 a.m.
Arizona at N.Y. Giants, noon
Dallas at Houston, noon
Green Bay at Tampa Bay, noon
Jacksonville at Cincinnati, noon
L.A. Rams at Philadelphia, noon
N.Y. Jets at Chicago, noon
New England at Buffalo, noon
Tennessee at Baltimore, noon
Miami at Minnesota, 3:05 p.m.
Denver at San Francisco, 3:25 p.m.
Kansas City at Las Vegas, 3:25 p.m.
L.A. Chargers at Seattle, 3:25 p.m.
Detroit at Carolina, 7:20 p.m.

Monday's games

Atlanta at New Orleans, 7:15 p.m.

Thursday's games

Cleveland 27, Pittsburgh 24

Late Thursday: Browns 27, Steelers 24

	Pittsburgh	7	3	0	14	—	24
	Cleveland	0	21	0	6	—	27

First quarter

PIT — R.Wilson 12 pass from Rodgers (Boswell kick), 2:56.

Second quarter

CLE — McLaughlin 28 run (Szmyt kick), 12:14.

CLE — Judkins 2 run (Szmyt kick), 8:28.

CLE — Fannin 2 pass from D.Watson (Szmyt kick), 1:22.

PIT — FG Boswell 31, :08.

Fourth quarter

PIT — D.Washington 21 pass from Rodgers (pass failed), 10:10.

CLE — FG Szmyt 44, 6:37.

PIT — Freiermuth 3 pass from Rodgers (Rodgers run), 1:42.

CLE — FG Szmyt 56, :10.

	PIT	CLE
First downs	24	22
Total net yards	361	372
Rushes-yards	19-92	27-112
Passing	269	260
Punt returns	2-30	2-10
Kickoff returns	4-96	4-99
Interceptions ret	1-0	2-0
Comp-att-int	22-40-2	24-33-1
Sacked-Yards Lost	5-30	2-8
Punts	5-51.8	4-62.75
Fumbles-lost	0-0	2-1
Penalties-yards	8-50	14-88
Time of poss	31:11	28:49

INDIVIDUAL STATS

Rushing — Pit, Warren 17-93, Homer 2-(C-1), Cle, Judkins 17-53, McLaughlin 1-28, D.Watson 7-22, R.Sanders 2-9.
Passing — Pit, Rodgers 22-40-2-299, Cle, D.Watson 24-33-1-268.
Receiving — Pit, Metcalf 5-115, R.Wilson 3-74, Warren 3-33, Washington 3-27, Freiermuth 3-17, Pittman 2-15, Bernard 2-11, Skowronek 1-7, Cle, Judkins 6-43, Concepcion 5-64, Boston 4-89, Jeudy 3-36, Fannin 3-27, R.Sanders 2-7, Bond 1-2.
Missed field goals — Pit, Boswell 48.

Odds

MLB Division Series Saturday

Favorite	Line	Underdog
at Cleveland	-155/+128	Chi White Sox
at Tampa Bay	-138/+114	NY Yankees
at LA Dodgers	-216/+174	Atlanta
at Milwaukee	-220/+178	San Diego

NHL

Saturday

Favorite	Line	Underdog
at Philadelphia	Off/Off	Carolina
at Buffalo	-224/+179	Chicago
at Edmonton	Off/Off	Seattle
at Toronto	Off/Off	Ottawa
at Tampa Bay	-152/+123	Washington
at Pittsburgh	-112/-111	Montreal
at Columbus	Off/Off	Utah
at NY Islanders	-118/-104	New Jersey
at Minnesota	-186/+149	Boston
at Nashville	Off/Off	Dallas
at Colorado	Off/Off	St. Louis
at San Jose	Off/Off	Los Angeles
at Vancouver	Off/Off	Calgary

NFL

NATIONAL SPORTS REPORT

Shorts

LONG DAY ENDS IN STEELERS' LOSS TO BROWNS

The Pittsburgh Steelers got rid of a lingering headache by trading cornerback Joey Porter Jr. to the Cowboys. Much later in the day, it was replaced by heartache after another loss to the Cleveland Browns. Andre Szmyt made a career-long, 56-yard field goal with 10 seconds remaining in the fourth quarter, giving the Browns a 27-24 victory over Pittsburgh on Thursday night. It was the Steelers' fifth consecutive loss in Cleveland and knocked them out of a first-place tie in the AFC North with the Browns, who are a surprising 3-1. "It's very frustrating. Unacceptable the way they moved the ball at the end," said Pittsburgh linebacker T.J. Watt (pictured). "We just have to put it together. You just can't let them move the ball that easily. You just can't." Cleveland quarterback Deshaun Watson shredded the Steelers' secondary for 181 yards and a touchdown in the first half, when the Browns scored 21 straight points to take a 21-7 advantage. Defensive tackle Cameron Heyward, who has spent his entire 16-year career with the franchise, refused to use Porter's departure as an excuse. He cited the team's poor "attention to detail" and not living up to an "elementary school" level of fundamentals.



RANGERS GOALTENDER ACHIEVES RARE FEAT

Igor Shesterkin shot the puck down the ice toward the empty net like he has done so many times before. Then his view was blocked by players standing in the way. "I didn't see the puck land," Shesterkin said, "so I didn't know can I celebrate or not." It landed perfectly and bounced into the net with 2 minutes, 34 seconds left on the clock. The crowd went crazy and his Rangers teammates mobbed him in celebration as Shesterkin became the 18th goaltender in NHL history to score a goal and first to do it for the Rangers. The first goal of his career is the 21st by an NHL goalie, counting the playoffs. Serenaded by chants of "Igor! Igor!" from fans delighted to see him finally cash in, Shesterkin got to lead the parade of players skating to the bench to fist-bump smiling teammates. "It's pretty nice," said Shesterkin, whose goal capped off a 5-1 victory over Tampa Bay on Thursday night in the home opener at Madison Square Garden. "I never did it before, so it's a lot of fun." Two games into the season, Shesterkin is tied with Zibanejad, Gabriel Perreault and newcomers Pavel Dorofeyev and Eeli Tolvanen for the team lead in goals. "He's not just a great goalie — he's a great goal-scorer right now," Dorofeyev said.



WILSON'S BIG GAME HELPS ACES ELIMINATE FEVER

A'ja Wilson made sure her basketball spoke for itself Thursday night. The four-time WNBA MVP, who had a verbal encounter with a Fever fan in Indiana two nights earlier, scored 36 points and grabbed 10 rebounds to lead the defending champion Las Vegas Aces to a 94-83 victory in the deciding Game 3 of the first round. "I have my moments because I'm human," Wilson said. "But after a while, I understood I didn't want that to be a distraction to myself and my team, and I knew what we had to do coming into tonight." The third-seeded Aces, who have won three of the last four titles, moved on to play the winner of the Golden State-Dallas series, which was decided Friday night in San Francisco. This is the second year in a row Las Vegas has ended the season for the Fever, who were seeded sixth. "We've got to give credit to the Aces," Fever star Caitlin Clark said. "I thought they played well. I thought they were ready to go. That's what championship teams do." Wilson book ended this series with sensational performances in Games 1 and 3, making her sure verbal confrontation with a Fever fan wouldn't be the enduring memory.



— Associated Press



Notre Dame running back Aneyas Williams reaches the ball across the goal line for a touchdown during the first half against Michigan State on Sept. 19 in South Bend, Ind. PAUL BARNICK/AP

NOTRE DAME FOOTBALL

Worth celebrating

Williams, Irish — with lawnmower celebration flap in the past — look for run game to blossom

By Colleen Kane
CHICAGO TRIBUNE

SOUTH BEND, Ind. — For the record, Aneyas Williams didn't even come up with the "Crank the Lawnmower" end-zone celebration that drew a flag two weeks ago against Michigan State.

The Notre Dame offensive line approached the junior running back with the idea, and he agreed. So when Williams bounced off a Spartans defender and rolled across the goal line for a 1-yard touchdown run Sept. 19, he motioned to the linemen. They each pulled an arm back a few times like they were starting a lawnmower and then danced.

The entire thing lasted all of six seconds, harmless it seemed. They thought it fell within coach Marcus Freeman's rules — celebrate together and then hand the ball to the officiating crew. But an official flung a flag in the air behind them. Too choreographed, an ACC representative later told Freeman.

"If we could go back and do it again, we would ask Free and have him get it approved," Williams said Tuesday after practice. "But, yeah, man, you live and you learn from it."

At the moment the unsportsmanlike conduct penalty was called, moving Notre Dame's ensuing kickoff back 15 yards, Freeman was incensed at the celebration, animatedly yelling at Williams, "What are you doing?"

Freeman later apologized to Williams and his mother for how he reacted and again at his weekly news conference. While he wants his players to be smart about celebrations and he needed to correct Williams, it also didn't sit well that people saw that interaction on TV without knowing their relationship, which goes back to Williams' sophomore year of high school.

Williams said Freeman's follow-ups showed his character.

"That holds a lot of weight," Williams said. "It meant a lot to me and to my mom. He didn't have to do that. I knew me and Freeman were good. My mom knew everything was going to be fine.

"Obviously, Freeman didn't like

the way he reacted, but I'd be lying if I didn't think I deserved it."

No. 3 Notre Dame didn't have many bumps in cruising to a 4-0 record in September against lesser competition entering Saturday's game at North Carolina (2-1). That minor viral hiccup passed easily because of Freeman's apologies and Williams owning up to his mistake.

It helped, too, that Williams came back Saturday against Purdue and totaled 80 yards on 14 carries, including a 22-yard touchdown — Notre Dame's first rush for more than 20 yards this season.

The Irish haven't had the smoothest transition in the running game to the post-Jeremiah Love era.

In their first first four games without the 2025 Heisman Trophy finalist, Notre Dame averaged 141.8 rushing yards per game and 4.1 per carry behind Williams and sophomore Nolan James Jr. Entering the Purdue game, the Irish's longest carry was 17 yards, though Freeman thinks his backs have shown the ability to be hard, vertical runners in short-yardage situations.

Freeman told reporters at his weekly news conference that he believes the running game is improving as they make schematic adjustments based on what the offensive line and running backs do best. The entire group is getting comfortable with each other, he said.

And the Purdue game showed more explosive-play ability. In addition to Williams' 22-yard touchdown, Jonaz Walton broke off a 44-yard run in the fourth quarter.

Williams echoed that it's a work in progress but said everyone in the room is looking for "team glory" as they stay ready for their opportunities. The Irish face a North Carolina run defense this week that's allowing 123 rushing yards per game (62nd in the FBS) and 3.4 yards per carry (46th).

"It's two new guys working a new scheme, and we're just trying to figure out what works best for this team," Williams said. "You've got two different backs and it's a week-by-week thing, and that's what we're figuring out. We were finally able to bring a little bit of that

KEY WEEK 5 GAMES
Friday's game

	Penn State at Northwestern Late
Saturday's games	
	No. 3 Notre Dame at North Carolina 11 a.m., ESPN
	Michigan at Minnesota 11 a.m., Fox-32
	Michigan State at Wisconsin 11:30 a.m., BTN
	No. 5 Ohio State at No. 14 Iowa 2:30 p.m., CBS-2
	Maryland at Nebraska 3 p.m., FS1
	Purdue at Illinois 3:15 p.m., BTN
	Washington at No. 18 USC 6:30 p.m., NBC-5
	No. 6 Indiana at Rutgers 7 p.m., BTN

to light, and we're going to be even better next week."

Williams and James entered the season under a lot of scrutiny given the impact their predecessors, Love and Jadarian Price, made last season on the Notre Dame offense.

That duo helped Notre Dame average 203.4 rushing yards per game and 5.7 per carry in 2025. Either Love or Price — or both — was good for a highlight-reel run almost every game.

Williams was an obvious successor after rushing for 443 yards and seven touchdowns over his first two seasons as a backup. He entered 2026 with a lot of confidence, but he also had expectations for what he wanted to do with his heightened opportunity.

"He has a lot on his plate, man, and a lot of expectations," Freeman said at his news conference before the Purdue game. "He puts a lot of pressure on himself to be this great running back and he just works tremendously. And I'm really proud of who he is, the way he goes about his business, the leadership that he leads with."

His results, along with those of James, have been uneven so far.

Williams rushed for 90 and 29 yards in the first two games against

Wisconsin and Rice. He totaled only 25 yards and the touchdown against Michigan State, while James had 26 carries for 121 yards.

But after James started against the Boilermakers, Williams helped Notre Dame total a season-high 177 rushing yards against a poor Purdue run defense.

As he tries to live up to his own standards, Williams has tried to keep in mind that he needs to be himself and play football the way he knows how.

"Understanding I'm not in this thing on my own was the biggest thing," he said. "Like it's not just me. I've got all the guys in the room behind me. I've got my coach backing me. I've got Coach Free. I've got everybody at my back.

"There's no pressure. I'm just going out there and playing the game that I love. That was the biggest thing for me to get back was not making anything more than it is."

After the Purdue game, Freeman said he was proud of Williams for how he responded following the Michigan State game. The week didn't faze him, Freeman said, and he worked the way he always does.

Among the rewards was that 22-yard touchdown run, on which Williams shot through a huge hole up the middle and charged into the end zone untouched. He had a feeling early in the play it could be a big score.

"Once we saw the light box and the linebacker that I was reading disappeared, and all I (saw) was green grass," Williams said. "So that was nice. It was good to see."

Williams' celebration after that one was to hug his teammates, and Freeman responded with a big smile.

Right guard Sullivan Absher was in the middle of both that end-zone party and the lawnmower dance. He said the Irish will try to be more spontaneous with celebrations moving forward and acknowledged it was probably appropriate to repay Williams somehow for persuading him to do the one that was penalized.

Absher recently got back into sports card collecting, so he figures if he ever pulls an Aneyas Williams card, he'll pass it along to him.

"I mean, they owe me one," Williams said. "I took the blow for them, but we're past it for sure."

COLLEGE FOOTBALL

Fight to regain throne

By Eddie Pells
and Steve Megargee
ASSOCIATED PRESS

The Southeastern Conference has experienced a steady drop in the number of players from its own states who stay close to home to play in the conference since the dawn of the name, image and likeness era that turned college sports upside down, an Associated Press analysis of recruiting data has found.

Among the most telling symptoms — a three-year stretch during which the Big Ten Conference has amassed three straight national titles while the SEC hasn't landed a team in the championship game.

There are dozens of ways to explain that recent title gulf between the nation's two top conferences and even more ways to excuse it, with almost all the reasons embedded somewhere in the world of the changes wrought by NIL.

The AP analysis of recruiting found one steady trend: The percentage of top high school recruits from states with SEC schools who stay home to play at one of those schools has dropped from 72% in 2022 — the first recruiting year after NIL rules as we know them were fully established — to a projected 53% for the still-developing 2027 signing class.

That translates to 99 players staying close to home in 2022 down to 78 for 2027. Big Ten schools picked up nine of those players in 2022, a number projected to rise to 22 next year.

This is not necessarily a Big Ten raid of five-star studs in the SEC's traditional recruiting hotbeds. But it does suggest a slow drain of talent that includes well-known players such as Heisman Trophy favorite Jeremiah Smith alongside young offensive and defensive linemen, runningbacks and quarterbacks who used to help programs build depth that is sorely lacking in a sport where the promise of immediate playing time can be as strong a recruiting tool as NIL payments.

"I think it's moved that way over a 10-year trend," Georgia coach Kirby Smart said. "I can't say that it's more because of NIL. I think it's more because social media, these kids travel, they play more 7-on-7s, they know more kids across the country. So that trend was trending that way before NIL — and NIL probably just sped it up even more."

One noticeable result: Top SEC programs that once commanded attention simply by the power of their name or their coach are not hoarding depth-building talent, which helped vault the league to the top of the sport in all but four seasons from 2005-2022.

"NIL ... has changed the landscape of recruiting," said Ohio State coach Ryan Day, who brought Smith in from Florida. "I also think the world's just gotten smaller. For us, we never used to recruit down toward Alabama and Louisiana, Mississippi. Now, you're seeing on our team, more and more guys from that area."

SEC STATES REMAIN A TALENT HOTBED, BUT RECRUITING CHANGED

The AP looked at the 24/7Sports Composite's 250 highest-ranked recruits each year since 2015, then broke down how many of those players lived in states with SEC teams (the only new state in the mix from then to now is Oklahoma, with the Sooners joining the SEC in 2024 along with Texas). Then, among that smaller group, the AP determined how many went to schools currently in the SEC and how many went elsewhere.

To no one's surprise, more than half of the top 250 players came from SEC states every year.